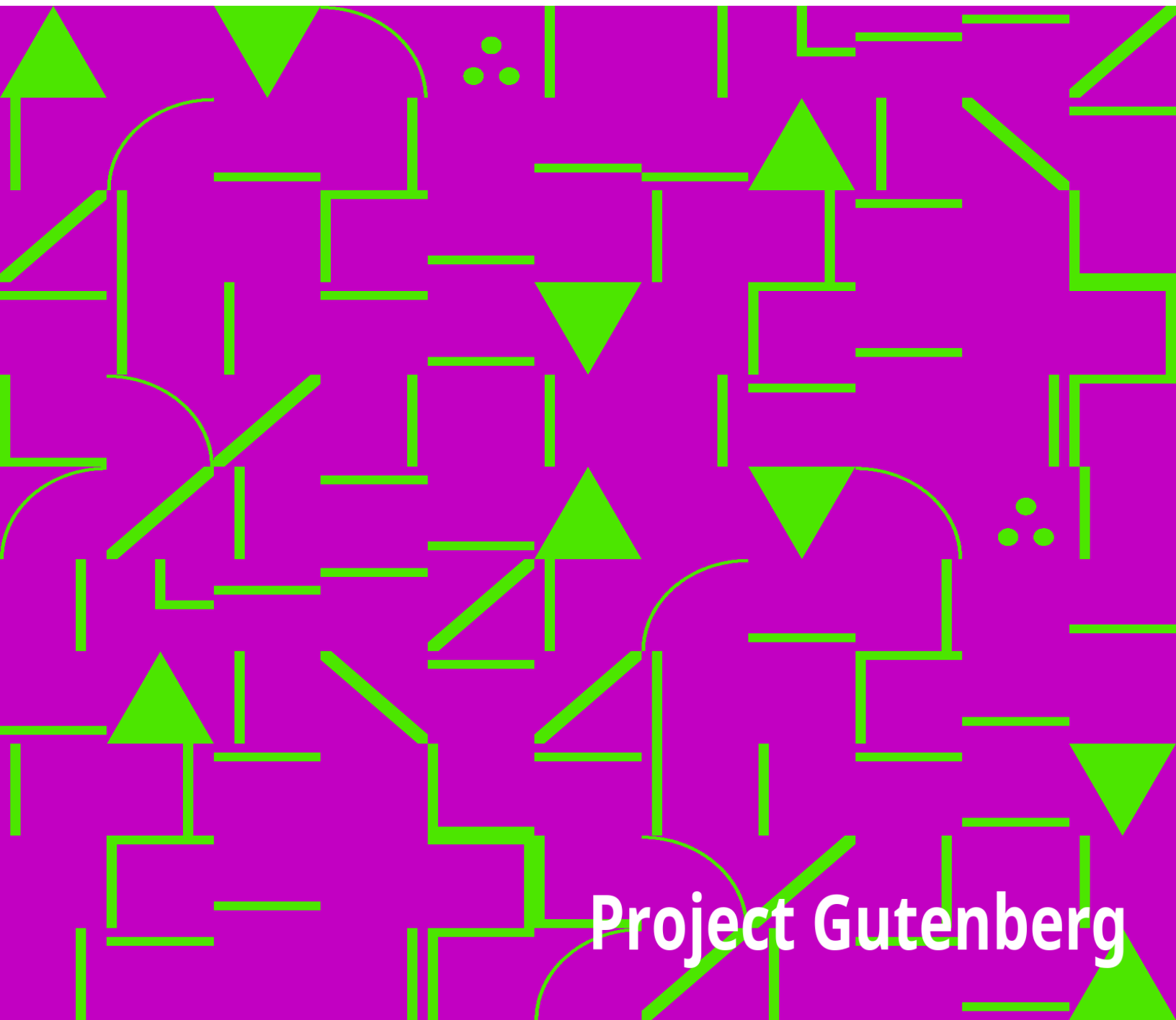


A Sixth-Century Fragment of the Letters of Pliny the Younger

E. A. Lowe and Edward Kennard Rand

An abstract geometric pattern composed of various shapes including triangles, squares, rectangles, and circles, all rendered in white lines and solid colors (yellow, red, and blue) against a black background. The pattern is dense and covers the entire lower half of the image.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A SIXTH-
CENTURY FRAGMENT OF THE LETTERS OF PLINY THE
YOUNGER ***

A few typographical errors have been corrected. They have been marked in the text with popups.

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A SIXTH-CENTURY FRAGMENT
OF THE
LETTERS OF
PLINY THE YOUNGER

A STUDY OF SIX LEAVES OF AN UNCIAL
MANUSCRIPT PRESERVED IN
THE PIERPONT MORGAN LIBRARY
NEW YORK

BY

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PREFATORY NOTE.

THE Pierpont Morgan Library, itself a work of art, contains masterpieces of painting and sculpture, rare books, and illuminated manuscripts. Scholars generally are perhaps not aware that it also possesses the oldest Latin manuscripts in America, including several that even the greatest European libraries would be proud to own. The collection is also admirably representative of the development of script throughout the Middle Ages. It comprises specimens of the uncial hand, the half-uncial, the Merovingian minuscule of the Luxeuil type, the script of the famous school of Tours, the St. Gall type, the Irish and Visigothic hands, and the Beneventan and Anglo-Saxon scripts.

Among the oldest manuscripts of the library, in fact the oldest, is a hitherto unnoticed fragment of great significance not only to palaeographers, but to all students of the classics. It consists of six leaves of an early sixth-century manuscript of the *Letters* of the younger Pliny. This new witness to the text, older by three centuries than the oldest codex heretofore used by any modern editor, has reappeared in this unexpected quarter, after centuries of wandering and hiding. The fragment was bought by the late J. Pierpont Morgan in Rome, in December 1910, from the art dealer Imbert; he had obtained it from De Marinis, of Florence, who had it from the heirs of the Marquis Taccone, of Naples. Nothing is known of the rest of the manuscript.

The present writers had the good fortune to visit the Pierpont Morgan Library in 1915. One of the first manuscripts put into their hands was this early sixth-century fragment of Pliny's *Letters*, which forms the subject of the following pages. Having received permission to study the manuscript and publish results, they lost no time in acquainting classical scholars with this important find. In December of the same year, at the joint meeting of the American Archaeological and Philological Associations, held at Princeton University, two papers were read, one concerning the palaeographical, the other the textual, importance of the fragment. The two studies which follow, Part I by Doctor Lowe, Part II by Professor Rand, are

an elaboration of the views presented at the meeting. Some months after the present volume was in the form of page-proof, Professor E. T. Merrill's long-expected edition of Pliny's *Letters* appeared (Teubner, Leipsic, 1922). We regret that we could not avail ourselves of it in time to introduce certain changes. The reader will still find Pliny cited by the pages of Keil, and in general he should regard the date of our production as 1921 rather than 1922.

The writers wish to express their gratitude for the privilege of visiting the Pierpont Morgan Library and making full use of its facilities. For permission to publish the manuscript they are indebted to the generous interest of Mr. J. Pierpont Morgan. They also desire to make cordial acknowledgment of the unfailing courtesy and helpfulness of the Librarian, Miss Belle da Costa Greene, and her assistant, Miss Ada Thurston. Lastly, the writers wish to thank the Carnegie Institution of Washington for accepting their joint study for publication and for their liberality in permitting them to give all the facsimiles necessary to illustrate the discussion.

E. K. RAND.
E. A. LOWE.

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DESCRIPTION OF PLATES



Part I.

THE PALAEOGRAPHY OF THE MORGAN
FRAGMENT

BY

E. A. LOWE

THE PALAEOGRAPHY OF THE MORGAN FRAGMENT.

DESCRIPTION OF THE FRAGMENT.

Contents

size

vellum

T *binding* HE Morgan fragment of Pliny the Younger contains the end of Book II and the beginning of Book III of the *Letters* (II, xx. 13-III, v. 4). The fragment consists of six vellum leaves, or twelve pages, which apparently formed part of a gathering or quire of the original volume.

The leaves measure 11-3/8 by 7 inches (286 x 180 millimeters); the written space measures 7-1/4 by 4-3/8 inches (175 x 114 millimeters); outer margin, 1-7/8 inches (50 millimeters); inner, 3/4 inch (18 millimeters); upper margin, 1-3/4 inches (45 millimeters); lower, 2-1/4 inches (60 millimeters).

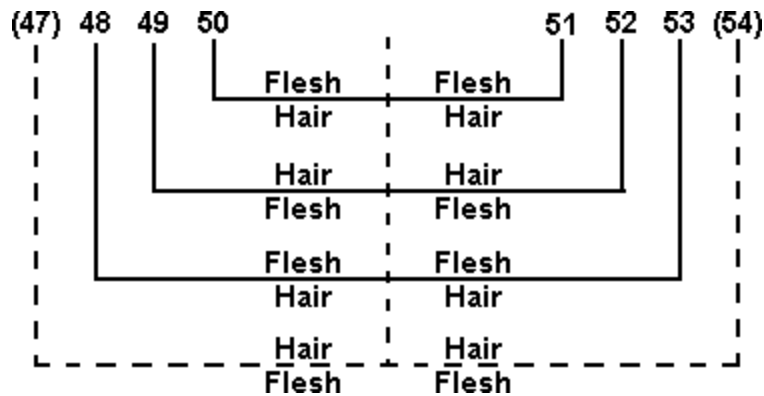
The vellum is well prepared and of medium thickness. The leaves are bound in a modern pliable vellum binding with three blank vellum fly-leaves in front and seven in back, all modern. On the inside of the front cover is the book-plate of John Pierpont Morgan, showing the Morgan arms with the device: *Onward and Upward*. Under the book-plate is the press-mark M.462.

Ruling There are twenty-seven horizontal lines to a page and two vertical bounding lines. The lines were ruled with a hard point on the flesh side, each opened sheet being ruled separately: 48^v and 53^r, 49^r and 52^v, 50^v and 51^r. The horizontal lines were guided by knife-slits made in the outside margins quite close to the text space; the two vertical lines were guided by two slits in the upper margin and two in the lower. The horizontal lines

were drawn across the open sheets and extended occasionally beyond the slits, more often just beyond the perpendicular bounding lines. The written space was kept inside the vertical bounding lines except for the initial letter of each epistle; the first letter of the address and the first letter of the epistle proper projected into the left margin. Here and there the scribe transgressed beyond the bounding line. On the whole, however, he observed the limits and seemed to prefer to leave a blank before the bounding line rather than to crowd the syllable into the space or go beyond the vertical line.

Relation of the six leaves to the rest of the manuscript One might suppose that the six leaves once formed a complete gathering of the original book, especially as the first and last pages, folios 48^r and 53^v have a darker appearance, as though they had been the outside leaves of a gathering that had been affected by exposure. But this darker appearance is sufficiently accounted for by the fact that both pages are on the hair side of the parchment, and the hair side is always darker than the flesh side. Quires of six leaves or trinions are not unknown. Examples of them may be found in our oldest manuscripts. But they are the exception.¹ The customary quire is a gathering of eight leaves, forming a quaternion proper. It would be natural, therefore, to suppose that our fragment did not constitute a complete gathering in itself but formed part of a quaternion. The supposition is confirmed by the following considerations:

In the first place, if our six leaves were once a part of a quaternion, the two leaves needed to complete them must have formed the outside sheet, since our fragment furnishes a continuous text without any lacuna whatever. Now, in the formation of quires, sheets were so arranged that hair side faced hair side, and flesh side flesh side. This arrangement is dictated by a sense of uniformity. As the hair side is usually much darker than the flesh side the juxtaposition of hair and flesh sides would offend the eye. So, in the case of our six leaves, folios 48^v and 53^r, presenting the flesh side, face folios 49^r and 52^v likewise on the flesh side; and folios 49^v and 52^r presenting the hair side, face folios 50^r and 51^v likewise on the hair side. The inside pages 50^v and 51^r which face each other, are both flesh side, and the outside pages 48^r and 53^v are both hair side, as may be seen from the accompanying diagram.



From this arrangement it is evident that if our fragment once formed part of a quaternion the missing sheet was so folded that its hair side faced the present outside sheet and its flesh side was on the outside of the whole gathering. Now, it was by far the more usual practice in our oldest uncial manuscripts to have the flesh side on the outside of the quire.² And as our fragment belongs to the oldest class of uncial manuscripts, the manner of arranging the sheets of quires seems to favor the supposition that two outside leaves are missing. The hypothesis is, moreover, strengthened by another consideration. According to the foliation supplied by the fifteenth-century Arabic numerals, the leaf which must have followed our fragment bore the number 54, the leaf preceding it having the number 47. If we assume that our fragment was a complete gathering, we are obliged to explain why the next gathering began on a leaf bearing an even number (54), which is abnormal. We do not have to contend with this difficulty if we assume that folios 47 and 54 formed the outside sheet of our fragment, for six quires of eight leaves and one of six would give precisely 54 leaves. It seems, therefore, reasonable to assume that our fragment is not a complete unit, but formed part of a quaternion, the outside sheet of which is missing.

Original size of the manuscript In the fifteenth century, as the previous demonstration has made clear, our fragment was preceded by 47 leaves that are missing to-day. With this clue in our possession it can be demonstrated that the manuscript began with the first book of the *Letters*. We start with the fact that not all the 47 folios (or 94 pages) which preceded our six leaves were devoted to the text of the *Letters*. For, from the contents of our

six leaves we know that each book must have been preceded by an index of addresses and first lines. The indices for Books I and II, if arranged in general like that of Book III, must have occupied four pages.³ We also learn from our fragment that space must be allowed for a colophon at the end of each book. One page for the colophons of Books I and II is a reasonable allowance. Accordingly it follows that out of the 94 pages preceding our fragment 5 were not devoted to text, or in other words that only 89 pages were thus devoted.

Now, if we compare pages in our manuscript with pages of a printed text we find that the average page in our manuscript corresponds to about 19 lines of the Teubner edition of 1912. If we multiply 89 by 19 we get 1691. This number of lines of the size of the Teubner edition should, if our calculation be correct, contain the text of the *Letters* preceding our fragment. The average page of the Teubner edition of 1912 of the part which interests us contains a little over 29 lines. If we divide 1691 by 29 we get 58.3. Just 58 pages of Teubner text are occupied by the 47 leaves which preceded our fragment. So close a conformity is sufficient to prove our point. We have possibly allowed too much space for indices and colophons, especially if the former covered less ground for Books I and II than for Book III. Further, owing to the abbreviation of *que* and *bus*, and particularly of official titles, we can not expect a closer agreement.

It is not worth while to attempt a more elaborate calculation. With the edges matching so nearly, it is obvious that the original manuscript as known and used in the fifteenth century could not have contained some other work, however brief, before Book I of Pliny's *Letters*. If the manuscript contained the entire ten books it consisted of about 260 leaves. This sum is obtained by counting the number of lines in the Teubner edition of 1912, dividing this sum by 19, and adding thereto pages for colophons and indices. It would be too bold to suppose that this calculation necessarily gives us the original size of the manuscript, since the manuscript may have had less than ten books, or it may, on the other hand, have had other works. But if it contained only the ten books of the *Letters*, then 260 folios is an approximately correct estimate of its size.

It is hard to believe that only six leaves of the original manuscript have escaped destruction. The fact that the outside sheet (foll. 48^r and 53^v) is not much worn nor badly soiled suggests that the gathering of six leaves must have been torn from the manuscript not so very long ago and that the remaining portions may some day be found.

Disposition The pages in our manuscript are written in long lines,⁴ in *scriptura continua*, with hardly any punctuation.

Each page begins with a large letter, even though that letter occur in the body of a word (cf. foll. 48^r, 51^v, 52^r).⁵

Each epistle begins with a large letter. The line containing the address which precedes each epistle also begins with a large letter. In both cases the large letter projects into the left margin.

The running title at the top of each page is in small rustic capitals.⁶ On the verso of each folio stands the word EPISTVLARVM; on the recto of the following folio stands the number of the book, *e.g.*, LIB. II, LIB. III.

To judge by our fragment, each book was preceded by an index of addresses and initial lines written in alternating lines of black and red uncials.

Alternating lines of black and red rustic capitals of a large size were used in the colophon.⁷

Ornamentation As in all our oldest Latin manuscripts, the ornamentation is of the simplest kind. Such as it is, it is mostly found at the end and beginning of books. In our case, the colophon is enclosed between two scrolls of vine-tendrils terminating in an ivy-leaf at both ends. The lettering in the colophon and in the running title is set off by means of ticking above and below the line.

Red is used for decorative purposes in the middle line of the colophon, in the scroll of vine-tendrils, in the ticking, and in the border at the end of the Index on fol. 49. Red was also used, to judge by our fragment, in the first

three lines of a new book,⁸ in the addresses in the Index, and in the addresses preceding each letter.

Corrections The original scribe made a number of corrections. The omitted line of the Index on fol. 49 was added between the lines, probably by the scribe himself, using a finer pen; likewise the omitted line on fol. 52^v, lines 7-8. A number of slight corrections come either from the scribe or from a contemporary reader; the others are by a somewhat later hand, which is probably not more recent than the seventh century.⁹ The method of correcting varies. As a rule, the correct letter is added above the line over the wrong letter; occasionally it is written over an erasure. An omitted letter is also added above the line over the space where it should be inserted. Deletion of single letters is indicated by a dot placed over the letter and a horizontal or an oblique line drawn through it. This double use of expunction and cancellation is not uncommon in our oldest manuscripts. For details on the subject of corrections, see the notes on [pp. 23-34](#).

There is a ninth-century addition on fol. 53 and one of the fifteenth century on fol. 51. On fol. 49, in the upper margin, a fifteenth-century hand using a stylus or hard point scribbled a few words, now difficult to decipher.¹⁰ Presumably the same hand drew a bearded head with a halo. Another relatively recent hand, using lead, wrote in the left margin of fol. 53^v the monogram QR¹¹ and the roman numerals i, ii, iii under one another. These numerals, as Professor Rand correctly saw, refer to the works of Pliny the Elder enumerated in the text. Further activity by this hand, the date of which it is impossible to determine, may be seen, for example, on fol. 49^v, ll. 8, 10, 15; fol. 52, ll. 4, 10, 13, 21, 22; fol. 53, ll. 12, 15, 16, 17, 20, 27; fol. 53^v, ll. 5, 10, 15.

Syllabification Syllables are divided after a vowel or diphthong except where such a division involves beginning the next syllable with a group of consonants.¹² In that case the consonants are distributed between the two syllables, one consonant going with one syllable and the other with the following, except when the group contains more than two successive

consonants, in which case the first consonant goes with the first syllable, the rest with the following syllable. That the scribe is controlled by this mechanical rule and not by considerations of pronunciation is obvious from the division SAN|CTISSIMUM and other examples found below. The method followed by him is made amply clear by the examples which occur in our twelve pages:[13](#)

fo. 48^r, line 1, con–suleret
2, sescen–ties
3, ex–ta
7, fal–si

fo. 49^v, line 3, spu–rinnam
5, senesce–re
7, distin–ctius
12, se–nibus
13, con–ueniunt
15, spurin–na
18, circum–agit
20, mi–lia
24, prae–sentibus
25, grauan–tur

fo. 50^r, line 1, singu–laris
4, an–tiquitatis
5, au–dias
9, ite–rum
11, scri–bit
12, ly–rica
15, scri–bentis
17, octa–ua
19, uehe–menter
20, exer–citationis
21, se–nectute
22, paulis–per
23, le–gentem

fo. 50^v, line 2, de-lectatur
3, co-moedis
4, uolupta-tes
5, ali-quid
6, lon-gum
11, senec-tut
12, uo-to
13, ingres-surus
14, ae-tatis
15, in-terim
16, ho-rum
20, re-xit
21, me-ruit
22, eun-dem
25, epis-tulam

fo. 51^r, line 2, mi-hi
4, afria-nus
6, facultati-bus
7, super-sunt
8, gra-uitate
9, consi-lio
10, ut-or
13, ar-dentius
23, con-feras
24, habe-bis
27, concu-piscat

fo. 51^v, line 3, san-ctissimum
5, memo-riam
10, pater-nus
11, contige-rit
12, lau-de
14, hones-tis
15, refe-rat
17, contuber-nium

- 21, circumspi-ciendus
- 22, scho-lae
- 24, nos-tro
- 27, praecep-tor
- fo. 52^r, line 2, demon-strare
 - 5, iudi-cio
 - 6, gra-uis
 - 8, quan-tum
 - 9, cre-dere
 - 12, mag-nasque
 - 13, ge-nitore
 - 16, nes[cis]-se
 - 19, nomi-na
 - 20, fauen-tibus
 - 23, dis-citur
- fo. 52^v, line 1, uidean-tur
 - 3, con-silium
 - 5, concu-pisco
 - 6, pecu-nia
 - 7, excucuris-sem
 - 10, se-natu
 - 12, ne-cessitatibus
 - 19, postulaue-runt
 - 21, bae-bium
 - 23, clari-sima
 - 25, in-quam
 - 26, excusa-tionis
- fo. 53^r, line 1, com (or con)-pulit
 - 5, ueni-ebat
 - 7, iniu-rias
 - 8, ex-secutos
 - 10, prae-terea
 - 12, aduoca-tione
 - 13, con-seruandum

15, com–paratum
 16, sub–uertas
 17, cumu–les
 18, obliga–ti
 23, tris–tissimum
 fo. 53^v, line 2, facili–orem
 3, si–quis
 5, offi–ciorum
 7, praepara–tur
 8, super–est
 10, sim–plicitas
 11, compro–bantis
 14, diligen–ter
 20, cog–nitio
 22, milita–ret
 26, exsol–uit

Orthography. The spelling found in our six leaves is remarkably correct. It compares favorably with the best spelling encountered in our oldest Latin manuscripts of the fourth and fifth centuries. The diphthong *ae* is regularly distinguished from *e*. The interchange of *b* and *u*, *d* and *t*, *o* and *u*, so common in later manuscripts, is rare here: the confusion between *b* and *u* occurs once (*comprouasse*, fo. 52^v, l. 1); the omission of *h* occurs once (*pulcritudo*, fo. 51^v, l. 26); the use of *k* for *c* occurs twice (*karet*, fo. 51^r, l. 14, and *karitas*, fo. 52^r, l. 5). The scribe uses the correct forms in *adolescet* (fo. 51^v, l. 14) and *adulescenti* (fo. 51^v, l. 24); he writes *auonculi* (fo. 53^v, l. 15), *exsistat* (fo. 51^v, l. 9), and *exsecutos* (fo. 53^r, l. 8). In the case of composite words he has the assimilated form in some, and in others the unassimilated form, as the following examples go to show:

fo. 48 ^r , line 3, inpleturus	fo. 48 ^r , line 7, improbissimum
49 ^r , 13a, adnotasse	48 ^v , 23, composuisse
19, adsumo	50 ^r , 1, ascendit
50 ^r , 1, adsumit	6, imbuare

	27, adponitur		22, accubat
50 ^v ,	3, adficitur	51 ^r ,	2, optulisse
51 ^r ,	19, adstruere		3, suppeteret
	21, adstruere		16, ascendere
	26, adpetat	51 ^v ,	16, accipiat
51 ^v ,	9, exsistat	52 ^v ,	1, comprouasse
	12, inlustri		11, collegae
	14, inbutus		17, impetrassent
52 ^r ,	18, admonebitur	53 ^r ,	8, accusationibus
52 ^v ,	20, inplorantes		15, comparatum
	22, adlegantes	53 ^v ,	1, computabam
	24, adsensio		5, accusare
	27, adtulisse		11, comprobantis
53 ^r ,	8, exsecutos		23, composuit

Abbreviations Very few abbreviated words occur in our twelve pages. Those that are found are subject to strict rules. What is true of the twelve pages was doubtless true of the entire manuscript, inasmuch as the sparing use of abbreviations in conformity with certain definite rules is a characteristic of all our oldest manuscripts.¹⁴ The abbreviations found in our fragment may conveniently be grouped as follows:

1. Suspensions which might occur in any ancient manuscript or inscription, *e.g.*:

B· = BUS

Q· = QUE¹⁵

·C̄· = GAIUS¹⁶

P· C· = PATRES CONSCRIPTI

2. Technical or recurrent terms which occur in the colophons at the end of each book and at the end of letters, as:

·EXP· = EXPLICIT

·INC· = INCIPIT

LIB· = LIBER

VAL· = VALE¹⁷

3. Purely arbitrary suspensions which occur only in the index of addresses preceding each book, suspensions which would never occur in the body of the text, as: SÜETON TRANQUE,¹⁸ ÜESTRIC SPURINN·

4. Omitted *M* at the end of a line, omitted *N* at the end of a line, the omission being indicated by means of a horizontal stroke, thickened at either end, which is placed over the space immediately following the final vowel.¹⁹ This omission may occur in the middle of a word but only at the end of a line.

Authenticity of the six leaves The sudden appearance in America of a portion of a very ancient classical manuscript unknown to modern editors may easily arouse suspicion in the minds of some scholars. Our experience with the “Anonymus Cortesianus” has taught us to be wary,²⁰ and it is natural to demand proof establishing the genuineness of the new fragment.²¹ As to the six leaves of the Morgan Pliny, it may be said unhesitatingly that no one with experience of ancient Latin manuscripts could entertain any doubt as to their genuineness. The look and feel of the parchment, the ink, the script, the titles, colophons, ornamentation, corrections, and later additions, all bear the indisputable marks of genuine antiquity.

But it may be objected that a clever forger possessing a knowledge of palaeography would be able to reproduce all these features of ancient manuscripts. This objection can hardly be sustained. It is difficult to believe that any modern could reproduce faithfully all the characteristics of sixth-century uncials and fifteenth-century notarial writing without unconsciously falling into some error and betraying his modernity. Besides, there is one consideration which to my mind establishes the genuineness of our fragment beyond a peradventure. We have seen above that the leaves of our manuscript are so arranged that hair side faces hair side and flesh side faces flesh side. The visible effect of this arrangement is that two pages of clear writing alternate with two pages of faded writing, the faded appearance

being caused by the ink scaling off from the less porous surface of the flesh side of the vellum.²² As a matter of fact, the flesh side of the vellum showed faded writing long before modern time. To judge by the retouched characters on fol. 53^r it would seem that the original writing had become illegible by the eighth or ninth century.²³ Still, a considerable period of time would, so far as we know, be necessary for this process. It is highly improbable that a forger could devise this method of giving his forgery the appearance of antiquity, and even if he attempted it, it is safe to say that the present effect would not be produced in the time that elapsed before the book was sold to Mr. Morgan.

But let us assume, for the sake of argument, that the Morgan fragment is a modern forgery. We are then constrained to credit the forger not only with a knowledge of palaeography which is simply faultless, but, as will be shown in the second part, with a minute acquaintance with the criticism and the history of the text. And this forger did not try to attain fame or academic standing by his nefarious doings, as was the case with the Roman author of the forged "Anonymus Cortesianus," for nothing was heard of this Morgan fragment till it had reached the library of the American collector. If his motive was monetary gain he chose a long and arduous path to attain it. It is hardly conceivable that he should take the trouble to make all the errors and omissions found in our twelve pages and all the additions and corrections representing different ages, different styles, when less than half the number would have served to give the forged document an air of verisimilitude. The assumption that the Morgan fragment is a forgery thus becomes highly unreasonable. When you add to this the fact that there is nothing in the twelve pages that in any way arouses suspicion, the conclusion is inevitable that the Morgan fragment is a genuine relic of antiquity.

Archetype As to the original from which our manuscript was copied, very little can be said. The six leaves before us furnish scanty material on which to build any theory. The errors which occur are not sufficient to warrant any conclusion as to the script of the archetype. One item of information, however, we do get: an omission on fol. 52^v goes to show that the manuscript from which our scribe copied was written in lines of 25 letters

or thereabout.²⁴ The scribe first wrote EXCUCURIS|SEM COMMEATU. Discovering his error of omission, he erased SEM at the beginning of line 8 and added it at the end of line 7 (intruding upon margin-space in order to do so), and then supplied, in somewhat smaller letters, the omitted words ACCEPTO UT PRAEFECTUS AERARI. As there are no *homoioтелеuta* to account for the omission, it is almost certain that it was caused by the inadvertent skipping of a line.²⁵ The omitted letters number 25.

A glance at the abbreviations used in the index of addresses on foll. 48^v-49^r teaches that the original from which our manuscript was copied must have had its names abbreviated in exactly the same form. There is no other way of explaining why the scribe first wrote AD IULIUM SERUIANUM (fol. 49, l. 12), and then erased the final UM and put a point after SERUIAN.

THE DATE AND LATER HISTORY OF THE MANUSCRIPT.

Our manuscript was written in Italy at the end of the fifth or more probably at the beginning of the sixth century.

The manuscripts with which we can compare it come, with scarcely an exception, from Italy; for it is only of more recent uncial manuscripts (those of the seventh and eighth centuries) that we can say with certainty that they originate in other than Italian centres. The only exception which occurs to one is the Codex Bobiensis (k) of the Gospels of the fifth century, which may actually have been written in Africa, though this is far from certain. As for our fragment, the details of its script, as well as the ornamentation, disposition of the page, the ink, the parchment, all find their parallels in authenticated Italian products; and this similarity in details is borne out by the general impression of the whole.

The manuscript may be dated at about the year A.D. 500, for the reason that the script is not quite so old as that of our oldest fifth-century uncial manuscripts, and yet decidedly older than that of the Codex Fuldensis of the Gospels (F) written in or before A.D. 546.

On the dating of uncial manuscripts In dating uncial manuscripts we must proceed warily, since the data on which our judgments are based are meagre in the extreme and rather difficult to formulate.

The history of uncial writing still remains to be written. The chief value of excellent works like Chatelain's *Uncialis Scriptura* or Zangemeister and Wattenbach's *Exempla Codicum Latinorum Litteris Maiusculis Scriptorum* lies in the mass of material they offer to the student. This could not well be otherwise, since clear-cut, objective criteria for dating uncial manuscripts have not yet been formulated; and that is due to the fact that of our four hundred or more uncial manuscripts, ranging from the fourth to the eighth century, very few, indeed, can be dated with precision, and of these virtually none is in the oldest class. Yet a few guide-posts there are. By means of those it ought to be possible not only to throw light on the development of this script, but also to determine the features peculiar to the different periods of its history. This task, of course, can not be attempted here; it may, however, not be out of place to call attention to certain salient facts.

The student of manuscripts knows that a law of evolution is observable in writing as in other aspects of human endeavor. The process of evolution is from the less to the more complex, from the less to the more differentiated, from the simple to the more ornate form. Guided by these general considerations, he would find that his uncial manuscripts naturally fall into two groups. One group is manifestly the older: in orthography, punctuation, and abbreviation it bears close resemblance to inscriptions of the classical or Roman period. The other group is as manifestly composed of the more recent manuscripts: this may be inferred from the corrupt or barbarous spelling, from the use of abbreviations unfamiliar in the classical period but very common in the Middle Ages, or from the presence of punctuation, which the oldest manuscripts invariably lack. The manuscripts of the first group show letters that are simple and unadorned and words unseparated from each other. Those of the second group show a type of ornate writing, the letters having serifs or hair-lines and flourishes, and the words being well separated. There can be no reasonable doubt that this rough classification is correct as far as it goes; but it must remain rough and permit large play for subjective judgement.

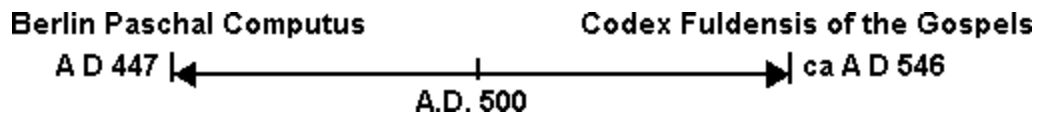
A scientific classification, however, can rest only on objective criteria—criteria which, once recognized, are acceptable to all. Such criteria are made possible by the presence of dated manuscripts. Now, if by a dated manuscript we mean a manuscript of which we know, through a subscription or some other entry, that it was written in a certain year, there is not a single dated manuscript in uncial writing which is older than the seventh century—the oldest manuscript with a *precise* date known to me being the manuscript of St. Augustine written in the Abbey of Luxeuil in A.D. 669.²⁶ But there are a few manuscripts of which we can say with certainty that they were written either before or after some given date. And these manuscripts which furnish us with a *terminus ante quem* or *post quem*, as the case may be, are extremely important to us as being the only relatively safe landmarks for following development in a field that is both remote and shadowy.

The Codex Fuldensis of the Gospels, mentioned above, is our first landmark of importance.²⁷ It was read by Bishop Victor of Capua in the years A.D. 546 and 547, as is testified by two entries, probably autograph. From this it follows that the manuscript was written before A.D. 546. We may surmise—and I think correctly—that it was shortly before 546, if not in that very year. In any case the Codex Fuldensis furnishes a precise *terminus ante quem*.

The other landmark of importance is furnished by a Berlin fragment containing a computation for finding the correct date for Easter Sunday.²⁸ Internal evidence makes it clear that this *Computus Paschalis* first saw light shortly after A.D. 447. The presumption is that the Berlin leaves represent a very early copy, if not the original, of this composition. In no case can these leaves be regarded as a much later copy of the original, as the following purely palaeographical considerations, that is, considerations of style and form of letters, will go to show.

Let us assume, as we do in geometry, for the sake of argument, that the Fulda manuscript and the Berlin fragment were both written about the year 500—a date representing, roughly speaking, the middle point in the period of about one hundred years which separates the extreme limits of the dates

possible for either of these two manuscripts, as the following diagram illustrates:



If our hypothesis be correct, then the script of these two manuscripts, as well as other palaeographical features, would offer striking similarities if not close resemblance. As a matter of fact, a careful comparison of the two manuscripts discloses differences so marked as to render our assumption absurd. The Berlin fragment is obviously much older than the Fulda manuscript. It would be rash to specify the exact interval of time that separates these two manuscripts, yet if we remember the slow development of types of writing the conclusion seems justified that at least several generations of evolution lie between the two manuscripts. If this be correct, we are forced to push the date of each as far back as the ascertained limit will permit, namely, the Fulda manuscript to the year 546 and the Berlin fragment to the year 447. Thus, apparently, considerations of form and style (purely palaeographical considerations) confirm the dates derived from examination of the internal evidence, and the Berlin and Fulda manuscripts may, in effect, be considered two dated manuscripts, two definite guide-posts.

If the preceding conclusion accords with fact, then we may accept the traditional date (circa A.D. 371) of the Codex Vercellensis of the Gospels. The famous Vatican palimpsest of Cicero's *De Re Publica* seems more properly placed in the fourth than in the fifth century; and the older portion of the Bodleian manuscript of Jerome's translation of the *Chronicle* of Eusebius, dated after the year A.D. 442, becomes another guide-post in the history of uncial writing, since a comparison with the Berlin fragment of about A.D. 447 convinces one that the Bodleian manuscript can not have been written much after the date of its archetype, which is A.D. 442.

Dated uncial manuscripts Asked to enumerate the landmarks which may serve as helpful guides in uncial writing prior to the year 800, we should

hardly go far wrong if we tabulate them in the following order:²⁹

1. Codex Vercellensis of the Gospels (a). ca. a. 371

Traube, l.c., No. 327; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XX.

2. Bodleian Manuscript (Auct. T. 2. 26) of Jerome's translation of the Chronicle of Eusebius (older portion). post a. 442

Traube, l.c., No. 164; J. K. Fotheringham, *The Bodleian manuscript of Jerome's version of the Chronicle of Eusebius reproduced in collotype*, Oxford 1905, pp. 25-6; Steffens², pl. 17; also Schwartz in *Berliner Philologische Wochenschrift*, XXVI (1906), c. 746.

3. Berlin Computus Paschalis (MS. lat. 4^o. 298). ca. a. 447

Traube, l.c., No. 13; Th. Mommsen, "Zeitzer Ostertafel vom Jahre 447" in *Abhandl. der Berliner Akad. aus dem Jahre 1862*, Berlin 1863, pp. 539 sqq.; "Liber Paschalis Codicis Cicensis A. CCCCXLVII" in *Monumenta Germaniae Historica, Auctores Antiquissimi*, IX, 1, pp. 502 sqq.; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XXIII.

4. Codex Fuldensis of the Gospels (F), Fulda MS. ante a. 546
Bonifat. 1, read by Bishop Victor of Capua.

Traube, l.c., No. 47; E. Ranke, *Codex Fuldensis, Novum Testamentum Latine interprete Hieronymo ex manuscripto Victoris Capuani*, Marburg and Leipsic 1868; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XXXIV; Steffens², pl. 21a.

5. Codex Theodosianus (Turin, MS. A. II. 2). a. 438-ca. 550

Manuscripts containing the Theodosian Code can not be earlier than A.D. 438, when this body of law was promulgated, nor much later than the middle of sixth century, when the Justinian Code supplanted the Theodosian and made it useless to copy it.

Traube, l.c., No. 311; idem, "Enarratio tabularum" in *Theodosiani libri XVI* edited by Th. Mommsen and P. M. Meyer, Berlin 1905; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pls. XXV-XXVIII; C. Cipolla, *Codici Bobbiesi*, pls. VII, VIII. See also *Oxyrh. Papyri* XV (1922), No. 1813, pl. 1.

6. The Toulouse Manuscript (No. 364) and Paris MS. a. 600-666
lat. 8901, containing Canons, written at Albi.

Traube, l.c., No. 304; F. Schulte, "Iter Gallicum" in *Sitzungsberichte der K. Akad. der Wiss. Phil.-hist. Kl.* LIX (1868), p. 422, facs. 5; C. H. Turner, "Chapters in the history of Latin manuscripts: II. A group of manuscripts of Canons at Toulouse, Albi and Paris" in *Journal of Theological Studies*, II (1901), pp. 266 sqq.; and Traube's descriptions in A. E. Burn, *Facsimiles*

of the Creeds from Early Manuscripts (= vol. XXXVI of the publications of the Henry Bradshaw Society).

7. The Morgan Manuscript of St. Augustine's Homilies, a. 669
written in the Abbey of Luxeuil. Later at Beauvais and
Chateau de Troussures.

Traube, l.c., No 307; L. Delisle, "Notice sur un manuscrit de l'abbaye de Luxeuil copié en 625" in *Notices et Extraits des manuscrits de la bibliothèque nationale*, XXXI. 2 (1886), pp. 149 sqq.; J. Havet, "Questions mérovingiennes: III. La date d'un manuscrit de Luxeuil" in *Bibliothèque de l'école des chartes*, XLVI (1885), pp. 429 sqq.

8. The Berne Manuscript (No. 219B) of Jerome's a. 699
translation of the Chronicle of Eusebius, written in
France, possibly at Fleury.

Traube, l.c., No. 16; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. LIX; J. R. Sinner, *Catalogus codicum manuscriptorum bibliothecae Bernensis* (Berne 1760), pp. 64-7; A. Schone, *Eusebii chronicorum libri duo*, vol. II (Berlin 1866), p. XXVII; J. K. Fotheringham, *The Bodleian manuscript of Jerome's version of the Chronicle of Eusebius* (Oxford 1905), p. 4.

9. Brussels Fragment of a Psalter and Varia Patristica a. 695-711
(MS. 1221 = 9850-52) written for St. Medardus in
Soissons in the time of Childebert III.

Traube, l.c., No. 27; L. Delisle, "Notice sur un manuscrit mérovingien de Saint-Médard de Soissons" in *Revue archéologique*, Nouv. sér. XLI (1881), pp. 257 sqq. and pl. IX; idem, "Notice sur un manuscrit mérovingien de la Bibliothèque Royale de Belgique Nr. 9850-52" in *Notices et extraits des manuscrits*, etc., XXXI. 1 (1884), pp. 33-47, pls. 1, 2, 4; J. Van den Ghejn, *Catalogue des manuscrits de la Bibliothèque Royale de Belgique*, II (1902), pp. 224-6.

10. Codex Amiatinus of the Bible (Florence Laur. ante a. 716
Am. 1) written in England.

Traube, l.c., No. 44; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XXXV; Steffens², pl. 21b; E. H. Zimmermann, *Vorkarolingische Miniaturen* (Berlin 1916), pl. 222; but particularly G. B. de Rossi, *La biblia offerta da Ceolfrido abate al sepolcro di S. Pietro, codice antichissimo tra i superstiti delle biblioteche della sede apostolica*—Al Sommo Pontefice Leone XIII, omaggio giubilare della biblioteca Vaticana, Rome 1888, No. v.

11. The Treves Prosper (MS. 36, olim S. Matthaei). a. 719

Traube, l.c., No. 306; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XLIX; M. Keuffer, *Beschreibendes Verzeichnis der Handschriften der Stadtbibliothek zu Trier*, I (1888), pp. 38 sqq.

12. The Milan Manuscript (Ambros. B. 159 sup.) of ca. a. 750
Gregory's Moralia, written at Bobbio in the abbacy of

Anastasius.

Traube, l.c., No. 102; *Palaeographical Society*, pl. 121; E. H. Zimmermann, *Vorkarolingische Miniaturen* (Berlin 1916), pl. 14-16, Text, pp. 10, 41, 152; A. Reifferscheid, *Bibliotheca patrum latinorum italica*, II, 38 sq.

13. The Bodleian Acts of the Apostles (MS. Selden ante a. 752
supra 30) written in the Isle of Thanet.

Traube, l.c., No. 165; Smith's *Dictionary of the Bible*, IV (New York 1876) 3458 b; S. Berger, *Histoire de la Vulgate* (Paris 1893), p. 44; Wordsworth and White, *Novum Testamentum*, II (1905), p. vii.

14. The Autun Manuscript (No. 3) of the Gospels, written a. 754
at Vosevium.

Traube, l.c., No. 3; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. LXI; Steffens², pl. 37.

15. Codex Beneventanus of the Gospels (London a. 739-760
Brit. Mus. Add. MS. 5463) written at Benevento.

Traube, l.c., No. 88; *Palaeographical Society*, pl. 236; *Catalogue of the Ancient Manuscripts in the British Museum*, II, pl. 7.

16. The Lucca Manuscript (No. 490) of the Liber post a. 787
Pontificalis.

Traube, l.c., No. 92; J. D. Mansi, "De insigni codice Caroli Magni aetate scripto" in *Raccolta di opuscoli scientifici e filologici*, T. XLV (Venice 1751), ed. A. Calogiera, pp. 78-80; Th. Mommsen, *Gesta pontificum romanorum*, I (1899) in *Monumenta Germaniae Historica*; Steffens², pl. 48.

Guided by the above manuscripts, we may proceed to determine the place which the Morgan Pliny occupies in the series of uncial manuscripts. The student of manuscripts recognizes at a glance that the Morgan fragment is, as has been said, distinctly older than the Codex Fuldensis of about the year 546. But how much older? Is it to be compared in antiquity with such venerable monuments as the palimpsest of Cicero's *De Re Publica*, with products like the Berlin *Computus Paschalis* or the Bodleian *Chronicle* of Eusebius? If we examine carefully the characteristics of our oldest group of fourth- and fifth-century manuscripts and compare them with those of the Morgan manuscript we shall see that the latter, though sharing some of the features found in manuscripts of the oldest group, lacks others and in turn shows features peculiar to manuscripts of a later group.

Oldest group of uncial manuscripts Our oldest group would naturally be composed of those uncial manuscripts which bear the closest resemblance to the above-mentioned manuscripts of the fourth and fifth centuries, and I should include in that group such manuscripts as these:

A. OF CLASSICAL AUTHORS.

1. Rome, Vatic. lat. 5757.—Cicero, *De Re Publica*, palimpsest.

Traube, l.c., No. 269-70; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XVII; E. Chatelain, *Paléographie des classiques latins*, pl. XXXIX, 2; *Palaeographical Society*, pl. 160; Steffens², pl. 15. For a complete facsimile edition of the manuscript see *Codices e Vaticanis selecti phototypice expressi*, Vol. II, Milan 1907; Ehrle-Liebaert, *Specimina codicum latinorum Vaticanorum* (Bonn 1912), pl. 4.

2. Rome, Vatic. lat. 5750 + Milan, Ambros. E. 147 sup.—Scholia Bobiensia in Ciceronem, palimpsest.

Traube, l.c., No. 265-68; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XXXI; *Palaeographical Society*, pl. 112; complete facsimile edition in *Codices e Vaticanis selecti*, etc., Vol. VII, Milan 1906; Ehrle-Liebaert, *Specimina codicum latinorum Vaticanorum*, pl. 5a.

3. Vienna, 15.—Livy, fifth decade (five books).

Traube, l.c., No. 359; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XVIII; E. Chatelain, *Paléographie des classiques latins*, pl. CXX; complete facsimile edition in *Codices graeci et latini photographice depicti*, Tom. IX, Leyden 1907.

4. Paris, lat. 5730.—Livy, third decade.

Traube, l.c., No. 183; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XIX; *Paleographical Society*, pls. 31 and 32; E. Chatelain, *Paléographie des classiques latins*, pl. CXVI; *Réproductions des manuscrits et miniatures de la Bibliothèque Nationale*, ed. H. Omont, Vol. I, Paris 1907.

5. Verona, XL (38).—Livy, first decade, 6 palimpsest leaves.

Traube, l.c., No. 349-50. Th. Mommsen, *Analecta Liviana*, Leipsic 1873; E. Chatelain, *Paléographie des classiques latins*, pl. CVI.

6. Rome, Vatic. lat. 10696.—Livy, fourth decade, Lateran fragments.

Traube, l.c., No. 277; M. Vattasso, "Frammenti d'un Livio del V. secolo recentemente scoperti, Codice Vaticano Latino 10696" in *Studi e Testi*, Vol. XVIII, Rome 1906; Ehrle-Liebaert, *Specimina codicum latinorum Vaticanorum*, pl. 5b.

7. Bamberg, Class. 35a.—Livy, fourth decade, fragments.

Traube, l.c., No. 7; idem, "Palaeographische Forschungen IV, Bamberger Fragmente der vierten Dekade des Livius" in *Abhandlungen der Königlich Bayerischen Akademie der Wissenschaften*,

III Klasse, XXIV Band, I Abteilung, Munich 1904.

8. Vienna, lat. 1a.—Pliny, *Historia Naturalis*, fragments.

Traube, l.c., No. 357; E. Chatelain, *Paléographie des classiques latins*, pl. CXXXVII, 1.

9. St. Paul in Carinthia, XXV a 3.—Pliny, *Historia Naturalis*, palimpsest.

Traube, l.c., No. 231; E. Chatelain, *ibid.* pl. CXXXVI. Chatelain cites the manuscript under the press-mark XXV 2/67.

10. Turin, A. II. 2.—Theodosian Codex, fragments, palimpsest.

Traube, l.c., No. 311; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XXV; Cipolla, *Codici Bobbiesi*, pl. VII.

B. OF CHRISTIAN AUTHORS.

1. Vercelli, Cathedral Library.—Gospels (a) ascribed to Bishop Eusebius (†371).

Traube, l.c., No. 327; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XX.

2. Paris, lat. 17225.—Corbie Gospels (ff²).

Traube, l.c., No. 214; *Palaeographical Society*, pl. 87; E. Chatelain, *Uncialis scriptura*, pl. II; Reusens, *Éléments de paléographie*, pl. III, Louvain 1899.

3. Constance-Weingarten Biblical fragments.—Prophets, fragments scattered in the libraries of Stuttgart, Darmstadt, Fulda, and St. Paul in Carinthia.

Traube, l.c., No. 302; Zangemeister-Wattenbach, pl. XXI; complete facsimile reproduction of the fragments in *Codices graeci et latini photographice depicti*, Supplementum IX, Leyden 1912, with introduction by P. Lehmann.

4. Berlin, lat. 4°. 298.—Computus Paschalis of ca. a. 447.

Traube, l.c., No. 13; see above, [p. 16](#), no. 3.

5. Turin, G. VII. 15.—Bobbio Gospels (k).

Traube, l.c., No. 324; *Old Latin Biblical Texts*, vol. II, Oxford 1886; F. Carta, C. Cipolla, C. Frati, *Monumenta Palaeographica sacra*, pl. V, 2; R. Beer, “Über den Ältesten Handschriftenbestand des Klosters Bobbio” in *Anzeiger der Kais. Akad. der Wiss. in Wien*, 1911, No. XI, pp. 91 sqq.; C. Cipolla, *Codici Bobbiesi*, pls. XIV-XV; complete facsimile reproduction of the manuscript, with preface by C. Cipolla: *Il codice Evangelico k della Biblioteca Universitaria Nazionale di Torino*, Turin 1913.

6. Turin, F. IV. 27 + Milan, D. 519. inf. + Rome, Vatic. lat. 10959.—Cyprian, *Epistolae*, fragments.

Traube, l.c., No. 320; E. Chatelain, *Uncialis scriptura*, pl. IV, 2; C. Cipolla, *Codici Bobbiesi*, pl. XIII; Ehrle-Liebaert, *Specimina codicum latinorum Vaticanorum*, pl. 5d.

7. Turin, G. V. 37.—Cyprian, de opere et eleemosynis.

Traube, l.c., No. 323; Carta, Cipolla e Frati, *Monumenta palaeographica sacra*, pl. V, 1; Cipolla, *Codici Bobbiesi*, pl. XII.

8. Oxford, Bodleian Auct. T. 2. 26.—Eusebius-Hieronymus, Chronicle, post a. 442.

Traube, l.c., No. 164; see above, [p. 16](#), no. 2.

9. Petrograd Q. v. I. 3 (Corbie).—Varia of St. Augustine.

Traube, l.c., No. 140; E. Chatelain, *Uncialis scriptura*, pl. III; A. Staerk, *Les manuscrits latins du V^e au XIII^e siècle conservés à la bibliothèque impériale de Saint Petersburg* (St. Petersburg 1910), Vol. II. pl. 2.

10. St. Gall, 1394.—Gospels (n).

Traube, l.c., No. 60; *Old Latin Biblical Texts*, Vol. II, Oxford 1886; *Palaeographical Society*, II. pl. 50; Steffens¹, pl. 15; E. Chatelain, *Uncialis scriptura*, pl. I, 1; A. Chroust, *Monumenta Palaeographica*, XVII, pl. 3.

Characteristics of the oldest uncial manuscripts The main characteristics of the manuscripts included in the above list, which is by no means complete, may briefly be described thus:

1. General effect of compactness. This is the result of *scriptura continua*, which knows no separation of words and no punctuation. See the facsimiles cited above.

2. Precision in the mode of shading. The alternation of stressed and unstressed strokes is very regular. The two arcs of  are shaded not in the middle, as in Greek uncials, but in the lower left and upper right parts of the letter, so that the space enclosed by the two arcs resembles an ellipse leaning to the left at an angle of about 45°, thus

. What is true of the  is true of other curved strokes. The strokes are often very short, mere touches of pen to parchment, like brush work. Often they are unconnected, thus giving a mere

suggestion of the form. The attack or fore-stroke as well as the finishing stroke is a very fine, oblique hair-line.³⁰

3. Absence of long ascending or descending strokes. The letters lie virtually between two lines (instead of between four as in later

uncials), the upper and lower shafts of letters like



4. The broadness of the letters



5. The relative narrowness of the letters



6. The manner of forming



B with the lower bow considerably larger than the upper, which often has the form of a mere comma.

E with the tongue or horizontal stroke placed not in the middle, as in later uncial manuscripts, but high above it, and extending beyond the upper curve. The loop is often left open.

L with very small base.

M with the initial stroke tending to be a straight line instead of the well-rounded bow of later uncials.

N with the oblique connecting stroke shaded.

P with the loop very small and often open.

S with a rather longish form and shallow curves, as compared with the broad form and ample curves of later uncials.

T with a very small, sinuous horizontal top stroke (except at the beginning of a line when it often has an exaggerated extension to the left).

7. Extreme fineness of parchment, at least in parts of the manuscript.
8. Perforation of parchment along furrows made by the pen.
9. Quires signed by means of roman numerals often preceded by the letter Q· (= Quaternio) in the lower right corner of the last page of each gathering.
10. Running titles, in abbreviated form, usually in smaller uncials than the text.
11. Colophons, in which red and black ink alternate, usually in large-sized uncials.
12. Use of a capital, *i.e.*, a larger-sized letter at the beginning of each page or of each column in the page, even if the beginning falls in the middle of a word.
13. Lack of all but the simplest ornamentation, *e.g.*, scroll or ivy-leaf.
14. The restricted use of abbreviations. Besides B· and Q· and such suspensions as occur in classical inscriptions only the contracted forms of the *Nomina Sacra* are found.
15. Omission of *M* and *N* allowed only at the end of a line, the omission being marked by means of a simple horizontal line (somewhat hooked at each end) placed above the line after the final vowel and not directly over it as in later uncial manuscripts.
16. Absence of nearly all punctuation.

17. The use of  in the text where an omission has occurred, and  after the supplied omission in the lower margin, or the same symbols reversed if the supplement is entered in the upper margin.

If we now turn to the Morgan Pliny we observe that it lacks a number of the characteristics enumerated above as belonging to the oldest type of uncial manuscripts. The parchment is not of the very thin sort. There has been no corrosion along the furrows made by the pen. The running title and colophons are in rustic capitals, not in uncials. The manner of forming such

letters as **B E M R S T** differs from that employed in the oldest group.

B with the lower bow not so markedly larger than the upper.

E with the horizontal stroke placed nearer the middle.

M with the left bow tending to become a distinct curve.

R S T have gained in breadth and proportionately lost in height.

Date of the Morgan manuscript Inasmuch as these palaeographical differences mark a tendency which reaches fuller development in later uncial manuscripts, it is clear that their presence in our manuscript is a sign of its more recent character as compared with manuscripts of the oldest type. Just as our manuscript is clearly older than the Codex Fuldensis of about the year 546, so it is clearly more recent than the Berlin *Computus Paschalis* of about the year 447. Its proper place is at the end of the oldest series of uncial manuscripts, which begins with the Cicero palimpsest. Its closest neighbors are, I believe, the Pliny palimpsest of St. Paul in Carinthia and the *Codex Theodosianus* of Turin. If we conclude by saying that the Morgan manuscript was written about the year 500 we shall probably not be far from the truth.

Later history of the Morgan manuscript The vicissitudes of a manuscript often throw light upon the history of the text contained in the manuscript. And the palaeographer knows that any scratch or scribbling, any *probatio pennae* or casual entry, may become important in tracing the wanderings of a manuscript.

In the six leaves that have been saved of our Morgan manuscript we have two entries. One is of a neutral character and does not take us further, but the other is very clear and tells an unequivocal story.

The unimportant entry occurs in the lower margin of folio 53^r. The words “*uir erat in terra*,” which are apparently the beginning of the book of Job, are written in Carolingian characters of the ninth century. As these characters were used during the ninth century in northern Italy as well as in France, it is impossible to say where this entry was made. If in France, then the manuscript of Pliny must have left its Italian home before the ninth century.^{[31](#)}

That it had crossed the Alps by the beginning of the fifteenth century we know from the second entry. Nay, we learn more precise details. We learn that our manuscript had found a home in France, in the town of Meaux or its vicinity. The entry is found in the upper margin of fol. 51^r and doubtless represents a *probatio penna* on the part of a notary. It runs thus:

“A tous ceulz qui ces presentes lettres verront et orront
Jehan de Sannemeres garde du scel de la provoste de
Meaulx & Francois Beloy clerc Jure de *par* le Roy
nostre sire a ce faire Salut sachient tuit que *par*.”

The above note is made in the regular French notarial hand of the fourteenth and fifteenth centuries.^{[32](#)} The formula of greeting with which the document opens is in the precise form in which it occurs in numberless charters of the period. All efforts to identify Jehan de Sannemeres, keeper of the seal of the *provosté* of Meaux, and François Beloy, sworn clerk in behalf of the King, have so far proved fruitless.^{[33](#)}

Conclusion Our manuscript, then, was written in Italy about the year 500. It is quite possible that it had crossed the Alps by the ninth century or even before. It is certain that by the fifteenth century it had found asylum in France. When and under what circumstances it got back to Italy will be shown by Professor Rand in the pages that follow.

So it is France that has saved this, the oldest extant witness of Pliny's *Letters*, for modern times. To mediaeval France we are, in fact, indebted for the preservation of more than one ancient classical manuscript. The oldest manuscript of the third decade of Livy was at Corbie in Charlemagne's time, when it was loaned to Tours and a copy of it made there. Both copy and original have come down to us. Sallust's *Histories* were saved (though not in complete form) for our generation by the Abbey of Fleury. The famous Schedae Vergiliana, in square capitals, as well as the Codex Romanus of Virgil, in rustic capitals, belonged to the monastery of St. Denis. Lyons preserved the *Codex Theodosianus*. It was again some French centre that rescued Pomponius Mela from destruction. The oldest fragments of Ovid's *Pontica*, the oldest fragments of the first decade of Livy, the oldest manuscript of Pliny's *Natural History*—all palimpsests—were in some French centre in the Middle Ages, as may be seen from the indisputably eighth-century French writing which covers the ancient texts. The student of Latin literature knows that the manuscript tradition of Lucretius, Suetonius, Cæsar, Catullus, Tibullus, and Propertius—to mention only the greatest names—shows that we are indebted primarily to Gallia Christiana for the preservation of these authors.

NOTES TO PART I

⁴ [1](#). For example, in the fifth-century manuscript of Livy in Paris (MS. lat. 5730) the forty-third and forty-fifth quires are composed of six leaves, while the rest are all quires of eight.

[2](#). In an examination of all the uncial manuscripts in the Bibliothèque Nationale of Paris, it was found that out of twenty manuscripts that may be ascribed to the fifth and sixth centuries only two had the hair side on the outside of the quires. Out of thirty written approximately between A.D. 600 and 800, about half showed the same practice, the other half having the hair side outside. Thus the practice of our oldest Latin scribes agrees with that of the Greek: see C. R. Gregory, "Les cahiers des manuscrits grecs" in *Comptes Rendus de l'Academie des Inscriptions et Belles-Lettres* (1885), p. 261. I am informed by Professor

Hyvernât, of the Catholic University of Washington, that the same custom is observed by Coptic scribes.

⁵ [3](#). The confused arrangement of the indices for Books I and II in the Codex Bellovacensis may well have been found in the manuscript of which the Morgan fragment is a part. The space required for the indices, however, would not have greatly differed from that taken by the index of Book III in both the Morgan fragment and the Codex Bellovacensis.

⁶ [4](#). Many of our oldest Latin manuscripts have two and even three columns on a page, a practice evidently taken over from the roll. But very ancient manuscripts are not wanting which are written in long lines, *e.g.*, the Codex Vindobonensis of Livy, the Codex Bobiensis of the Gospels, or the manuscript of Pliny's *Natural History* preserved at St. Paul in Carinthia.

[5](#). This is an ear-mark of great antiquity. It is found, for example, in the Berlin and Vatican Schedae Vergilianae in square capitals (Berlin lat. 2^o 416 and Rome Vatic. lat. 3256 reproduced in Zangemeister and Wattenbach's *Exempla Codicum Latinorum*, etc., pl. 14, and in Steffens, *Lateinische Paläographie*², pl. 12b), in the Vienna, Paris, and Lateran manuscripts of Livy, in the Codex Corbeiensis of the Gospels, and here and there in the palimpsest manuscript of Cicero's *De Re Publica* and in other manuscripts.

[6](#). In many of our oldest manuscripts uncials are employed. The Pliny palimpsest of St. Paul in Carinthia agrees with our manuscript in using rustic capitals. For facsimiles see J. Sillig, *C. Plini Secundi Naturalis Historiae*, Libri XXXVI, Vol. VI, Gotha 1855, and Chatelain, *Paléographie des Classiques Latins*, pl. CXXXVI.

⁷ [7](#). In this respect, too, the Pliny palimpsest of St. Paul in Carinthia agrees with our fragment. Most of the oldest manuscripts, however, have the colophon in the same type of writing as the text.

8. This is also the case in the Paris manuscript of Livy of the fifth century, in the Codex Bezae of the Gospels (published in facsimile by the University of Cambridge in 1899), in the Pliny palimpsest of St. Paul in Carinthia, and in many other manuscripts of the oldest type.

9. The strokes over the two consecutive *i*'s on fol. 53^v, l. 23, were made by a hand that can hardly be older than the thirteenth century.

10. I venture to read *dominus meus ... in te deus*.

11. This doubtless stands for *Quaere* (= "investigate"), a frequent marginal note in manuscripts of all ages. A number of instances of *Q* for *quaere* are given by A. C. Clark, *The Descent of Manuscripts*, Oxford 1918, p. 35.

⁸ 12. Such a division as *ut|or* on fol. 7, l. 10, is due entirely to thoughtless copying. The scribe probably took *ut* for a word.

13. For further details on syllabification in our oldest Latin manuscripts, see Th. Mommsen, "Livii Codex Veronensis," in *Abhandlungen der k. Akad. d. Wiss. zu Berlin, phil. hist. Cl.* (1868), p. 163, n. 2, and pp. 165-6; Mommsen-Studemund, *Analecta Liviana* (Leipsic 1873), p. 3; Brandt, "Der St. Galler Palimpsest," in *Sitzungsberichte der phil. hist. Cl. der k. Akad. der Wiss. in Wien*, CVIII (1885), pp. 245-6; L. Traube, "Palaeographische Forschungen IV," in *Abhandlungen d. h. t. Cl. d. k. Bayer. Akad. d. Wiss.* XXIV. 1 (1906), p. 27; A. W. Van Buren, "The Palimpsest of Cicero's *De Re Publica*," in *Archaeological Institute of America, Supplementary Papers of the American School of Classical Studies in Rome*, ii (1908), pp. 89 sqq.; C. Wessely, in his preface to the facsimile edition of the Vienna Livy (MS. lat. 15), published in the Leyden series, *Codices graeci et latini*, etc., T. XI. See also W. G. Hale, "Syllabification in Roman speech," in *Harvard Studies of Classical Philology*, VII (1896), pp. 249-71, and W. Dennison, "Syllabification in Latin Inscriptions," in *Classical Philology*, I (1906), pp. 47-68.

¹⁰ [14](#). That is, manuscripts written before the eighth century. The number of abbreviations increases considerably during the eighth century. Previously the only symbols found in calligraphic majuscule manuscripts are the “Nomina Sacra” (*deus, dominus, Iesus, Christus, spiritus, sanctus*), which constantly occur in Christian literature, and such suspensions as are met with in our fragment. A familiar exception is the manuscript of Gaius, preserved in the Chapter library of Verona, MS. xv (13). This is full of abbreviations not found in contemporary manuscripts containing purely literary or religious texts. Cf. W. Studemund, *Gaii Institutionum Commentarii Quattuor*, etc., Leipsic 1874; and F. Steffens, *Lateinische Paläographie*², pl. 18 (pl. 8 of the Supplement). The Oxyrhynchus papyrus of Cicero’s speeches is non-calligraphic and therefore not subject to the rule governing calligraphic products. The same is true of marginal notes to calligraphic texts. See W. M. Lindsay, *Notae Latinae*, Cambridge 1915, pp. 1-2.

[15](#). Found only at the end of words in our fragment. Its use in the body of a word is, however, very ancient.

[16](#). The C invariably has the two dots as well as the superior horizontal stroke.

[17](#). The abbreviation is indicated by a stroke above the letters as well as by a dot after them.

¹¹ [18](#). An ancestor of our manuscript must have had TRANQ·, which was wrongly expanded to TRANQUE.

[19](#). This is a sign of antiquity. After the sixth century the *M* or *N* stroke is usually placed above the vowel. The practice of confining the omission of *M* or *N* to the end of a line is a characteristic of our very oldest manuscripts. Later manuscripts omit *M* or *N* in the middle of a line and in the middle of a word. No distinction is made in our manuscript between omitted *M* and omitted *N*. Some ancient manuscripts make a distinction. Cf. Traube, *Nomina Sacra*, pp. 179, 181, 183, 185, final column of each page; and W. M. Lindsay, *Notae Latinae*, pp. 342 and 345.

[20.](#) The fraudulent character of the alleged discovery was exposed in masterly fashion by Ludwig Traube in his “Palaeographische Forschungen IV,” published in the *Abhandlungen der K. Bayerischen Akademie der Wissenschaften*, III Klasse, XXIV Band, 1 Abteilung, Munich 1904.

[21.](#) Cf. E. T. Merrill, “On the use by Aldus of his manuscripts of Pliny’s *Letters*,” in *Classical Philology*, XIV (1919), p. 34.

[22.](#) That the hair side of the vellum retained the ink better than the flesh side may be seen from an examination of facsimiles in the Leyden series *Codices graeci et latini photographice depicti*.

¹² [23.](#) That the ink could scale off the flesh side of the vellum in less than three centuries is proved by the condition of the famous Tacitus manuscript in Beneventan script in the Laurentian Library. It was written in the eleventh century and shows retouched characters of the thirteenth. See foll. 102, 103 in the facsimile edition in the Leyden series mentioned in the previous note.

[24.](#) On the subject of omissions and the clues they often furnish, see the exhaustive treatise by A. C. Clark entitled *The Descent of Manuscripts*, Oxford 1918.

¹³ [25.](#) Our scribe’s method is as patient as it is unreflecting. Apparently he does not commit to memory small intelligible units of text, but is copying word for word, or in some places even letter for letter.

¹⁴ [26.](#) See below, [p. 16](#).

[27.](#) See below, [p. 16](#).

¹⁵ [28.](#) See below, [p. 16](#).

¹⁶ [29.](#) For the pertinent literature on the manuscripts in the following list the student is referred to Traube’s *Vorlesungen und Abhandlungen*, Vol. I, pp. 171-261, Munich 1909, and the index in Vol. III, Munich 1920. The chief works of facsimiles referred to below are: Zangemeister and Wattenbach, *Exempla codicum latinorum litteris maiusculis scriptorum*, Heidelberg 1876 &

1879; E. Chatelain, *Paléographie des classiques latins*, Paris 1884-1900, and *Uncialis scriptura codicum latinorum novis exemplis illustrata*, Paris 1901-2; and Steffens, *Lateinische Paläographie*², Treves 1907. (Second edition in French appeared in 1910.)

¹⁹ [30](#). In later uncials the fore-stroke is often a horizontal hair-line.

²¹ [31](#). This supposition will be strengthened by Professor Rand; see [p. 53](#).

[32](#). Compare, for example, the facsimile of a French deed of sale at Roye, November 24, 1433, reproduced in *Recueil de Facsimilés à l'usage de l'école des chartes*. Premier fascicule (Paris 1880), No. 1.

[33](#). No mention of either of these is to be found in Dom Toussaints du Plessis' *Histoire de l'église de Meaux*. For documents with similar opening formulas, see *ibid.* vol. ii (Paris 1731), pp. 191, 258, 269, 273.

[TRANSCRIPTION]*

* The original manuscript is in *scriptura continua*. For the reader's convenience, words have been separated and punctuation added in the transcription.

In a few places the transcribers used V in place of U. This appears to be an error, but has not been changed.

[folio 48^r](#)

[folio 48^v](#)

[folio 49^r](#)

[folio 49^v](#)

[folio 50^r](#)

[folio 50^v](#)

[folio 51^r](#)

[folio 52^r](#)

[folio 53^r](#)

[folio 51^v](#)

[folio 52^v](#)

[folio 53^v](#)

LIBER · II ·

CESSIT UT IPSE MIHI DIXERIT CUM CON
SULERET QUAM CITO SESTERTIUM SESEN
TIES INPLETURUS ESSET INUENISSE SE EX
TA DUPLICATA QUIBUS PORTENDI MI^LLIES¹
ET
DUCENTIES HABITURUM ET HABEBIT SI
MODO UT COEPIT ALIENA TESTAMENTA
QUOD EST IMPROBISSIMUM GENUS FAL
SI IPSIS QUORUM SUNT ILLA DICTAUERIT
UALE

1. *L* added by a hand which seems contemporary, if not the scribe's own. If the scribe's, he used a finer pen for corrections.

2. C · PLINI · SECUNDI

2-2 The colophon is written in rustic capitals, the middle line being in red.

EPISTULARUM · *EXPLICIT* ·
LIBER · II.

· INCIPIT · LIBER · III ·
FELICITER²

*AD CALPURNIUM RUFUM*¹
5 NESCIO AN ULLUM

1. On this and the following page lines in red alternate

AD UIBIUM · MAXIMUM
 QUOD · IPSE AMICIS TUIS
 AD CAERELLIAE HISPULLAE²
 CUM PATREM TUUM
 10 AD CAE^{CI}LIUM³ MACRINUM
 QUAMUIS ET AMICI
 AD BAEBIUM MACRUM
 PERGRATUM EST MIHI
 4AD ANNIUM⁴ SEUERUM
 15 4EX HEREDITATE⁴ QUAE
 AD CANINIUM RUFUM
 MODO NUNTIATUS EST
 AD SUETON⁵ TRANQUE
 FACIS AD PRO CETERA
 20 AD CORNELIUM⁶ MINICIANUM
 POSSUM IAM PERSCRIB
 AD UESTRIC SPURINN ·
 COMPOSUISSE ME QUAED

with lines in black. The first line is in red.

2. The *h* seems written over an erasure.

3. *ci* above the line by first hand.

4-4 Over an erasure apparently.

5. *t* over an erasure.

6. *c* over an erasure.

AD IULIUM GENITOR ·
 5 EST OMNINO ARTEMIDORI
 AD CATILINUM SEUER ·
 UENIAM AD CENAM
 AD UOCONIUM ROMANUM
 LIBRUM QUO NUPER
 10 AD PATILIUM
 REM ATROCEM
 AD SILIUM PROCUL ·
 PETIS UT LIBELLOS TUOS
 AD NEPOTEM ADNOTASSE UIDEOR FATA DICTAQUE.¹
 AD IULIUM SERUIAN ·²
 15 RECTE OMNIA
 AD UIRIUM SEUERUM

1. Added interlineally, in black, by first hand using a finer pen.

2. This is followed by an

OFFICIUM CONSULATUS
AD CALUISIUM RUFUM ·
ADSUMO TE IN CONSILIUM
20 AD MAESIUM MAXIMUM
MEMINISTINE TE
AD CORNELIUM PRISCUM
AUDIO VALERIUM MARTIUM ·

erasure of the letters *um* in red.

· EPISTULARUM ·

· C · PLINIUS · CALUISIO SUO SALUTEM

NESCIO AN ULLUM IUCUNDIUS TEMPUS
EXEGERIM QUAM QUO NUPER APUD SPURIN-
NAM FUI ADEO QUIDEM UT NEMINEM
5 MAGIS IN SENECTUTE SI MODO SENESCE-
RE DATUM EST AEMULARI UELIM NIHIL
EST ENIM ILLO UITAE GENERE DISTIN-
CTIUS ME AUTEM UT CERTUS SIDERUM
CURSUS ITA UITA HOMINUM DISPOSITA
10 DELECTAT SENUM PRAESERTIM NAM
IUVENES ADHUC CONFUSA QUAEDAM
ET QUASI TURBATA NON INDECENT SE-
NIBUS PLACIDA OMNIA ET OR^{DI}NATA¹ CON-
UENIUNT QUIBUS INDUSTRIA
SER^UA¹TURPIS
15 AMBITIO EST HANC REGULAM SPURIN-
NA CONSTANTISSIME SERUAT · QUIN ETIAM
PARUA HAEC PARUA · SI NON COTIDIE
FIANT
ORDINE QUODAM ET UELUT ORBE CIRCUM
AGIT MANE LECTULO² CONTINETUR HORA
20 SECUNDA CALCEOS POSCIT AMBULAT MI-
LIA PASSUUM TRIA NEC MINUS ANIMUM

1. Letters above the line were added by first or contemporary hand.

2. *u* corrected to *e*.

QUAM CORPUS EXERCET SI ADSUNT AMICI
HONESTISSIMI SERMONES EXPLICANTUR
SI NON LIBER LEGITUR INTERDUM ETIAM
PRAE

25 SENTIBUS AMICIS SI TAMEN ILLI NON
GRAUAN

TUR DEINDE CONSIDIT³ ET LIBER RURSUS
AUT SERMO LIBRO POTIOR · MOX
UEHICULUM

3. Second *i* corrected to *e*
(not the regular uncial form)
apparently by the first or
contemporary hand.

· LIBER · III ·

ASCENDIT ADSUMIT UXOREM SINGU
LARIS EXEMPLI UEL ALIQUEM AMICORUM
UT ME PROXIME QUAM PULCHRUM ILLUD
QUAM DULCE SECRETUM QUANTUM IBI AN
5 TIQUITATIS QUAE FACTA QUOS UIROS AU
DIAS QUIBUS PRAECEPTIS IMBUARE
QUAMUIS

ILLE HOC TEMPERAMENTUM MODESTIAE
SUAE INDIXERIT NE PRAECIPE REUIDEATUR
PERACTIS SEPTEM MILIBUS PASSUUM ITE
10 RUM AMBULAT MILLE ITERUM RESIDIT
UEL SE CUBICULO AC STILO REDDIT SCRI
BIT ENIM ET QUIDEM UTRAQUE LINGUA LY
RICA DOCTISSIMA MIRA ILLIS DULCEDO

MIRA SUAUITAS MIRA HILARITATIS¹ CUIUS
15 GRATIAM CUMULAT SANCTITATIS² SCRI
BENTIS UBI HORA BALNEI NUNTIATA EST
EST AUTEM HIEME NONA · AESTATE OCTA
UA IN SOLE SI CARET UENTO AMBULAT
NUDUS DEINDE MOUETUR PILA UEHE
20 MENTER ET DIU NAM HOC QUOQUE EXER

1. The scribe first wrote
hilaritatis. To correct the
error he or a contemporary
hand placed dots above the *t*
and *i* and drew a horizontal
line through them to indicate
that they should be omitted.

CITATIONIS GENERE PUGNAT CUM SE
NECTUTE LOTUS ACCUBAT ET PAULIS
PER CIBUM DIFFERT INTERIM AUDIT LE
GENTEM REMISSIUS ALIQUID ET DULCIUS
25 PER HOC OMNE TEMPUS LIBERUM EST
AMICIS UEL EADEM FACERE UEL ALIA
SI MALINT ADPON^ITUR³ CENA NON MINUS

This is the usual method in very old manuscripts.
2. *sanctitatis* is corrected to *sanctitas* in the manner described in the preceding note.
3. *i* added above the line, apparently by first hand.

· EPISTULARUM ·

NITIDA QUAM FRUGI IN ARGENTO PURO
ET
ANTIQUO SUNT IN USU ET C^HORINTHIA¹
QUIBUS DE
LECTATUR ET ADFICITUR FREQUENTER CO
MOEDIS CENA DISTINGUITUR UT UOLUPTA
5 TES QUOQUE STUDIIS CONDIANTUR SUMIT
ALI
QUID DE NOCTE ET AESTATE NEMI^{NI1} HOC
LON
GUM EST TANTA COMITATE CONUIUIUM
TRAHITUR INDE ILLI POST SEPTIMUM ET
SEPTUAGENSIMUM ANNUM AURIUM
10 OCULORUM UIGOR INTEGER INDE AGILE
ET UIUIDUM CORPUS SOLAQUE EX SENEC
TUTE PRUDENTIA HANC EGO UITAM UO
TO ET COGITATIONE PRAESUMO INGRES
SURUS AUIDISSIME UT PRIMUM RATIO AE
15 TATIS RECEPTUI CANERE PERMISERIT² IN
TERIM MILLE LABORIBUS CONTEROR QUI
HO
RUM MIHI ET SOLACIUM ET EXEMPLUM

1. The letters above the line are additions by the first, or by another contemporary, hand.

2. *permiserit*: *t* stands over an erasure, and original *it* seems to be corrected to *et*, with *e* having the rustic form.

EST IDEM SPURINNA NAM ILLE QUOQUE
QUOAD HONESTUM FUIT OB^IIT¹ OFFICIA
20 GESSIT MAGISTRATUS PROVINCIAS RE
XIT MULTOQ^{UE} LABORE HOC OTIUM ME
RUIT IGITUR EUNDEM MIHI CURSUM EUN
DEM TERMINUM STATUO IDQUE IAM NUNC
APUD TE SUBSIGNO UT SI ME LONGIUS SE
25 EUEHI³ UIDERIS IN IUS UOCES AD HANC
EPIS
TULAM MEAM ET QUIESCERE IUBEAS CUM
INERTIAE CRIMEN EFFUGERO UALE⁴.

3. The scribe first wrote *longius se uehi*. The *e* which precedes *uehi* was added by him when he later corrected the page and deleted *se*.

4. *uale*: The abbreviation is marked by a stroke above as well as by a dot after the word.

· LIBER · III ·

*A tout ceulz qui ces presentes lettres verront et orront
Jehan de sannemeres garde du scel de la provoste de
Meaulx & francois Beloy clerc Jure de par le Roy
nostre sire a ce faire Salut sachient tuit que par.*¹

· **C** · PLINIUS · MAXIMO SUO SALUTEM
QUOD IPSE AMICIS TUIS OPTULISSEM · SI MI
HI EADEM MATERIA SUPPETERET ID NUNC
IURE UIDEOR A TE MEIS PETITURUS ARRIA
5 NUS MATURUS ALTINATIUM EST PRINCEPS
CUM DICO PRINCEPS NON DE FACULTATI
BUS LOQUOR QUAE ILLI LARGE SUPER
SUNT SED DE CASTITATE IUSTITIA GRA
UITATE PRUDENTIA HUIOS EGO CONSI
10 LIO IN NEGOTIIS IUDICIO IN STUDIIS UT

1. A fifteenth-century addition, see above, [p. 21](#).

OR NAM PLURIMUM FIDE PLURIMUM
 VERITATE PLURIMUM INTELLEGENCIA
 PRAESTAT AMAT ME NIHIL POSSUM AR
 DENTIOUS DICERE UT TU KARET AMBITUI²
 15 IDEO SE IN EQUESTRI GRADU TENUIT
 CUM
 FACILE POSSIT³ ASCENDERE ALTISSIMUM
 MIHI TAMEN ORNANDUS EXCOLENDUS
 QUE EST ITAQUE MAGNI AESTIMO
 DIGNITATI
 EIUS ALIQUID ADSTRUERE INOPINANTIS
 20 NESCIENTIS IMMO ETIAM FORTASSE
 NOLENTIS ADSTRUERE AUTEM QUOD SIT
 SPLENDIDUM NEC MOLESTUM CUIUS
 GENERIS QUAE PRIMA OCCASIO TIBI CON
 FERAS IN EUM ROGO HABEBIS ME HABE
 25 BIS IPSUM GRATISSIMUM DEBITOREM
 QUAMUIS ENIM ISTA NON ADPETAT TAM
 GRATE TAMEN EXCIPIT QUAM SI CONCU

2. The scribe originally divided *i-deo* between two lines. On correcting the page he (or a contemporary corrector) cancelled the *i* at the end of the line and added it before the next.

3. *i* changed to *e* (not the uncial form) possibly by the original hand in correcting.

· EPISTULARUM ·

PISCAT · UALE

· C · PLINIUS · CORELLIAE · SALUTEM ·

CUM PATREM TUUM GRAUISSIMUM ET
 SAN
 CTISSIMUM UIRUM SUSPEXERIM MAGIS
 5 AN AMAUERIM DUBITEM TEQUE IN MEMO
 RIAM EIUS ET IN HONOREM TUUM
 I^UNU^ICE¹ DILIGAM CUPIAM NECESSE EST
 ATQUE ETIAM

1. *inuice*: corrected to *unice* by cancelling *i* and *ui* (the cancellation stroke is barely

QUANTUM IN ME FUERIT ENITAR UT FILIUS
 TUUS AUO SIMILIS EXSISTAT EQUIDEM
 10 MALO MATERNO QUAMQ^UAM² ILLI
 PATER
 NUS ETIAM CLARUS SPECTATUS^{QUE}³
 CONTIGE
 RIT PATER QUOQUE ET PATRUUS INLUSTRI
 LAU
 DE CONSPICUI QUIBUS OMNIBUS ITA
 DEMUM
 SIMILIS ADOLESCET SIBI INBUTUS HONES
 15 TIS ARTIBUS FUERIT QUAS PLURIMUM
 REFER⁴
 RÂT⁵ A QUO POTISSIMUM ACCIPIAT ADHUC
 ILLUM PUERITIAE RATIO INTRA CONTUBER
 NIUM TUUM TENUIT PRAECEPTORES DOMI
 HABUIT UBI EST ERRORIBUS MODICA
 U^ELST⁶ ETIAM
 20 NULLA MATERIA IAM STUDIA EIUS
 EXTRA
 LIMEN CONFERANDA SUNT IAM CIRCUMSPI
 CIENDUS RHETOR LATINUS CUIUS SCHO
 LAE SEUERITAS PUDOR INPRIMIS CASTITAS
 CONSTET ADEST ENIM ADULESCENTI NOS
 25 TRO CUM CETERIS NATURAE
 FORTUNAEQUE
 DOTIBUS EXIMIA CORPORIS PULC^HRITUDO⁷
 CUI IN HOC LUBRICO AETATIS NON PRAECEP

visible) and writing *u* and *i* above the line. The correction is by a somewhat later hand.

2. *u* above the line is by the first hand.

3. *q·* above the line is added by a somewhat later hand.

4. Final *r* is added by a somewhat later hand.

5. The dots above *ra* indicate deletion. The cancellation stroke is oblique.

6. A somewhat later corrector, possibly contemporary, changed *est* to *uel* by adding *u* before *e* and *l* above *s* and cancelling both *s* and *t*.

7. *h* added above the line by a hand which may be contemporary.

· LIBER · III ·

TOR MODO SED CUSTOS ETIAM

RECTORQUE

QUAERENDUS EST UIDEOR ERGO DEMON
STRARE TIBI POSSE IULIUM GEN^ITIOREM¹
AM^NATUR² A ME I^UDICIO³ TAMEN MEO NON
5 OBSTAT KARITAS HOMINIS QUAE^{EX}⁴IUDI
CIO NATA EST UIR EST EMENDATUS ET GRA
UIS PAULO ETIAM HORRIDIOR ET DURIOR
UT IN HAC LICENTIA TEMPORUM QUAN
TUM ELOQUENTIA UALEAT PLURIBUS CRE
10 DERE POTES NAM DICENDI FACULTAS
APERTA ET EXPOSITA · STATIM CERNITUR
UITA HOMINUM ALTOS RECESSUS MAG
NASQUE LATEBRAS HABET CUIUS PRO GE
NITORE ME SPONSOREM ACCIPE NIHIL
15 EX HOC UIRO FILIUS TUUS AUDIET NISI
PROFUTURUM NIHIL DISCET QUOD NESCIS⁵
SE RECTIUS FUERIT NE^C⁶ MINUS SAEPE AB
ILLO QUAM A TE MEQUE ADMONEBITUR
QUIBUS IMAGINIBUS ONERETUR QUAE NOMI
20 NA ET QUANTA SUSTINEAT PROINDE
FAUEN
TIBUS DIIS TRADE^EUM⁷ PRAECEPTORI A
QUO MORES PRIMUM MOX ELOQUENTIAM
DISCAT QUAE MALE SINE MORIBUS DIS
CITUR UALE

25 ·C· PLINIUS MACRINO SALUTEM

QUAMUIS ET AMICI QUOS PRAESENTES
HABEBAM ET SERMONES HOMINUM

1. The scribe wrote *gentiorem*: a somewhat later corrector changed it to *genitorem* by adding an *i* above the line between *n* and *t* and cancelled the *i* after *t*.
2. Above the *m* a somewhat later hand wrote *n*. It was cancelled by a crude modern hand using lead.
3. *u* added above the line by the later hand.
4. *ex* added above the line by the later corrector.
5. *cis* is added in the margin by the later hand. The original scribe wrote *nes* | *se*.
6. *c* is added above the line by the later hand.

7. *e* added above the line.

F ACTUM MEUM COMPROUASSE UIDEAN
TUR MAGNI TAMEN AESTIMO SCIRE QUID
SENTIAS TU NAM CUIUS INTEGRA RE CON
SILIUM EXQUIRERE O^PTASSEM¹ HUIUS
ETIAM

5 PERACTA IUDICIÀUM² NOSSE MIRE CONCU
PISCO CUM PUBLICUM OPUS MEA PECU
NIA INCHOATURUS IN TUSCOS EXCUCURISSEM AC

AEFECTUS AERARI

CEPTO UT PR COMMEATU³ LEGATI PROVINCIAE
BAETICAE QUESTURI DE PROCONSULATU⁴
10 CAECILII CLASSICI ADVOCATUM ME A SE
NATU PETIERUNT COLLEGAE OPTIMI
MEIQUE

AMANTISSIMI DE COMMUNIS OFFICII NE
CESSITATIBUS PRAELOCUTI EXCUSARE
ME ET EXIMERE TEMPTARUNT FACTUM
15 TÛM⁵ EST SENATUS CONSULTUM
PERQUAM

HONORIFICUM UT DARE^{R6} PROVINCIALIBUS
PATRONUS SI AB IPSO ME IMPETRASSENT
LEGATI RURSUS INDUCTI ITERUM ME IAM

PRAESENTEM ADUOCATUM POST^ULAUE⁷ 20
RUNT INPLORANTES FIDEM MEAM
QUAM ESSENT CONTRA MASSAM BAE
BIUM EXPERTI ADLEGANTES PATRO^CINI⁸
FOEDUS SECUTA EST SENATUS CLARIS
SIMA ADSENSIO QUAE SOLET DECRETA
25 PRAECURRERE TUM EGO DESINO IN

1. *p* added above the line by the scribe.

2. The superfluous *a* is cancelled by means of a dot above the letter.

3. The scribe originally wrote *excucuris* | *sem commeatu*, omitting *accepto ut praefectus aerari*. Noticing his error, he erased *sem* and wrote it at the end of the preceding line, and added the omitted words over the erasure and the word *commeatu*.

4. The dot over *s* indicates deletion.

5. *tum*: error due to diplography. The correction is made by means of dots and crossing out.

6. *r* added by the scribe.

7. *u* added apparently by a contemporary hand.

8. *c* added above the line, apparently by a contemporary hand.

QUAM P. C. PUTARE ME IUSTAS EXCUSA
TIONIS CAUSAS ADTULISSE PLACUIT ET

· LIBER · III ·

MODESTIA SERMONIS ET RATIO COM
PULIT AUTEM ME AD HOC CONSILIUM NON
SOLUM CONSENSUS SENATUS QUAMQUAM
HIC MAXIME UERUM ET ALII QUIDEM
5 MINORIS SED TAMEN NUMERI UENI
EBAT IN MENTEM PRIORES NOSTROS
ETIAM SINGULORUM HOSPITIUM¹ INIU
RIAS ACCUSATIONIBUS UOLUNTARIIS EX
SECUTOS QUO DEFORMIUS ARBITRABAR

10 PUBLICI ^HOSPITII ^IURA² NEGLEGERE
PRAE
TEREA CUM RECORDARER QUANTA
PRO IISDEM BAETICIS PRIORE ADUOCA
TIONE ETIAM PERICULA SUBISSEM CON
SERVANDUM UETERIS OFFICII MERITUM
15 NOVO VIDEBATUR EST ENIM ITA COM
PARATUM UT ANTIQUIORA BENEFICIA SUB
UERTAS NISI ILLA POSTERIORIBUS CUMU
LES NAM QUAMLIBET SAEPE OBLIGA(N)³ TI
SIQUID⁴ UNUM NEGES HOC SOLUM
20 MEMINERUNT QUOD NEGATUM EST
DUCEBAR ETIAM QUOD DECESSERAT
CLASSICUS AMOTUMQUE ERAT QUOD
I⁵N EIUSMODI CAUSIS SOLET ESSE TRIS

1. Deletion of *i* before *u* is marked by a dot above the letter and a slanting stroke through it.

2. *h* and *i* above the line are apparently by the first hand.

3. *n* (in brackets) is a later addition.

4. The letters *uid* are plainly retraced by a later hand. The same hand retouched *neges h* in the same line.

5. *i* before *n* added by a later corrector who erased the *i*

ŢĪTISSIMUM⁶ PERICULUM SENATORIS
25 UIDEBAM ERGO ADUOCATIONI MEAE
NON MINOREM GRATIAM QUAM SI
UIUERET ILLE PROPOSITAM INUIDIAM

which the scribe wrote after
quod, in the line above.

6. Superfluous *ti* cancelled
by means of dots and oblique
stroke.

*Uir erat in terra*⁷

7. Added by a Caroline hand
of the ninth century.

· EPISTULARUM ·

NULLAM IN SUMMA COMPUTABAM
SI MUNERE HOC TERTIO FUNGERE^{R1} FACILI
OREM MIHI EXCUSATIONEM FORE SI
QUIS INCIDISSET QUEM NON DEBEREM
5 ACCUSARE NAM CUM EST OMNIUM OFFI
CIORUM FINIS ALIQUIS TUM OPTIME
LIBERTATI UENIA OBSEQUIO PRAEPARA
TUR AUDISTI CONSILII MEI MOTUS SUPER
EST ALTERUTRA EX PARTE IUDICIUM TUUM
10 IN QUO MIHI AEQUE IUCU^IND^A² ERIT SIM
PLICITAS DISSI^NTIENTIS³ QUAM COMPRO
BANTIS AUCTORITAS UALE

· **C̄** · PLINIUS MACRO · SUO · SALUTEM

PERGRATUM EST MIHI QUOD TAM DILIGEN
15 TER LIBROS AUONCULI MEI LECTITAS UT
HABERE OMNES UELIS QUAERASQUE QUI
SINT OMNES DĒFUNGAR⁴ INDICIS PARTIBUS
ATQUE ETIAM QUO SINT ORDINE SCRIPTI
NOTUM TIBI FACIAM EST ENIM HAEC

1. *r* added above the line by
the scribe or by a
contemporary hand.

2. *i* added above the second *u*
by the scribe or by a
contemporary hand.

3. The scribe wrote
dissitientis. A contemporary
hand changed the second *i* to
e and wrote an *n* above the *t*.

4. *de* is cancelled by means
of dots above the *d* and *e* and
oblique strokes drawn
through them.

20 QUOQUE STUDIOSIS NON INIUCUNDA
COG

NITIO DE IACULATIONE EQUESTRI UNUS ·
HUNC CUM PRAEFECTUS ALAE MILITA

RET· PARI⁵ INGENIO CURAQUE COMPOSUIT·
DE UITA POMPONI SECUNDI DUO A QUO
25 SINGULARITER AMATUS HOC MEMORIAE
AMICI QUASI DEBITUM MUNUS EXSOL
UIT · BELLORUM GERMANIAE UIGINTI
QUIBUS

5. The strokes over the *i* at the end of this word and at the beginning of the next were added by a corrector who can not be much older than the thirteenth century.



Part II.

THE TEXT OF THE MORGAN FRAGMENT

BY

E. K. RAND

THE MORGAN FRAGMENT AND ALDUS'S ANCIENT CODEX PARISINUS.¹

A *The Codex Parisinus* ALDUS MANUTIUS, in the preface to his edition of Pliny's *Letters*, printed at Venice in 1508, expresses his gratitude to Aloisio Mocenigo, Venetian ambassador in Paris, for bringing to Italy an exceptionally fine manuscript of the *Letters*; the book had been found not long before at or near Paris by the architect Fra Giocondo of Verona. The *editio princeps*, 1471, was based on a family of manuscripts that omitted Book VIII, called Book IX Book VIII, and did not contain Book X, the correspondence between Pliny and Trajan. Subsequent editions had only in part made good these deficiencies. More than a half of Book X, containing the letters numbered 41-121 in editions of our day, was published by Avantius in 1502 from a copy of the Paris manuscript made by Petrus Leander.² Aldus himself, two years before printing his edition, had received from Fra Giocondo a copy of the entire manuscript, with six other volumes, some of them printed editions which Giocondo had collated with manuscripts. Aldus, addressing Mocenigo, thus describes his acquisition:

“Deinde Iucundo Veronensi Viro singulari ingenio, ac bonarum
literarum studiosissimo, quod et easdem Secundi epistolas ab eo ipso
exemplari a se descriptas in Gallia diligenter ut facit omnia, et sex
alia uolumina epistolarum partim manu scripta, partim impressa
quidem, sed cum antiquis collata exemplaribus, ad me ipse sua
sponte, quae ipsius est ergo studiosos omneis beneuolentia,

adportauerit, idque biennio ante, quam tu ipsum mihi exemplar publicandum tradidisses.”

So now the ancient manuscript itself had come. Aldus emphasizes its value in supplying the defects of previous editions. The *Letters* will now include, he declares:

“multae non ante impressae. Tum Graeca correcta, et suis locis restituta, atque reiectis adulterinis, uera reposita. Item fragmentatae epistolae, integrae factae. In medio etiam epistolae libri octauus de Clitumno fonte non solum uertici calx additus, et calci uertex, sed decem quoque epistolae interpositae, ac ex Nono libro Octauus factus, et ex Octauo Nonus, Idque beneficio exemplaris correctissimi, & mirae, ac uenerandae Vetustatis.”

The presence of such a manuscript, “most correct, and of a marvellous and venerable antiquity,” stimulates the imagination: Aldus thinks that now even the lost Decades of Livy may appear again:

“Solebam superioribus Annis Aloisi Vir Clariss. cum aut T. Liuii Decades, quae non extare creduntur, aut Sallustii, aut Trogi historiae, aut quemuis alium ex antiquis autoribus inuentum esse audiebam, nugae dicere, ac fabulas. Sed ex quo tu ex Gallia has Plinii epistolas in Italia reportasti, in membrana scriptas, atque adeo diuersis a nostris characteribus, ut nisi quis diu assuerit, non queat legere, coepi sperare mirum in modum, fore aetate nostra, ut plurimi ex bonis autoribus, quos non extare credimus, inueniantur.”

There was something unusual in the character of the script that made it hard to read; its ancient appearance even suggested to Aldus a date as early as that of Pliny himself.

“Est enim uolumen ipsum non solum correctissimum, sed etiam ita antiquum, ut putem scriptum Plinii temporibus.”

This is enthusiastic language. In the days of Italian humanism, a scholar might call almost any book a *codex peruetustus* if it supplied new readings for his edition and its script seemed unusual. As Professor Merrill remarks:^{[3](#)}

“The extreme age that Aldus was disposed to attribute to the manuscript will, of course, occasion no wonder in the minds of those who are familiar with the vague notions on such matters that prevailed among scholars before the study of palaeography had been developed into somewhat of a science. The manuscript may have been written in one of the so-called ‘national’ hands, Lombardic, Visigothic, or Merovingian. But if it were in a ‘Gothic’ hand of the twelfth or thirteenth centuries, it might have appeared sufficiently grotesque and illegible to a reader accustomed for the most part to the exceedingly clear Italian book hands of the fifteenth century.”

In a later article Professor Merrill well adds that even the uncial script would have seemed difficult and alien to one accustomed to the current fifteenth-century style.⁴ A contemporary and rival editor, Catanaeus, disputed Aldus’s claims. In his second edition of the *Letters* (1518), he professed to have used a very ancient book that came down from Germany and declared that the Paris manuscript had no right to the antiquity which Aldus had imputed to it. But Catanaeus has been proved a liar.⁵ He had no ancient manuscript from Germany, and abused Aldus mainly to conceal his cribbings from that scholar’s edition; we may discount his opinion of the age of the Parisinus. Until Aldus, an eminent scholar and honest publisher,⁶ is proved guilty, we should assume him innocent of mendacity or naïve ignorance. He speaks in earnest; his words ring true. We must be prepared for the possibility that his ancient manuscript was really ancient.

Since Aldus’s time the Parisinus has disappeared. To quote Merrill again:⁷

“This wonderful manuscript, like so many others, appears to have vanished from earth. Early editors saw no especial reason for preserving what was to them but copy for their own better printed texts. Possibly some leaves of it may be lying hid in old bindings; possibly they went to cover preserve-jars, or tennis-racquets; possibly into some final dust-heap. At any rate the manuscript is gone; the copy by Iucundus is gone; the copy of the correspondence with Trajan that Avantius owed to Petrus Leander is gone; if others had any other copies of Book X, in whole or in part, they are gone too.”

The Bodleian volume In 1708 Thomas Hearne, the antiquary, bought at auction a peculiar volume of Pliny's *Letters*. It consisted of Beroaldus's edition of the nine books (1498), the portions of Book X published by Avantius in 1502, and, on inserted leaves, the missing letters of Books VIII and X.⁸ The printed portions, moreover, were provided with over five hundred variant readings and lemmata in a different hand from that which appeared on the inserted leaves; the hand that added the variants also wrote in the margin the sixteenth letter of Book IX, which is not in the edition of Beroaldus. Hearne recognized the importance of this supplementary matter, for he copied the variants into his own edition of the *Letters* (1703), intending, apparently, to use them in a larger edition which he is said to have published in 1709; he also lent the book to Jean Masson, who refers to it in his *Plinii Vita*. Upon Hearne's death, this valuable volume was acquired by the Bodleian Library in Oxford, but lay unnoticed until Mr. E. G. Hardy, in 1888,⁹ examined it and, after a comparison of the readings, pronounced it the very copy from which Aldus had printed his edition in 1508. External proof of this highly exciting surmise seemed to appear in a manuscript note on the last page of the edition of Avantius, written in the hand that had inserted the variants and supplements throughout the volume:¹⁰

“hae plinii iunioris epistolae ex uetustissimo exemplari parisiensi et restitutae et emendatae sunt opera et industria ioannis iucundi prestantissimi architecti hominis imprimis antiquarii.”

What more natural to conclude than that here is the very copy that Aldus prepared from the ancient manuscript and the collations and transcripts sent him by Fra Giocondo? One fact blocks this attractive conjecture: though there are many agreements between the readings of the emended Bodleian book and those of Aldus, there are also many disagreements. Mr. Hardy removed the obstacle by assuming that Aldus made changes in the proof; but the changes are numerous; they are not too numerous for a scholar who can mark up his galleys free of cost, but they are decidedly too numerous if the scholar is also his own printer.

Merrill, in a brilliant and searching article,¹¹ entirely demolishes Hardy's argument. Unlike most destructive critics, he replaces the exploded theory

by still more interesting fact. For the rediscovery of the Bodleian book and a proper appreciation of its value, students of Pliny's text must always be grateful to Hardy; we now know, however, that the volume was never owned by Aldus. The scholar who put its parts together and added the variants with his own hand was the famous Hellenist Guillaume Budé (Budaëus). The parts on the supplementary leaves were done by some copyist who imitated the general effect of the type used in the book itself; Budaëus added his notes on these inserted leaves in the same way as elsewhere. It had been shown before by Keil¹² that Budaëus must have used the readings of the Parisinus; indeed, it is from his own statement in *Annotationes in Pandectas* that we learn of the discovery of the ancient manuscript by Giocondo:¹³

“Verum haec epistola et aliae non paucae in codicibus impressis non leguntur: nos integrum ferme Plinium habemus: primum apud parrhisios repertum opera Iucundi sacerdotis: hominis antiquarii Architectique famigerati.”

The wording here is much like that in the note at the end of the Bodleian book. After establishing his case convincingly from the readings followed by Budaëus in his quotations from the *Letters*, Merrill eventually was able to compare the handwriting with the acknowledged script of Budaëus and to find that the two are identical.¹⁴ The Bodleian book, then, is not Aldus's copy for the printer. It is Budaëus's own collation from the Parisinus. Whether he examined the manuscript directly or used a copy made by Giocondo is doubtful; the note at the end of the Bodleian volume seems to favor the latter possibility. Budaëus does not by any means give a complete collation, but what he does give constitutes, in Merrill's opinion, our best authority for any part of the lost Parisinus.¹⁵

The Morgan fragment possibly a part of the lost Parisinus

The script Perhaps we may now say the Bodleian volume *has been hitherto* our best authority. For a fragment of the ancient book, if my conjecture is right, is now, after various journeys, reposing in the Pierpont Morgan Library in New York City.

First of all, we are impressed with the script. It is an uncial of about the year 500 A.D.—certainly *venerandae vetustatis*. If Aldus had this same uncial codex at his disposal, we can understand his delight and pardon his slight exaggeration, for it is only slight. The essential truth of his statement remains: he had found a book of a different class from that of the ordinary manuscript—indeed *diversis a nostris characteribus*. Instead of thinking him arrant knave or fool enough to bring down “antiquity” to the thirteenth century, we might charitably push back his definition of “*nostris characteres*” to include anything in minuscules; script “not our own” would be the majuscule hands in vogue before the Middle Ages. That is a position palaeographically defensible, seeing that the humanistic script is a lineal descendant of the Caroline variety. Furthermore, an uncial hand, though clear and regular as in our fragment, is harder to read than a glance at a page of it promises. This is due to the writing of words continuously. It takes practice, as Aldus says, to decipher such a script quickly and accurately. Moreover, the flesh sides of the leaves are faded.

Provenience and contents We next note that the fragment came to the Pierpont Morgan Library from Aldus’s country, where, as Dr. Lowe has amply shown, it was written; how it came into the possession of the Marquis Taccone would be interesting to know. But, like the Parisinus, the book to which our fragment belonged had not stayed in Italy always. It had made a trip to France—and was resting there in the fifteenth century, as is proved by the French note of that period on fol. 51^r. We may say “the book” and not merely “the present six leaves,” for the fragment begins with fol. 48, and the foliation is of the fifteenth century. The last page of our fragment is bright and clear, showing no signs of wear, as it would if no more had followed it;¹⁶ I will postpone the question of what probably did follow. Moreover, if the *probatio pennae* on fol. 53^r is Carolingian,¹⁷ it would appear that the book had been in France at the beginning as well as at the end of the Middle Ages. Thus our manuscript may well have been one of those brought up from Italy by the emissaries of Charlemagne or their successors during the revival of learning in the eighth and ninth centuries. The outer history of our book, then, and the character of its script, comport with what we know of Aldus’s Parisinus.

The text closely related to that of Aldus But we must now subject our fragment to internal tests. If Aldus used the entire manuscript of which this is a part, his text must show a general conformity to that of the fragment. An examination of the appended collation will establish this fact beyond a doubt. The references are to Keil's critical edition of 1870, but the readings are verified from Merrill's apparatus. I will designate the fragment as *Π*, using *P* for Aldus's Parisinus and *a* for his edition.

We may begin by excluding two probable misprints in Aldus, 64, 1 *conturbernium* and 65, 17 *subeuertas*. Then there are various spellings in which Aldus adheres to the fashion of his day, as *sexcenties*, *millies*, *millia*, *tentarunt*, *caussas*, *autoritas*, *quanquam*, *syderum*, *hyeme*, *coena*, *ocium*, *hospicii*, *negociis*, *solatium*, *adulescet*, *exoluit*, *Thuscos*; there are other spellings which modern editors might not disdain, *i.e.*, *aerarii* and *illustri*, and some that they have accepted, namely *apponitur*, *existat*, *impleturus*, *implorantes*, *obtulissem*, *balinei*, *caret* (not *karet*), *caritas* (not *karitas*).¹⁸

A study of our collation will also show some forty cases of correction in *Π* by either the scribe himself or a second and possibly a third ancient hand. Here Aldus, if he read the pages of our fragment and read them with care, might have seen warrant for following either the original text or the emended form, as he preferred. The most important cases are: 61, 14 *sera*] *Πa* *SERUA* *Π*² 61, 21 *considit*] *Π* *CONSIDET* *Π*²*a*. The original reading of *Π* is clearly *CONSIDIT*. The second *i* has been altered to a capital *E*, which of course is not the proper form for uncial. 62, 5 *residit*] *Π* *residet* *a*. Here *Π* is not corrected, but Aldus may have thought that the preceding case of *CONSIDET* (*m.* 2) supported what he supposed the better form *residet*. 63, 11 *posset*] *a* *POSSIT* (in *posset m. 1?*) *Π*. Again the corrected *E* is capital, not uncial, but Aldus would have had no hesitation in adopting the reading of the second hand. 64, 2 *modica vel etiam*] *a* *MODICA EST ETIAM* (*corr. m. 2*) *Π*. 64, 28 *excurrissem accepto, ut praefectus aerari, commeatu*] *a*. Here *Π* omitted *accepto ut praefectus aerari*,—evidently a line of the manuscript that he was copying, for there are no similar endings to account otherwise for the omission. 66, 2 *dissentientis*] *a* *ex DISSITIENTIS m. 1 (?)* *Π*.

There are also a few careless errors of the first hand, uncorrected, in *Π*, which Aldus himself might easily have corrected or have found the right

reading already in the early editions. 62, 23 conteror quorum] *a* CONTEROR QUI HORUM *II B F* 63, 28 si] *a* SIBI *II* 64, 24 conprobasse] COMPROUASSE *II*.

In view of these certain errors of the first hand of *II*, most of them corrected but a few not, Aldus may have felt justified in abiding by one of the early editions in the following three cases, where *II* might well have seemed to him wrong; in one of them (64,3) modern editors agree with him: 62, 20 aurium oculorum vigor] *II* aurium oculorumque uigor *a* 64, 3 proferenda] *a* CONFERANDA *II* 65, 11 et alii] *II* etiam alii *a*.

There is only one case of possible emendation to note: 64, 29 questuri] *II* quaesturi *MVa*. Aldus's reading, as I learn from Professor Merrill, is in the anonymous edition ascribed to Roscius (Venice, 1492?), but not in any of the editions cited by Keil. This may be a conscious emendation, but it is just as possibly an error of hearing made by either Aldus or his compositor in repeating the word to himself as he wrote or set up the passage. Once in the text, *quaesturi* gives no offense, and is not corrected by Aldus in his edition of 1518. An apparently more certain effort at emendation is reported by Keil on 62, 13, where Aldus is said to differ from all the manuscripts and the editions in reading *agere* for *facere*. So he does in his second edition; but here he has *facere* with everybody else. The changes in the second edition are few and are largely confined to the correction of obvious misprints. There is no point in substituting *agere* for *facere*. I should attribute this innovation to a careless compositor, who tried to memorize too large a bit of text, rather than to an emending editor. At all events, it has no bearing on our immediate concern.

The striking similarity, therefore, between Aldus's text and that of our fragment confirms our surmise that the latter may be a part of that ancient manuscript which he professes to have used in his edition. Whatever his procedure may have been, he has produced a text that differs from *II* only in certain spellings, in the correction, with the help of existing editions, of three obvious errors of *II* and of three of its readings that to Aldus might well have seemed erroneous, in two misprints, and in one reading which is possibly an emendation but which may just as well be another misprint. Thus the internal evidence of the text offers no contradiction of what the script and the history of the manuscript have suggested. I can not claim to

have established an irrefutable conclusion, but the signs all point in one direction. I see enough evidence to warrant a working hypothesis, which we may use circumspectly as a clue, submit to further tests, and abandon in case these tests yield evidence with which it can not be reconciled.

Editorial methods of Aldus Further, if we are justified in our assumption that Aldus used the manuscript of which Π is a part, the fragment is instructive as to his editorial methods. If he proceeded elsewhere as carefully as here, he certainly did not perform his task with the high-handedness of the traditional humanistic editor; rather, he treated his ancient witness with respect, and abandoned it only when confronted with what seemed its obvious mistakes. I will revert to this matter at a later stage of the argument.

RELATION OF THE MORGAN FRAGMENT TO THE OTHER MANUSCRIPTS OF THE LETTERS.

BUT, it will be asked, how do we know that Aldus used Π rather than some other manuscript that had a very similar text and that happened to have gone through the same travels? To answer this question we must examine the relation of Π to the other extant manuscripts in the light of what is known of the transmission of Pliny's *Letters* in the Middle Ages. A convenient summary is given by Merrill on the basis of his abundant researches.^{[19](#)}

Classes of the manuscripts Manuscripts of the *Letters* may be divided into three classes, distinguished by the number of books that each contains.

Class I, the ten-book family, consists of *B* (Bellovacensis or Riccardianus), now Ashburnhamensis, R 98 in the Laurentian Library in Florence, its former home, whence it had been diverted on an interesting pilgrimage by the noted book-thief Libri. This manuscript is attributed to the tenth century by Merrill, and by Chatelain in his description of the book. But Chatelain labels his facsimile page "*Saec. IX.*"^{[20](#)} The latter seems the more probable

date. The free use of a flat-topped *a*, along with the general appearance of the script, reminds me of the style in vogue at Fleury and its environs about the middle of the ninth century. A good specimen is accessible in a codex of St. Hilary on the Psalms (Vaticanus Reginensis 95), written at Micy between 846 and 859, of which a page is reproduced by Ehrle and Liebaert.²¹ *F* (Florentinus), the other important representative of this class, is also in the Laurentian Library (S. Marco 284). The date assigned to it seems also too late. It is apparently as early as the tenth century, and also has some of the characteristics of the script of Fleury; it is French work, at any rate. Keil's suggestion²² that it may be the book mentioned as *liber epistolarum Gaii Plinii* in a tenth-century catalogue of the manuscripts at Lorsch may be perfectly correct; though not written at Lorsch, it might have been presented to the monastery by that time.²³ These two manuscripts agree in containing, by the first hand, only Books I-V, vi (*F* having all and *B* only a part of the sixth letter). However, as the initial title in *B* is PLINI · SECUNDI · EPISTULARUM · LIBRI · DECEM, we may infer that some ancestor, if not the immediate ancestor, of *B* and *F* had all ten books.

In Class II the leading manuscript is another Laurentian codex (Mediceus XLVII 36), which contains Books I-IX, xxvi, 8. It was written in the ninth century, at Corvey, whence it was brought to Rome at the beginning of the sixteenth century. It is part of a volume that also once contained our only manuscript of the first part of the *Annals* of Tacitus.²⁴ The other chief manuscript of this class is *V* (Vaticanus Latinus 3864), which has Books I-IV. The script has been variously estimated. I am inclined to the opinion that the book was written somewhere near Tours, perhaps Fleury, in the earlier part of the ninth century.²⁵ If Ullman is right in seeing a reference to Pliny's *Letters* in a notice in a mediaeval catalogue of Corbie,²⁶ it may be that the codex is a Corbeiensis. But it is also possible that a volume of the *Letters* at Corbie was twice copied, once at Corvey (*M*) and once in the neighborhood of Tours (*V*). At any rate, with the help of *V*, we may reach farther back than Corvey and Germany for the origin of this class. There are likewise two fragmentary texts, both of brief extent, Monacensis 14641 (olim Emmeramensis) *saec.* IX, and Leidensis Vossianus 98 *saec.* IX, the latter partly in Tironian notes. Merrill regards these as bearing "testimony to the existence of the nine-book text in the same geographical region,"

namely Germany.²⁷ There they are to-day, in Germany and Holland, but where they were written is another affair. The Munich fragment is part of a composite volume of which it occupies only a page or two. The script is continental, and may well be that of Regensburg, but it shows marked traces of insular influence, English rather than Irish in character. The work immediately preceding the fragment is in an insular hand, of the kind practised at various continental monasteries, such as Fulda; there are certain notes in the usual continental hand. Evidently the manuscript deserves consideration in the history of the struggle between the insular and the continental hands in Germany.²⁸ The script of the Leyden fragment, on the other hand, so far as I can judge from a photograph, looks very much like the mid-century Fleury variety with which I have associated the Bellovacensis; there can hardly be doubt, at any rate, that De Vries is correct in assigning it to France, where Voss obtained so many of his manuscripts.²⁹ Except, therefore, for *M* and the Munich fragment, there is no evidence furnished by the chief manuscripts which connects the tradition of the *Letters* with Germany. The insular clue afforded by the latter book deserves further attention, but I can not follow it here. The question of the Parisinus aside, *B* and *F* of Class I and *V* of Class II are sure signs that the propagation of the text started from one or more centres—Fleury and Corbie seem the most probable—in France.

The third class comprises manuscripts containing eight books, the eighth being omitted and the ninth called the eighth. Representatives of this class are all codices of the fifteenth century, though the class has a more ancient basis than that, namely a lost manuscript of Verona. This is best attested by *D*, a Dresden codex, while almost all other manuscripts of this class descend from a free recension made by Guarino and conflated with *F*; *o*, *u*, and *x* are the representatives of this recension (*G*) that are reported by Merrill. The relation of this third class to the second is exceedingly close; indeed, it may be merely a branch of it.³⁰

The early editions As is often the case, the leading manuscript authorities are only inadequately represented in the early editions. The Editio Princeps (*p*) of 1471 was based on a manuscript of the Guarino recension. A Roman

editor in 1474 added part of Book VIII, putting it at the end and calling it Book IX; he acquired this new material, along with various readings in the other books, from some manuscript of Class II that may have come down from the north. Three editors, called ς by Keil—Pomponius Laetus 1490, Beroaldus 1498, and Catanaeus 1506—took *r* as a basis; but Laetus had another and a better representative of the same type of text as that from which *r* had drawn, and he likewise made use of *V*. With the help of these new sources the ς editors polished away a large number of the gross blunders of *p* and *r*, and added a sometimes unnecessary brilliance of emendation. Avantius's edition of part of Book X in 1502 was appropriated by Beroaldus in the same year and by Catanaeus in 1506; these latter editors had no new sources at their disposal. No wonder that the Parisinus seemed a godsend to Aldus. The only known ancient manuscripts whose readings had been utilized in the editions preceding his own were *F* and *V*, both incomplete representatives of Classes I and II. The manuscripts discovered by the Roman editor and Laetus were of great help at the time, but we have no certain evidence of their age. *B* and *M* were not accessible.³¹ Now, besides the transcript of Giocondo and his other six volumes, whatever these may have been, Aldus had the ancient codex itself with all ten books complete. Everybody admits that the Parisinus, as shown by the readings of Aldus, is clearly associated with the manuscripts of Class I. Its contents corroborate the evidence of the title in *B*, which indicates descent from some codex containing ten books.

II a member of Class I Now nothing is plainer than that *II* is a member of Class I, as it agrees with *BF* in the following errors, or what are regarded by Keil as errors. I consider the text of the *Letters* and not their superscriptions. 60, 15 duplicia] *MVD* duplicata *II BFGa*; 61, 12 confusa adhuc] *MV* adhuc confusa *II BFGa*; 62, 6 doctissime] *MV* doctissima *II BFDa* et doctissima *G*; 62, 16 nec adficitur] *MVD* et adficitur *II BFGa*; 62, 23 quorum] *MVDGa* qui horum *II BF*; 63, 22 teque et] *MVDG* teque *II BFa*; 64, 3 proferenda] *Doxa* conferenda *BFu* CONFERANDA *II* (*MV* lack an extensive passage here); 65, 11 alii quidam minores sed tamen numeri] *DG* alii quidam minores sed tam innumeri *MV* alii quidem minoris sed tamen numeri *II BFa*; 65, 12 voluntariis accusationibus] *M* (uoluntaris) *D* voluntariis *om. V*

accusationibus uoluntariis *ΠBFGa*; 65, 15 superiore] *MVD* priore *ΠBFGa*; 65, 24 iam] *MVDG om. ΠBFa*.

Tastes differ, and not all these eleven readings of Class I may be errors. Kukula, in the most recent Teubner edition (1912), accepts three of them (60, 15; 62, 6; 65, 15), and Merrill, in his forthcoming edition, five (60, 15; 61, 12; 62, 6; 65, 12; 65, 15). Personally I could be reconciled to them all with the exception of the very two which Aldus could not admit—62, 23 and 64, 3; in both places he had the early editions to fall back on. However, I should concur with Merrill and Kukula in preferring the reading of the other classes in 62, 16 and 65, 24. In 65, 11 I would emend to *alii quidam minoris sed tamen numeri*; if this is the right reading, *ΠBF* agree in the easy error of *quidem* for *quidam*, and *MVD* in another easy error, *minores* for *minoris*—the parent manuscript of *MV* further changed *tamen numeri* to *tam innumeri*. Whatever the final judgment, here are five cases in which all recent editors would attribute error to Class I; in the remaining six cases the manuscripts of Class I either agree in error or avoid the error of Class II—surely, then, *Π* is not of the latter class. There are six other significant errors of *MV* in the whole passage, no one of which appears in *Π*: 61, 15 si non] sint *MV*; 62, 6 mira illis] mirabilis *MV*; 62, 11 lotus] illic *MV*; cibus] cibos *MV*; 62, 25 fuit—64, 12 potes] *om. MV*; 66, 12 amatus] est amatus *MV*. Once the first hand in *Π* agrees with *V* in an error easily committed independently: 61, 12 ordinata] *ORDINATA*, *DI ss. m. 2 Π* ornata *V*.

Π, then, and *MV* have descended from the archetype by different routes. With Class III, the Verona branch of Class II, *Π* clearly has no close association.

But the evidence for allying *Π* with *B* and *F*, the manuscripts of Class I, is by no means exhausted. In 61, 14, *BFux* have the erroneous emendation, which Budaeus includes among his variants, of *serua* for *sera*. A glance at *Π* shows its apparent origin. The first hand has *SERA* correctly; the second hand writes *U* above the line.³² If the second hand is solely responsible for the attempt at improvement here, and is not reproducing a variant in the parent manuscript of *Π*, then *BF* must descend directly from *Π*. The following instances point in the same direction: 61, 21 considit] considet *BF*. *Π* has *CONSIDIT* by the first hand, the second hand changing the second *i*

to a capital E.³³ In 65, 5, however, RESIDIT is not thus changed in *II*, and perhaps for this very reason is retained by the careful scribe of *B*; *F*, which has a slight tendency to emend, has, with *G*, *residet*. 63, 9 *praestat amat me]* *praestatam ad me B*. Here the letters of the *scriptura continua* in *II* are faded and blurred; the error of *B* would therefore be peculiarly easy if this manuscript derived directly from *II*. If one ask whether the page were as faded in the ninth century as now, Dr. Lowe has already answered this question; the flesh side of the parchment might well have lost a portion of its ink considerably before the Carolingian period.³⁴ In any case, the error of *praestatam ad me* seems natural enough to one who reads the line for the first time in *II*. *B* did not, as we shall see, copy directly from *II*; a copy intervened, in which the error was made and then, I should infer, corrected above the line, whence *F* drew the right reading, *B* taking the original but incorrect text.

There are cases in plenty elsewhere in the *Letters* to show that *B* is not many removes from the *scriptura continua* of some majuscule hand. In the section included in *II*, apart from the general tightness of the writing, which led to the later insertion of strokes between many of the words,³⁵ we note these special indications of a parent manuscript in majuscules. In 61, 10 *me autem]*, *B* started to write *mea* and then corrected it. 64, 19 *praeceptor* *a quo]* *praeceptor* *a quo B*, (*m. 1*) *F*. If *B* or its parent manuscript copied *II* directly, the mistake would be especially easy, for *PRAECEPTORIA* ends the line in *II*. 64, 25 *integra re]*. After *integra*, a letter is erased in *B*; the copyist, it would seem, first mistook *integra re* for one word.

Other instances showing a close connection between *B* and *II* are as follows: 62, 23 *unice]* *II* has by the first hand *INUICE*, the second hand writing *U* above *I*, and a vertical stroke above *U*. In *BF*, *uince*, the reading of the first hand, is changed by the second to *unice*; this second hand, Professor Merrill informs me, seems to be that of a writer in the same scriptorium as the first. The error in *BF* might, of course, be due to copying an original in minuscules, but it might also be due to the curious state of affairs in *II*. 65, 24 *fungerer]*. In *II* the final *R* is written, somewhat indistinctly, above the line. *B* has *fungerer* corrected by the second hand from *fungeret* (?), which may be due to a misunderstanding of *II*. 66, 2

avunculi] AUONCULI *II* (O *in ras.*) *B*. This form might perhaps be read; *F* has emended it out, and no other manuscript has it. 65, 7 desino, inquam, patres conscripti, putare]. Here the relation of *BF* to *II* seems particularly close. *II*, like *MVDoxa*, has the abbreviation P.C. On a clearly written page, the error of *reputare* (*BF*) for P.C. PUTARE is not a specially likely one to make. But in the blur at the bottom of fol. 52^v, a page on the flesh side of the parchment, the combination might readily be mistaken for REPUTARE.

Another curious bit of testimony appears at the beginning of the third book. The scribe of *B*³⁶ wrote the words NESICIO—APUD in rustic capitals, occupying therewith the first line and about a third of the second. This is not effective calligraphy. It would appear that he is reproducing, as is his habit, exactly what he found in his original. That original might have had one full line, or two lines, of majuscules, perhaps, following pretty closely the lines in *II*, which has the same amount of text, plus the first three letters of SPURINNAM, in the first two lines. If *B* had *II* before him, there is nothing to explain his most unusual procedure. His original, therefore, is not *II* but an intervening copy, which he is transcribing with an utter indifference to aesthetic effect and with a laudable, if painful, desire for accuracy. This trait, obvious in *B*'s work throughout, is perhaps nowhere more strikingly exhibited than here.

II the direct ancestor of BF with probably a copy intervening If *II* is the direct ancestor of *BF*, these manuscripts should contain no good readings not found in *II*, unless their writers could arrive at such readings by easy emendation or unless there is contamination with some other source. From what we know of the text of *BF* in general, the latter supposition may at once be ruled out. There are but three cases to consider, two of which may be readily disposed of: 64, 3 proferenda] conferenda *BF* CONFERANDA *II*; 64, 4 conprobasse] (comp.) *BF* COMPROUASSE *II*. These are simple slips, which a scribe might almost unconsciously correct as he wrote. The remaining error (63, 28 SIBI to si) is not difficult to emend when one considers the entire sentence: *quibus omnibus ita demum similis adolescet, si imbutus honestis artibus fuerit, quas*, etc. It is less probable, however, that *B* with *II* before him should correct it as he wrote than, as we have already surmised, that a

minuscule copy intervened between *Π* and *B*, in which the letters *bi* were deleted by some careful reviser. Two other passages tend to confirm this assumption of an intermediate copy. In 65, 6 (*tum optime libertati venia obsequio praeparatur*), *B* has *optimae*, a false alteration induced perhaps by the following *libertati*. In *Π*, *OPTIME* stands at the end of the line. The scribe of *B*, had he not found *libertati* immediately adjacent, would not so readily be tempted to emend; still, we should not make too much of this instance, as *B* has a rather pronounced tendency to write *ae* for *e*. A more certain case is 66, 7 *fungar indicis] fungarindicis ex fungari dicis* *B*; here the error is easier to derive from an original in minuscules in which *in* was abbreviated with a stroke above the *i*. There is abundant evidence elsewhere in the *Letters* that the immediate ancestor of *BF* was written in minuscules; I need not elaborate this point. Our present consideration is that apart from the three instances of simple emendation just discussed, there is no good reading of *B* or *F* in the portion of text contained in *Π* that may not be found, by either the first or the second hand, in *Π*.³⁷

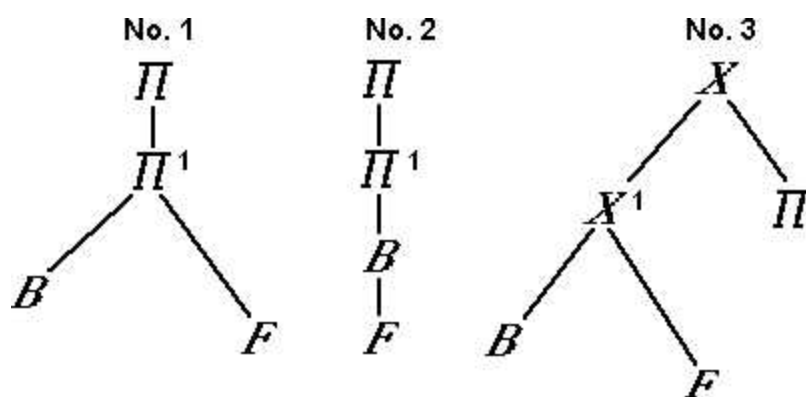
We may now examine a most important bit of testimony to the close connection existing between *BF* and *Π*. *B* alone of all manuscripts hitherto known is provided with indices of the *Letters*, one for each book, which give the names of the correspondents and the opening words of each letter. Now *Π*, by good luck, preserves the end of Book II, the beginning of Book III, and between them the index for Book III. Dr. F. E. Robbins, in a careful article on *B* and *F*, and one on the tables of contents in *B*,³⁸ concluded that *P* did not contain the indices which are preserved in *B*, and that these were compiled in some ancestor of *B*, perhaps in the eighth century. Here they are, in the Morgan fragment, which takes us back two centuries farther into the past. A comparison of the index in *Π* shows indubitably a close kinship with *B*. A glance at plates [XIII](#) and [XIV](#) indicates, first of all, that the copy *B*, here as in the text of the *Letters*, is not many removes from *scriptura continua*. Moreover, the lists are drawn up on the same principle; the *nomen* and *cognomen* but not the *praenomen* of the correspondent being given, and exactly the same amount of text quoted at the beginning of each letter. The incipit of III, xvi (AD NEPOTEM—ADNOTASSE UIDEOR FATADICTAQ·) is an addition in *Π*, and the lemma is longer than usual, as though the original title had been omitted in the manuscript which *Π* was copying and the

corrector of *Π* had substituted a title of his own making.³⁹ It reappears in *B*, with the easy emendation of *facta* from *fata*. The only other case in the indices of a right reading in *B* that is not in *Π* is in the title of III, viii: AD SÜETON TRANQUE *Π* Adu&on tranqui. *B*. In both these instances the scribe of *B* needed no external help in correcting the simple error. Far more significant is the coincidence of *B* and *Π* in very curious mistakes, as the address of III, iii (AD CAERELLIAE HISPULLAE for AD CORELLIAM HISPULLAM) and the lemma of III, viii (FACIS ADPROCETERA for FACIS PRO CETERA). *ΠBF* agree in omitting SUAE (III, iii) and SUO (III, iv), but in retaining the pronominal adjectives in the other addresses preserved in *Π*. The same unusual suspensions occur in *Π* and *B*, as AD SÜETON TRANQUE (tranqui *B*); AD ÜESTRIC SPURINN·; AD SILIUM PROCUL.⁴⁰ In the first of these cases, the parent of *Π* evidently had TRANQ·, which *Π* falsely enlarges to TRANQUE; this form and not TRANQ· is the basis of *B*'s correction—a semi-successful correction—TRANQUI. This, then, is another sign that *B* depends directly on *Π*. Further, *B* omits one symbol of abbreviation which *Π* has (POSSUM IAM PERSCRI{-B}), the lemma of the ninth letter), and in the lemma of the tenth neither manuscript preserves the symbol (COMPOSUISSE ME QUAED). In the first of these cases, it will be observed, *B* has a very long *i* in *perscrib*.⁴¹ This long *i* is not a feature of the script of *B*, nor is there any provocation for it in the way in which the word is written in *Π*. This detail, therefore, may be added to the indications that a copy in minuscules intervened between *B* and *Π*; the curious *i*, faithfully reproduced, as usual, by *B*, may have occurred in such a copy.

These details prove an intimate relation between *Π* and *BF*, and fit the supposition that *B* and *F* are direct descendants of *Π*. This may be strengthened by another consideration. If *Π* and *B* independently copy the same source, they inevitably make independent errors, however careful their work. *Π* should contain, then, a certain number of errors not in *B*. As we have found only three such cases in 12 pages, or 324 lines, and as in all these three the right reading in *B* could readily have been due to emendation on the part of the scribe of *B* or of a copy between *Π* and *B*, we have acquired negative evidence of an impressive kind. It is distinctly harder to believe that the two texts derive independently from a common source. Show us the significant errors of *Π* not in *B*, and we will accept the

existence of that common source; otherwise the appropriate supposition is that *B* descends directly from its elder relative *Π*. It is not necessary to prove by an examination of readings that *Π* is not copied from *B*; the dates of the two scripts settle that matter at the start. Supposing, however, for the moment, that *Π* and *B* were of the same age, we could readily prove that the former is not copied from the latter. For *B* contains a significant collection of errors which are not present in *Π*. Six slight mistakes were made by the first hand and corrected by it, three more were corrected by the second hand, and twelve were left uncorrected. Some of these are trivial slips that a scribe copying *B* might emend on his own initiative, or perhaps by a lucky mistake. Such are 64, 26 iudicium] indicium *B*; 64, 29 Caecili] caecilii *B*; 65, 13 neglegere] neglere *B*. But intelligent pondering must precede the emendation of *praeceptoria quo* into *praeceptori a quo* (64, 19), of *beatidis* into *Baeticis* (65, 15), and of *optimae* into *optime* (65, 26), while it would take a Madvig to remedy the corruptions in 63, 9 (*praestatam ad me*) and 65,7 (*reputare* into *patres conscripti putare*). These are the sort of errors which if found in *Π* would furnish incontrovertible proof that a manuscript not containing them was independent of *Π*; but there is no such evidence of independence in the case of *B*. Our case is strengthened by the consideration that various of the errors in *B* may well be traced to idiosyncrasies of *Π*, not merely to its *scriptura continua*, a source of misunderstanding that any majuscule would present, but to the fading of the writing on the flesh side of the pages in *Π*, and to the possibility that some of the corrections of the second hand may be the private inventions of that hand.⁴² We are hampered, of course, by the comparatively small amount of matter in *Π*, nor are we absolutely certain that this is characteristic of the entire manuscript of which it was once a part. But my reasoning is correct, I believe, for the material at our disposal.

The probable stemma Our tentative stemma thus far, then, is No. 1 below, not No. 2 and not No. 3.



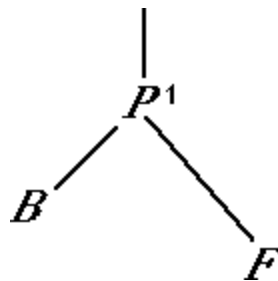
Robbins put P in the position of Π in this last stemma, but on the assumption that it did not contain the indices. That is not true of Π .

Further consideration of the external history of P , Π , and B Still further evidence is supplied by the external history of our manuscripts. B was at Beauvais at the end of the twelfth or the beginning of the thirteenth century, as we have seen.⁴³ Whatever the uncertainties as to its origin, any palaeographer would agree that it could hardly have been written before the middle of the ninth century or after the middle of the tenth. It was undoubtedly produced in France, as was F , its sister manuscript. The presumption is that Π^1 , the copy intervening between Π and B , was also French, and that Π was in France when the copy was made from it. Merrill, for what reason I fail to see, suggested that the original of BF might be “Lombardic,” written in North Italy.⁴⁴ An extraneous origin of this sort must be proved from the character of the errors, such as spellings and the false resolution of abbreviations, made by BF . If no such signs can be adduced, it is natural to suppose that Π^1 was of the same nationality and general tendencies as its copies B and F . This consideration helps out the possible evidence furnished by the scribbling in a hand of the Carolingian variety on fol. 53^v;⁴⁵ we may now be more confident that it is French rather than Italian. But whatever the history of our book in the early Middle Ages, in the fifteenth century it was surely near Meaux, which is not far from Paris—about as far to the east as Beauvais is to the north. Now, granted for a moment that the last of our stemmata is correct, X , from which Π and B descend, being earlier than Π , must have been a manuscript in majuscules,

written in Italy, since that is unquestionably the provenience of *Π*. There were, then, by this supposition, two ancient majuscule manuscripts of the *Letters*, most closely related in text—veritable twins, indeed—that travelled from Italy to France. One (*X*¹) had arrived in the early Middle Ages and is the parent of *B* and *F*; the other (*Π*) was probably there in the early Middle Ages, and surely was there in the fifteenth century. We can not deny this possibility, but, on the principle *melius est per unum fieri quam per plura*, we must not adopt it unless driven to it. The history of the transmission of Classical texts in the Carolingian period is against such a supposition.⁴⁶ Not many books of the age and quality of *Π* were floating about in France in the ninth century. There is nothing in the evidence presented by *Π* and *B* that drives us to assume the presence of two such codices. There is nothing in this evidence that does not fit the simpler supposition that *BF* descend directly from *Π*. The burden of proof would appear to rest on those who assert the contrary. *Π*, therefore, if the ancestor of *B*, contained at least as much as we find today in *B*. Some ancestor of *B* had all ten books. Aldus, whose text is closely related to *BF*, got all ten books from a very ancient manuscript that came down from Paris. Our simpler stemma indicates the presence of one rather than more than one such manuscript in the vicinity of Paris in the ninth or the tenth century and again in the fifteenth. This line of argument, which presents not a mathematically absolute demonstration but at least a highly probable concatenation of facts and deductions, warrants the assumption, to be used at any rate as a working hypothesis, that *Π* is a fragment of the lost Parisinus which contained all the books of Pliny's *Letters*.

Our stemma, then, becomes,

P (the whole manuscript), of which *Π* is a part.



Evidence from the portions of *BF* outside the text of *II* We may corroborate this reasoning by evidence drawn from the portions of *BF* outside the text of *II*. We note, above all, a number of omissions in *BF* that indicate the length of line in some manuscript from which they descend. This length of line is precisely what we find in *II*. Our fragment has lines containing from 23 to 33 letters, very rarely 23, 24, or 33, and most frequently from 27 to 30, the average being 28.4. These figures tally closely with those given by Professor A. C. Clark⁴⁷ for the Vindobonensis of Livy, a codex not far removed in date from *II*. Supposing that *II* is a typical section of *P*—and after Professor Clark’s studies⁴⁸ we may more confidently assume that it is—*P* had the same length of line. The important cases of omission are as follows:

32, 19 atque etiam invisus virtutibus fuerat evasit, reliquit incolumen optimum atque] etiam—atque *om. BF. P* would have the abbreviation for *bus* in *virtutibus* and for *que* in *atque*. There would thus be in all 61 letters and dots, or two lines, arranged about as follows:

ATQ·

ETIAMINUISUSUIRTUTIB·FUERATEUA (30)

SITRELIQUITINCOLUMEMOPTIMUMATQ· (31)

The scribe could easily catch at the second ATQ· after writing the first. It will be at once objected that the repeated ATQ· might have occasioned the mistake, whatever the length of the line. Thus in 82, 2 (aegrotabat Caecina Paetus, maritus eius, aegrotabat] Caecina—aegrotabat *om. BF*), the omitted portion comprises 34 letters—a bit too long, perhaps, for a line of *P*. The following instances, however, can not be thus disposed of.

94, 10 alia quamquam dignitate propemodum paria] quamquam—paria (32 letters) *om. BF. Cetera* and *paria*, to be sure, offer a mild case of *homoioтелеута*, but not powerful enough to occasion an omission unless the words happened to stand at the ends of lines, as they might well have done in *P*. As the line occurs near the beginning of a letter, we may verify our conjecture by plotting the opening lines. The address, as in *II*, would occupy a line. Then, allowing for contractions in *rebus* (18) and *quoque* (19) and reading *cum* (Class I) for *quod* (18), *cetera* (Class I) for *alia* (20),

we can arrange the 236 letters in 8 lines, with an average of 29.5 letters in a line.

123, 10 sentiebant. interrogati a Nepote praetore quem docuissent, responderunt quem prius: interrogati an tunc gratis adfuisset, responderunt sex milibus] interrogati a Nepote—docuissent responderunt *om.* *BF*. Here are two good chances for omissions due to similar endings, as *interrogati* and *responderunt* are both repeated, but neither chance is taken by *BF*. Instead, a far less striking case (*sentiebant*—*responderunt*) leads to the omission. The arrangement in *P* might be

SENTIEBANT	
INTERROGATIANEPOTEPRAETORE	(26)
QUEMDOCUISSENTRESPONDERUNT	(26)
QUEMPRIUSINTERROGATIANUNCGRA	(29)
TISADFUISSETRESPONDERUNTSEXMI	(29)

Here the dangerous words INTERROGATI and RESPONDERUNT are in safe places.

SENTIEBANT and RESPONDERUNT, ordinarily a safe enough pair, become dangerous by their position at the end of lines; indeed, in the *scriptura continua* the danger of confusing *homoioteleuta*, unless these stand at the end of lines, is distinctly less than in a script in which the words are divided. Here again, as in 94, 10, we may reckon the lengths of the opening lines of the letter. After the line occupied with the addresses, we have 296 letters, or ten lines with an average of 29.6 letters apiece.

We may add two omissions of *F* in passages now missing altogether in *B*. 69, 28 quod minorem ex liberis duobus amisit sed maiorem] minorem—sed *om.* *F*. Here again an omission is imminent from the similar endings *minorem*—*maiolem*; that made by *F* (29 letters and one dot) seems to be that of a line of *P* where the arrangement would be:

QUOD	
MINOREMEXLIBERISDUOB·AMISITSED	
MAIOREM	

There may have been a copy (*P*²) intervening between *P*¹ and *F*, but doubtless neither that nor *P*¹ itself had lines so short as those in *P*; the error

of *F*, therefore, may be most naturally ascribed to *P*¹, who omitted a line of *P*.

130, 16 percolui. in summa (cur enim non aperiam tibi vel iudicium meum vel errorem?) primum ego] in summa—primum (59 letters) *om. F*. As there are no *homoioleuta* here at all, we surely are concerned with the omission of a line or lines. Perhaps 59 letters would make up a line in *P*¹ or *P*². Perhaps two lines of *P* were dropped.

Similarly we may note two omissions in *B*, though not in *F*, which may be due originally to the error of *P*¹ in copying *P*.

68, 5 electorumque commentarios centum sexaginta mihi reliquit, opisthographos] -torumque—opisthographos *om. B*. Allowing the abbreviation of *QUE*, we have 59 letters and one dot here. The omitted words are written by the first hand of *B* at the foot of the page. Of course the omission may correspond to a line of *P*¹ dropped by *B* in copying, but it is equally possible that *P*¹ committed the error and corrected it by the marginal supplement, *F* noting the correction in time to include the omitted words in his text, *B* copying them in the margin as he found them in *P*¹.

87, 12 tacitus suffragiis impudentia inrepat. nam quoto cuique eadem honestatis] suffragiis—honestatis *om. m. 1, add. in mg. m. 2 B* (54 letters, with *QUE* abbreviated). This may be like the preceding, except that the correction was done not by the original scribe of *B*, but by a scribe in the same monastery. The presence of *homoioleuta*, we must admit, adds an element of uncertainty.

So, of the passages here brought forward, 94, 20; 123, 10 and 69, 28 are best explained by supposing that *B* and *F* descend from a manuscript that like *Π* had from 24 to 32 letters in a line, while 32, 19 and 130, 16 fit this supposition as well as they do any other.

One orthographic peculiarity is perhaps worth noting: we saw that *B* did not agree with *Π* in the spellings *karet* and *karitas*.⁴⁹ We do, however, find *karitate* elsewhere in *B* (109, 8), and the curious reading *Kl:·facere*, *mg. calfacere*, for *calfacere* (56, 12). This is an additional bit of evidence for supposing that a copy (*P*¹) intervened between *P* and *B*; *P* had the spelling

Karitas consistently, P^1 altered it to the usual form, and *B* reproduced the corrections in P^1 , failing to take them all, unless, as may well be, P^1 had failed to correct all the cases.

Thus the evidence contained in the portion of *BF* outside the text of *II* corroborates our working hypothesis deduced from the fragment itself. We have found nothing yet to overthrow our surmise that a bit of the ancient Parisinus is veritably in the city of New York.

EDITORIAL METHODS OF ALDUS.

W *Aldus's methods; his basic text* E may now return to Aldus and imagine, if we can, his method of critical procedure. Finding his agreement with *II* so close, even in what editors before and after him have regarded as errors, I am disposed to think that he studied his Parisinus with care and followed its authority respectfully. Finding that his seemingly extravagant statements about the antiquity of his book are essentially true, I am disposed to put more confidence in Aldus than editors have granted him thus far. I should suppose that, working in the most convenient way, he turned over to his compositor, not a fresh copy of *P*, but the pages of some edition corrected from *P*—which Aldus surely tells us that he used—and from whatever other sources he consulted. It may be beyond our powers to discover the precise edition that he thus employed. It does not at first thought seem likely that he would select the Princeps, which does not include the eighth book at all, and contains errors that later were weeded out. In the portion of text included in *II*, *P* has thirty-two readings which Aldus avoids. In most of these cases *p* commits an error, sometimes a ridiculous error, like *offam* for *officia* (62, 25); the manuscript on which *p* was based apparently made free use of abbreviations. Keil's damning estimate of r ⁵⁰ is amply borne out in this section of the text; Aldus differs from *r* in sixty-five cases, most of these being errors in *r*. He agrees with ς in all but twenty-six readings.⁵¹ Aldus would have had fewest changes to make, then, if his basic text was ς . This is apparently the view of Keil,⁵² who would agree at any rate that Aldus made special use of the ς

editions and who also declares that *p* is the *fundamentum* of *r* as *r* is of the edition of Pomponius Laetus.⁵³

It would certainly be natural for Aldus to start with his immediate predecessors, as they had started with theirs. The matter ought to be cleared up, if possible, for in order to determine what Aldus found in *P* we must know whether he took some text as a point of departure and, if so, what that text was. But the task should be undertaken by some one to whom the early editions are accessible. Keil's report of them, intentionally incomplete,⁵⁴ is sufficient, he declares,⁵⁵ "*ad fidem Aldinae editionis constituendam*," but, as I have found by comparing our photographs of the edition of Beroaldus in the present section, Keil has not collated minutely or accurately enough to encourage us to undertake, on the basis of his apparatus, an elaborate study of Aldus's relation to the editions preceding his own.

The variants of Budaeus in the Bodleian volume We may now test Aldus by the evidence of the Bodleian volume with its variants in the hand of Budaeus. For the section included in *II*, their number is disappointingly small. The only additions by Budaeus (= *i*) to the text of Beroaldus are: 61, 14 sera] *MVDoa*, (*m. 1*) *II* serua *BFuxi*, (*m. 2*) *II*; 62, 4 ambulat] *i cum plerisque* ambulabat *r Ber.* (*ab del.*) *M*; 62, 25 quoque] *i cum ceteris* pouq (ue) *Ber.*; 64, 23 Quamvis] *q Vmuis Ber. corr. i.*

This is all. Budaeus, who, according to Merrill, had the Parisinus at his disposal, has corrected two obvious misprints, made an inevitable change in the tense of a verb—with or without the help of the ancient book—and introduced from that book one unfortunate reading which we find in the second hand of *II*.

There is one feature of Budaeus's marginal jottings that at once arouses the curiosity of the textual critic, namely, the frequent appearance of the *obelus* and the *obelus cum puncto*. These signs as used by Probus⁵⁶ would denote respectively a surely spurious and a possibly spurious line or portion of text. But such was not the usage of Budaeus; he employed the obelus merely to call attention to something that interested him. Thus at the end of the first letter of Book III we find a doubly pointed obelus opposite an interesting

passage, the text of which shows no variants or editorial questionings. Budaeus appears to have expressed his grades of interest rather elaborately—at least I can discover no other purpose for the different signs employed. The simple obelus apparently denotes interest, the pointed obelus great interest, the doubly pointed obelus intense interest, and the pointing finger of a carefully drawn hand burning interest. He also adds catchwords. Thus on the first letter he calls attention successively⁵⁷ to *Ambulatio*, *Gestatio*, *Hora balnei*, *pilae ludus*, *Coena*, and *Comoedi*. The purpose of the doubly pointed obelus is plainly indicated here, as it accompanies two of these catchwords. Just so in the margin opposite 65, 17, a pointing finger is accompanied by the remark, “*Beneficia beneficiis aliis cumulanda*,” while 227, 5 is decorated with the moral ejaculation, “*o hominem in diuitiis miserum*.” Incidentally, it is obvious that the Morgan fragment was once perused by some thoughtful reader, who marked with lines or brackets passages of special interest to him. For example, the account of how Spurinna spent his day⁵⁸ is so marked. This passage likewise called forth various marginal notes from Budaeus,⁵⁹ and other coincidences exist between the markings in *II* and the marginalia in the Bodleian volume. But there is not enough evidence of this sort to warrant the suggestion that Budaeus himself added the marks in *II*.

Aldus and Budaeus compared It is of some importance to consider what Budaeus might have done to the text of Beroaldus had he treated it to a systematic collation with the Parisinus. Our fragment allows us to test Budaeus; for even if it be not the Parisinus itself, its readings with the help of *B*, *F*, and Aldus show what was in that ancient book. I have enumerated above⁶⁰ eleven readings of *ΠΒF* which are called errors by Keil, but of which nine were accepted by Aldus and five by the latest editor, Professor Merrill. In two of these (62, 33 and 64, 3), Budaeus, like Aldus, wisely does not harbor an obvious error of *P*. In two more (62, 16 and 65, 12), Beroaldus already has the reading of *P*. Of the remaining seven, however, all of which Aldus adopted, there is no trace in Budaeus. There are also nineteen cases of obvious error in the ς editions, which Aldus corrected but Budaeus did not touch. I give the complete apparatus⁶¹ for these twenty-six

places, as they will illustrate the radical difference between Aldus and Budaeus in their use of the Parisinus.

- 60, 15 duplicia] *MVDr*ζ
duplicata *ΠBFGpa*
- 61, 12 confusa adhuc] *MV*ζ
adhuc confusa *ΠBFGpra*
- 18 milia passuum tria nec] *ΠBFMV(p?)a*
milia passum tria et nec *D*
mille pastria nec *r*
mille pas. nec ζ
- 62, 6 doctissime] *MV*ζ
et doctissime *r*
doctissima *ΠBFDa*
et doctissima *p*
- 26 igitur eundem mihi cursum, eundem] *ΠBFD(p?)a*
igitur et eundem mihi cursum et eundem *r*ζ
fuit (25)—potes (64, 12) *om. MV*
- 63, 2 MAXIMO] *ΠBFDG(pr?)a*
Valerio Max. ζ
Gauio Maximo *Catanaeus*
- 4 Arrianus Maturus] *ΠBFDra*
arianus maturus *Gp*
Arrianus Maturius ζ
- 5 est] *ΠBFDG(p?)a*
om. r Ber.
- 9 ardentibus dicere] *ΠBFDG(r?)a*
dicere ardentius *p*ζ
- 12 excolendusque] *ΠBFD(p?)a*
extollendusque *Gr*ζ

- 15 conferas in eum] $\Pi BFD(p?)a$
in eum conferas *Gr* ς
- 17 excipit] $\Pi BFD(p?)a$
accipit *r* ς

quam si] $\Pi BFDG(p?)a$
quasi si *r*
quasi *Laet., Ber.*
- 20 CORELLIAE HISPULLAE SUAE]
CORELLIAE ΠB
AD CAERELLIAE HISPULLAE *ind. \Pi B*
CORELLIE ISPULLAE *F*
CORELLIAE HISPULLAE *a*
corneliae (Coreliae *Catanaeus*) hispullae (suae *add. Do*)
DGpr ς
- 22 teque et] $DG(p?)[\sigma]$
teque $\Pi BFra$
- 23 et in] $\Pi BFDG(p?)a$
et *r* ς

diligam, cupiam necesse est atque etiam] $\Pi BFDG(p?)a$
diligam et cupiam necesse est etiam *r*
diligam atque etiam cupiam nececesse (*sic*) est etiam *Ber.*
- 64, 2 erroribus modica vel etiam nulla] $BFDG(p?)a$
(*ex ERRORIB·MODICAESTETIAMNULLA m. 2*) Π
erroribus uel modica uel nulla *r*
erroribus modica uel nulla *Ber.*
uel erroribus modica uel etiam nulla *vulgo*
- 5 fortunaeque] $\Pi BFDG(p?)a$
form(a)equae *r Ber.*

- 65, 11 alii quidem minores sed tamen numeri] (ali *D*) *DGp*
alii quidem minoris sed tamen numeri *ΠBFa*
alii quidam (quidem *Catanaeus*) minores sed tam (tamen
rς)
innumeri *MVrς*
- 15 superiore] *MVDς*
prior *ΠBFGr*
prior *p*
- 24 iam] *MVDG(pr?)ς*
om. ΠBFa
- 66, 7 sint omnes] *ΠBFMVDG(pr?)a*
sint *ς*
- 9 haec quoque] *ΠBFDVGr*
hoc quoque *M*
hic quoque *p*
haec *ς*
- 11 Pomponi] *ΠBMVo*
Pomponii *FDpra*
Q. Pomponii *ς*
- 12 amatus] *ΠFDG(pr?)a*
est amatus *MVς*
amatus est *corr. m. 1 B*

Here is sufficient material for a test. Aldus, it will be observed, whether or not he started with some special edition, refuses to follow the latest and best texts of his day (i.e., *ς*) in these twenty-six readings. In one sure case (60, 15) and eleven possible⁶² cases (61, 18; 62, 26; 63, 5, 12, 15, 17 *bis*, 23 *bis*; 64, 2, 5), his reading agrees with the Princeps. In four sure cases (63, 4, 22; 65, 15; 66, 9) and one possible one (63, 9), he agrees with the Roman edition; in two sure (61, 12; 66, 11) and three possible (63, 2; 66, 7, 12) cases, with both *p* and *r*. Once he breaks away from all editions reported by

Keil and agrees with *D* (62, 6). At the same time, all these readings are attested by *PIFB* and hence were presumably in the Parisinus. In two cases (65, 11, 24), we know of no source other than *P* that could have furnished him his reading. Further, in the superscription of the third letter of Book III (63, 20), he might have taken a hint from Catanaeus, who was the first to depart from the reading *CORNELIAE*, universally accepted before him, but again it is only *P* that could give him the correct spelling *CORELLIAE*.⁶³

If all the above readings, then, were in the Parisinus, how did Aldus arrive at them? Did he fish round, now in the Princeps, now in the Roman edition, despite the repellent errors that those texts contained,⁶⁴ and extract with felicitous accuracy excellent readings that coincided with those of the Parisinus, or did he draw them straight from that source itself? The crucial cases are 65, 11 and 24. As he must have gone to the Parisinus for these readings, he presumably found the others there, too. Moreover, he did not get his new variants by a merely sporadic consultation of the ancient book when he was dissatisfied with the accepted text of his day, for in the two crucial cases and many of the others, too, that text makes sense; some of the readings, indeed, are accepted by modern editors as correct.⁶⁵ Aldus was collating. He carefully noted minutiae, such as the omission of *et* and *iam*, and accepted what he found, unless the ancient text seemed to him indisputably wrong. He gave it the benefit of the doubt even when it may be wrong. This is the method of a scrupulous editor who cherishes a proper veneration for his oldest and best authority.

Budaeus, on the other hand, is not an editor. He is a vastly interested reader of Pliny, frequently commenting on the subject-matter or calling attention to it by marginal signs. As for the text, he generally finds Beroaldus good enough. He corrects misprints, makes a conjecture now and then, or adopts one of Catanaeus, and, besides supplementing the missing portions with transcripts made for him from the Parisinus, inserts numerous variants, some of which indubitably come from that manuscript.⁶⁶ In the present section, occupying 251 lines in *II*, there is only one reading of the Parisinus—a false reading, it happens—that seems to Budaeus worth recording. Compared with what Aldus gleaned from *II*, Budaeus's extracts are insignificant. It is remarkable, for instance, that on a passage (65, 11)

which, as the appended obelus shows, he must have read with attention, he has not added the very different reading of the Parisinus. Either, then, Budaeus did not consult the Parisinus with care, or he did not think the great majority of its readings preferable to the text of Beroaldus, or, as I think may well have been the case, he had neither the manuscript itself nor an entire copy of it accessible at the time when he added his variants in his combined edition of Beroaldus and Avantius.⁶⁷

But I do not mean to present here a final estimate of Budaeus; for that, I hope, we may look to Professor Merrill. Nor do I particularly blame Budaeus for not constructing a new text from the wealth of material disclosed in the Parisinus. His interests lay elsewhere; *suos quoque mos*. What I mean to say, and to say with some conviction, is that for the portion of text included in our fragment, the evidence of that fragment, coupled with that of *B* and *F*, shows that as a witness to the ancient manuscript Aldus is overwhelmingly superior to either Budaeus or any of the ancient editors.

Our examination of the Morgan fragment, therefore, leads to what I deem a highly probable conclusion. We could perhaps hope for absolute proof in a matter of this kind only if another page of the same manuscript should appear, bearing a note in the hand of Aldus Manutius to the effect that he had used the codex for his edition of 1508. Failing that, we can at least point out that all the data accessible comport with the hypothesis that the Morgan fragment was a part of this very codex. We have set our hypothesis running a lengthy gauntlet of facts, and none has tripped it yet. We have also seen that *II* is most intimately connected with manuscripts *BF* of Class I, and indeed seems to be a part of the very manuscript whence they are descended. Finally, a careful comparison of Aldus's text with *II* shows him, for this much of the *Letters* at least, to be a scrupulous and conscientious editor. His method is to follow *II* throughout, save when, confronted by its obvious blunders, he has recourse to the editions of his day.

The latest criticism of Aldus Since the publication of Otto's article in 1886,⁶⁸ in which the author defended the *F* branch against that of *MV*, to which, as the elder representative of the tradition, Keil had not unnaturally

deferred, critical procedure has gradually shifted its centre. The reappearance of *B* greatly helped, as it corroborates the testimony of *F*. *B* and *F* head the list of the manuscripts used by Kukula in his edition of 1912,⁶⁹ and *B* and *F* with Aldus's Parisinus make up Class I, not Class II, in Merrill's grouping of the manuscripts. Obviously, the value of Class I mounts higher still now that we have evidence in the Morgan fragment of its existence in the early sixth century. This fact helps us to decide the question of glosses in our text. We are more than ever disposed to attribute not to *BF* but to what has now become the younger branch of the tradition, Class II, the tendency to interpolate explanatory glosses. The changed attitude towards the *BF* branch has naturally resulted in a gradual transformation of the text. We have seen in the portion included in *II* that of the eleven readings which Keil regarded as errors of the *F* branch, three are accepted by Kukula and five by Merrill.⁷⁰

Since Class I has thus appreciated in value, we should expect that Aldus's stock would also take an upward turn. In Aldus's lifetime, curiously, he was criticized for excessive conservatism. His rival Catanaeus finds his chief quality *supina ignorantia* and adds:⁷¹

“Verum enim uero non satis est recuperare venerandae vetustatis exemplaria, nisi etiam simul adsit acre emendatoris iudicium: quoniam et veteres librarii in voluminibus describendis saepissime falsi sunt, et Plinius ipse scripta sua se viuo deprauari in quadam epistola demonstraerit.”

Nowadays, however, editors hesitate to accept an unsupported reading of Aldus as that of the Parisinus, since they believe that he abounds in those very conjectures of which Catanaeus felt the lack. The attitude of the expert best qualified to judge is still one of suspicion towards Aldus. In his most recent article,⁷² Professor Merrill declares that Keil's remarks⁷³ on the procedure of Aldus in the part of Book X already edited by Avantius, Beroaldus, and Catanaeus might safely have been extended to cover the work of Aldus on the entire body of the *Letters*. He proceeds to subject Aldus to a new test, the material for which we owe to Merrill's own researches. He compares with Aldus's text the manuscript parts of the Bodleian volume, which are apparently transcripts from the Parisinus

(= *I*);⁷⁴ in them Budaeus with his own hand (= *i*) has corrected on the authority of the Parisinus itself, according to Merrill, the errors of his transcriber. In a few instances, Merrill allows, Budaeus has substituted conjectures of his own. This material, obviously, offers a valuable criterion of Aldus's methods as an editor. There is a further criterion in the shape of Codex *M*, not utilized till after Aldus's edition. As this manuscript represents Class II, concurrences between *M* and *Ii* against *a* make it tolerably certain that Aldus himself and no higher authority is responsible for such readings. On this basis, Merrill cites twenty-five readings in the added part of Book VIII (viii, 3 *quas obvias*—xviii, II *amplissimos hortos*) and nineteen readings in the added part of Book X (letters iv-xli), which represent examples "wherein Aldus abandons indubitably satisfactory readings of his only and much belauded manuscript in favor of conjectures of his own."⁷⁵ Letter IX xvi, a very short affair, added by Budaeus in the margin, contains no indictment against Aldus.

Aldus's methods in the newly discovered parts of Books VIII, IX, and X

The result of this exposure, Professor Merrill declares, should convince "any unprejudiced student" of the question that "Aldus stands clearly convicted of being an extremely unsafe textual critic of Pliny's *Letters*."⁷⁶ "This conclusion does not depend, as that of Keil necessarily did, on any native or acquired acuteness of critical perception. The wayfaring man, though a fool, need not err therein."⁷⁷ I speak as a wayfarer, but nevertheless I must own that Professor Merrill's path of argument causes me to stumble. I readily admit that Aldus, in editing a portion of text that no man had put into print before him, fell back on conjecture when his authority seemed not to make sense. But Merrill's lists need revision. He has included with Aldus's "willful deviations" from the true text of *P* certain readings that almost surely were misprints (218, 12; 220, 3), some that may well be (as 217, 28; 221, 12), one case in which Aldus has retained an error of *P* while *I* emends (221, 11), and several cases in which Aldus and *I* or *i* emend in different ways an error of *P* (222, 14; 226, 5; 272, 4—not 5). In one case he misquotes Aldus, when the latter really has the reading that both Merrill and Keil indicate as correct (276, 21); in another he fails to remark that Aldus's erroneous reading is supported by *M*

(219,17). However, even after discounting these and possibly other instances, a significant array of conjectures remains. Still, it is not fair to call the Parisinus Aldus's *only* manuscript. We know that he had other material in the six volumes of manuscripts and collated editions sent him by Giocondo, as well as the latter's copy of *P*. There could hardly have been in this number a source superior to the Parisinus, but Giocondo may have added here and there his own or others' conjectures, which Aldus adopted unwisely, but at least not solely on his own authority; the most apparent case of interpolation (224, 8) Keil thought might have been a conjecture of Giocondo's. Further, if the general character of *P* is represented in *II*, Book X, as well as the beginning of Book III, may have had variants by the second hand, sometimes taken by Aldus and neglected, wisely, by Budaeus's transcriber.

The Morgan fragment the best criterion of Aldus With the discovery of the Morgan fragment, a new criterion of Aldus is offered. I believe that it is the surest starting-point from which to investigate Aldus's relation to his ancient manuscript. I admit that for Book X, Avantius and the Bodleian volume in its added parts are better authorities for the Parisinus than is Aldus. I admit that Aldus resorted throughout the text of the *Letters*—in some cases unhappily—to the customary editorial privilege of emendation. But I nevertheless maintain that for the entire text he is a much better authority than the Bodleian volume as a whole, and that he should be given, not absolute confidence, but far more confidence than editors have thus far allowed him. Nor is the section of text preserved in the fragment of small significance for our purpose. Indeed, both for Aldus and in general, I think it even more valuable than a corresponding amount of Book X would be. We could wish that it were longer, but at least it includes a number of crucial readings and above all vouches for the existence of the indices some two hundred years before the date previously assigned for their compilation. It also supplies a final confirmation of the value of Class I; indeed, *B* and *F*, the manuscripts of this class, appear to have descended from the very manuscript of which *II* was a part. We see still more clearly than before that *BF* can be used elsewhere in the *Letters* as a test of Aldus, and we also note that these manuscripts contain errors not in the Parisinus. This is a highly

important factor for forming a true estimate of Aldus and one that we could not deduce from a fragment of Book X, which *BF* do not contain.

Conclusion I conclude, then, that the Morgan fragment is a piece of the Parisinus, and that we may compare with Aldus's text the very words which he studied out, carefully collated, and treated with a decent respect. On the basis of the new information furnished us by the fragment, I shall endeavor, at some future time, to confirm my present judgement of Aldus by testing him in the entire text of Pliny's *Letters*. Further, despite Merrill's researches and his brilliant analysis, I am not convinced that the last word has been spoken on the nature of the transcript made for Budaeus and incorporated in the Bodleian volume. I will not, however, venture on this broad field until Professor Merrill, who has the first right to speak, is enabled to give to the world his long-expected edition. Meanwhile, if my view is right, we owe to the acquisition of the ancient fragment by the Pierpont Morgan Library a new confidence in the integrity of Aldus, a clearer understanding of the history of the *Letters* in the early Middle Ages, and a surer method of editing their text.

NOTES TO PART II

³⁷ [1.](#) I would acknowledge most gratefully the help given me in the preparation of this part of our discussion by Professor E. T. Merrill, of the University of Chicago. Professor Merrill, whose edition of the *Letters* of Pliny has long been in the hands of Teubner, placed at my disposal his proof-sheets for the part covered in the Morgan fragment, his preliminary *apparatus criticus* for the entire text of the *Letters*, and a card-catalogue of the readings of *B* and *F*. He patiently answered numerous questions and subjected the first draft of my argument to a searching criticism which saved me from errors in fact and in expression. But Professor Merrill should not be held responsible for errors that remain or for my estimate of the Morgan fragment.

[2.](#) On Petrus Leander, see Merrill in *Classical Philology* V (1910), pp. 451 f.

³⁸ [3.](#) *C.P.* II (1907), pp. 134 f.

[4.](#) *C.P.* X (1915), pp. 18 f.

[5.](#) By Merrill, *C.P.* V (1910), pp. 455 ff.

[6.](#) Sandys, *A History of Classical Studies* II (1908), pp. 99 ff.

³⁹ [7.](#) *C.P.* II, p. 135.

[8.](#) See [plate XVII](#), which shows the insertion in Book VIII.

[9.](#) *Journal of Philology* XVII (1888), pp. 95 ff., and in the introduction to his edition of the *Tenth Book* (1889), pp. 75 ff.

[10.](#) See Merrill *C.P.* II, p. 136.

⁴⁰ [11.](#) *C.P.* II, pp. 129 ff.

[12.](#) In his edition, pp. xxiii f.

[13.](#) *C.P.* II, p. 152.

[14.](#) *C.P.* V, p. 466.

[15.](#) *C.P.* II, p. 156.

⁴¹ [16.](#) See Dr. Lowe's remarks, [pp. 3-6](#) above.

[17.](#) See above, [p. 21](#), and below, [p. 53](#).

⁴² [18.](#) The spellings *Karet* and *Karitas*, whether Pliny's or not, are a sign of antiquity. In the first century A.D., as we see from Velius Longus (p. 53, 12 K) and Quintilian (I, 7, 10), certain old-timers clung to the use of *k* for *c* when the vowel *a* followed. By the fourth century, theorists of the opposite tendency proposed the abandonment of *k* and *q* as superfluous letters, since their functions were performed by *c*. Donatus (p. 368, 7 K) and Diomedes, too, according to Keil (p. 423, 11), still believed in the rule of *ka* for *ca*, but these rigid critics had passed away in the time of Servius, who, in his commentary on Donatus (p. 422, 35 K), remarks *k vero et q aliter nos utimur, aliter usi sunt maiores nostri. Namque illi, quotienscumque a sequebatur, k praeponerant in omni parte orationis, ut Kaput et similia; nos vero non usurpamus k litteram nisi in Kalendarum nomine scribendo*. See also Cledonius (p. 28, 5K); W. Brambach, *Latein*.

Orthog. 1868, pp. 210 ff.; W. M. Lindsay, *The Latin Language*, 1894, pp. 6 f. There would thus be no temptation for a scribe at the end of the fifth century or the beginning of the sixth to adopt *ka* for *ca* as a habit. The writer of our fragment was copying faithfully from his original a spelling that he apparently would not have used himself. There are various other cases of *ca* in our text (e.g., *calceos*, III, i, 4; *canere*, 11), but there we find the usual spelling. On traces of *ka* in the Bellovacensis, see below, [p. 57](#). I should not be surprised if Pliny himself employed the spelling *ka*, which was gradually modified in the successive copies of his work; it may be, however, that our manuscript represents a text which had passed through the hand of some archaeologizing scholar of a later age, like Donatus. At any rate, this feature of our fragment is an indication of genuineness and of antiquity.

⁴⁴ [19](#). *C.P.* X (1915), pp. 8 ff. A classified list of the manuscripts of the *Letters* is given by Miss Dora Johnson in *C.P.* VII (1912), pp. 66 ff.

[20](#). *Pal. des Class. Lat.* pl. CXLIII. See our [plates XIII](#) and [XIV](#). At least as early as the thirteenth century, the manuscript was at Beauvais. The ancient press-mark *S. Petri Beluacensis*, in writing perhaps of the twelfth century, may still be discerned on the recto of the first folio. See Merrill, *C.P.* X, p. 16. If the book was written at Beauvais, as Chatelain thinks (*Journal des Savants*, 1900, p. 48), then something like what I call the mid-century style of Fleury was also cultivated, possibly a bit later, in the north. The Beauvais Horace, Leidensis lat. 28 saec. IX (Chatelain, pl. LXXVIII), shows a certain similarity in the script to that of *B*. If both were done at Beauvais, the Horace would seem to be the later book. It belongs, we may observe, to a group of manuscripts of which a Floriacensis (Paris lat. 7971) is a conspicuous member. To settle the case of *B*, we need a study of all the books of Beauvais. For this, a valuable preliminary survey is given by Omont in *Mém. de l'Acad. des Ins. et Belles Lettres* XL (1914), pp. 1 ff.

[21](#). *Specimina Cod. Lat. Vatic.* 1912, pl. 30. See also H. M. Bannister, *Paleografia Musicale Vaticana* 1913, p. 30, No. 109.

[22.](#) See the preface to his edition, p. xi.

⁴⁵ [23.](#) For the script of *F*, see [plates XV](#) and [XVI](#). Bern. 136, s. XIII (Merrill, *C.P.* X, p. 18) is a copy of *F*.

[24.](#) Cod. Med. LXVIII, 1. See Rostagno in the preface to his edition of this manuscript in the Leyden series, and for the Pliny, Chatelain, *Pal. des Class. Lat.*, pl. CXLV. Keil (edition, p. vi), followed by Kukula (edition, p. iv), incorrectly assigns the manuscript to the tenth century. The latest treatment is by Paul Lehmann in his "Corveyer Studien," in *Abhandl. der Bayer. Akad. der Wiss. Philos.-philol. u. hist. Klasse*, XXX, 5 (1919), p. 38. He assigns it to the middle or the last half of the ninth century.

[25.](#) Chatelain calls the page of Pliny that he reproduces (pl. CXLIV) tenth century, but attributes the Sallust portion of the manuscript, although this seems of a piece with the style of the Pliny, to the ninth; see pl. LIV. Hauler, who has given the most complete account of the manuscript, thinks it "*saec.* IX/X" (*Wiener Studien* XVII (1895), p. 124). He shows, as others had done before him, the close association of the book with Bernensis 357, and of that codex with Fleury.

[26.](#) See Merrill *C.P.* X, p. 23. The catalogue (G. Becker, *Catalogi bibliothecarum antiqui*, p. 282) was prepared about 1200, and is of Corbie, not as Merrill has it, Corvey. Chatelain (on plate LIV) regards the book as "provenant du monastère de Corbie." At my request, Mr. H. J. Leon, Sheldon Fellow of Harvard University, recently examined the manuscript, and neither he nor Monsignore Mercati, the Prefect of the Vatican Library, could discover any note or library-mark to indicate that the book is a Corbeiensis. In a recent article, *Philol. Quart.* I (1922), pp. 17 ff.), Professor Ullman is inclined, after a careful analysis of the evidence, to assign the manuscript to Corbie, but allows for the possibility that it was written in Tours or the neighborhood and thence sent to Corbie.

[27.](#) *C.P.* X, p. 23.

⁴⁶ [28](#). See Paul Lehmann, “Aufgaben und Anregungen der lateinischen Philologie des Mittelalters,” in *Sitzungsberichte der Bayer. Akad. der Wiss. Philos.-philol. u. hist. Klasse*, 1918, 8, pp. 14 ff. I am indebted to Professor Lehmann for the facts on the basis of which I have made the statement above. To quote his exact words, the contents of the manuscript are as follows: “Fol. 1-31^v Briefe des Hierononymus u. Gregorius Magnus + fol. 46^v-47^v, Briefe des Plinius an Tacitus u. Albinus, in kontinentaler, wohl Regensburger Minuskel etwa der Mitte des 9^{ten} Jahrhunderts, *unter starken insularen (angelsächsischen) Einfluss* in Buchstabenformen, Abkürzungen, etc. Fol. 32^r *saec. IX^{ex} vel Xⁱⁿ*. fol. 32^v-46^r in der Hauptsache *direkt insular* mit historischen Notizen in festländischer Style. Fol. 48^v-128 Ambrosius *saec. Xⁱⁿ*.”

[29](#). *Commentatiuncula de C. Plinii Caecilii Secundi epistularum fragmento Vossiano notis tironianis descripto* (in *Exercitationes Palaeog. in Bibl. Univ. Lugduno-Bat.*, 1890). De Vries ascribes the fragment to the ninth century and is sure that the writing is French (p. 12). His reproduction, though not photographic, gives an essentially correct idea of the script. The text of the fragment is inferior to that of *MV*, with which manuscripts it is undoubtedly associated. In one error it agrees with *V* against *M*. Chatelain (*Introduction à la Lecture des Notes Tironiennes*, 1900), though citing De Vries’s publication in his bibliography (p. xv), does not discuss the character of the notes in this fragment. I must leave it for experts in tachygraphy to decide whether the style of the Tironian notes is that of the school of Orléans.

[30](#). See Merrill’s discussion of the different possibilities, *C.P. X*, p. 14.

⁴⁷ [31](#). *C.P. X*, p. 20.

⁴⁸ [32](#). I have not always followed Dr. Lowe in distinguishing first and second hands in the various alterations discussed here ([pp. 48-50](#)).

[33](#). See above, [p. 42](#).

[34.](#) See above, [pp. 11 f.](#)

⁴⁹ [35.](#) See [plates XIII-XIV.](#)

[36.](#) See [plate XIV.](#)

⁵⁰ [37.](#) There are one or two divergencies in spelling hardly worth mention. The most important are 63, 10 caret *B* KARET *II*; caritas *B* KARITAS *II*. Yet see below, [p. 57](#), where it is shown that the ancient spelling is found in *B* elsewhere than in the portion of text included in *II*.

⁵¹ [38.](#) *C.P.* V, pp. 467 ff. and 476 ff., and for the supposed lack of indices in *P*, p. 485.

[39.](#) I venture to disagree with Dr. Lowe's view (above, [p. 25](#)) that the addition is by the first hand.

[40.](#) See above, [p. 11.](#)

[41.](#) See [plate XIV.](#)

⁵² [42.](#) See above, [pp. 48 f.](#)

⁵³ [43.](#) See above, [p. 44, n. 2.](#)

[44.](#) "Zur frühen Ueberlieferungsgeschichte des Briefwechsels zwischen Plinius und Trajan," in *Wiener Studien* XXXI (1909), p. 258.

[45.](#) See above, [pp. 21, 41.](#)

⁵⁴ [46.](#) See above, [p. 22.](#)

[47.](#) *The Descent of Manuscripts*, 1918, p. 16. Professor Clark counts on two pages chosen at random, 23-31 letters in the line. My count for *II* includes the nine and a third pages on which full lines occur. If I had taken only foll. 52^r, 52^v, 53^r and 53^v, I should have found no lines of 32 or 33 letters. On the other hand, the first page to which I turned in the Vindobonensis of Livy (133^v) has a line of 32 letters, and so has 135^v, while 136^v has one of 33. The lines of *II* are a shade longer than those of the Vindobonensis, but only a shade.

⁵⁵ [48.](#) *Ibidem*, pp. vi, 9-18. There is some danger of pushing Professor Clark's method too far, particularly when it is applied to New Testament problems. For a well-considered criticism of the book, see Merrill's review in the *Classical Journal* XIV (1919), pp. 395 ff.

⁵⁷ [49.](#) See above, [pp. 42, n. 1](#), and [50, n. 1](#).

⁵⁸ [50.](#) See the introduction to his edition, p. xviii.

[51.](#) See below, [pp. 60 ff.](#)

[52.](#) *Op. cit.*, p. xxv: illis potissimum Aldum usum esse vidi.

[53.](#) *Op. cit.*, pp. xviii, xx.

[54.](#) *Op. cit.*, p. 2: Ex ꝑ pauca adscripta sunt.

[55.](#) *Op. cit.*, p. xxxii.

⁵⁹ [56.](#) See Ribbeck's Virgil, *Prolegomena*, p. 152.

[57.](#) See [plate XVIII](#).

[58.](#) *Epist.* III, i ([plate IV](#)).

[59.](#) See [plate XVIII](#).

⁶⁰ [60.](#) See above, [p. 47](#).

[61.](#) The readings of manuscripts are taken from Merrill, those of the editions from Keil; in the latter case, I use parentheses if the reading is only implied, not stated.

⁶¹ [62.](#) I say "possible" because the reading is implied, not stated, in Keil's edition. The reading of Beroaldus on 63, 23 I get from our photograph, not from Keil, who does not give it.

[63.](#) I have purposely omitted to treat Aldus's use of the superscriptions in *P*, as that matter is best reserved for a consideration of the superscriptions in general.

[64.](#) See above, [p. 58](#).

[65.](#) See above, [pp. 47 f.](#)

⁶² [66.](#) See Merrill, “Zur frühen Ueberlieferungsgeschichte des Briefwechsels zwischen Plinius und Trajan,” in *Wiener Studien* XXXI (1909), p. 257; *C.P.* II, p. 154; XIV, p. 30 f. Two examples (216, 23 and 227, 18) will be noted in [plate XVII a](#).

[67.](#) Certain errors of the scribe who wrote the additional pages in the Bodleian book warrant the surmise that he was copying not the Parisinus itself, but some copy of it. Thus in 227, 14 (see [plate XVII b](#)) we find him writing *Tamen* for *tum*, Budaeus correcting this error in the margin. A scribe is of course capable of anything, but with an uncial *tum* to start from, *tamen* is not a natural mistake to commit; it would rather appear that the scribe falsely resolved a minuscule abbreviation.

⁶³ [68.](#) “Die Ueberlieferung der Briefe des jüngeren Plinius,” in *Hermes* XXI (1886), pp. 287 ff.

[69.](#) See [p. iv](#).

[70.](#) See above, [pp. 47 f](#).

[71.](#) See the prefatory letter in his edition of 1518.

[72.](#) *C.P.* XIV (1919), pp. 29 ff.

[73.](#) *Op. cit.*, p. xxxvii: nam ea quae aliter in Aldina editione atque in illis (i.e., Avantius, Beroaldus, and Catanaeus) exhibentur ita comparata sunt omnia, ut coniectura potius inventa quam e codice profecta esse existimanda sint et plura quidem in pravis et temerariis interpolationibus versantur.

⁶⁴ [74.](#) But see above, [p. 62, n. 2](#).

[75.](#) Pp. 31 ff.

[76.](#) P. 33.

[77.](#) P. 30.

DESCRIPTION OF PLATES.

Large plates are shown at about 3/4 original size.

Nos. I-XII. New York, The Pierpont Morgan Library, MS. M. 462. A fragment of 12 pages of an uncial manuscript of the early sixth century. The fragment contains Pliny's *Letters*, Book II, xx. 13—Book III, v. 4. For a detailed description, see above, [pp. 3 ff.](#) The entire fragment is here given, very slightly reduced. The exact size of the script is shown in Plate XX.



[Plate I](#)



[Plate II](#)



[Plate III](#)



[Plate IV](#)



[Plate V](#)



[Plate VI](#)



[Plate VII](#)



[Plate VIII](#)



[Plate IX](#)



[Plate X](#)



[Plate XI](#)



[Plate XII](#)

XIII-XIV. Florence, Laurentian Library MS. Ashburnham R 98, known as Codex Bellovacensis (*B*) or Riccardianus (*R*), written in Caroline minuscule of the ninth century. See above, [p. 44](#). Our plates reproduce fols. 9 and 9^v (slightly reduced), containing the end of Book II and the beginning of Book III.



[Plate XIII](#)



[Plate XIV](#)

XV-XVI. Florence, Laurentian Library MS. San Marco 284, written in Caroline minuscule of the tenth century. See above, [pp. 44 f.](#) Our plates

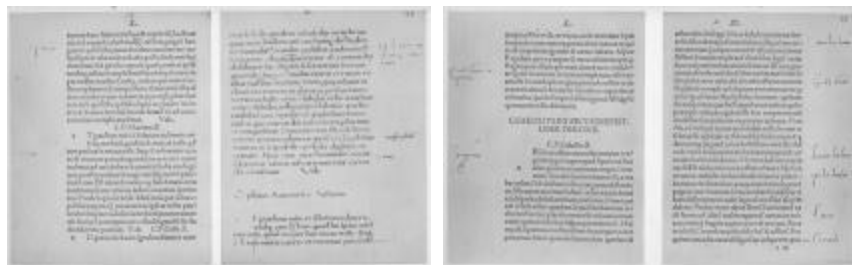
reproduce fols. 56^v and 57^r, containing the end of Book II and the beginning of Book III.



[Plate XV](#)

[Plate XVI](#)

XVII-XVIII. Oxford, Bodleian Library, Auct. L 4. 3. See above, [pp. 39 f.](#) The lacuna in Book VIII (216, 27-227, 10 Keil) is indicated by a cross (+) on fol. 136^v (plate XVII^a). The missing text is supplied on added leaves by the hand shown on plate XVII^b (= fol. 144). The variants are in the hand of Budaeus. Plate XVIII contains fols. 32^v and 33, showing the end of Book II and the beginning of Book III.



[Plate XVII](#)

[Plate XVIII](#)

XIX. Aldine edition of Pliny's *Letters*, Venice 1508. Our plate reproduces the end of Book II and the beginning of Book III.



[Plate XIX](#)

XX. Specimens of three uncial manuscripts:

(a) Berlin, Königl. Bibl. Lat. 4° 298, circa a. 447.

(b) New York, The Pierpont Morgan Library, MS. M. 462, circa a. 500 (exact size).

(c) Fulda, Codex Bonifatianus 1, ante a. 547.



[Plate XX](#)

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A SIXTH-
CENTURY FRAGMENT OF THE LETTERS OF PLINY THE
YOUNGER ***

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opacus hunc subter exit fons & exprimit pluribus uen-
nis: sed imparibaeluctatus. Quae facit gurgitē lato
gremio patefacto purus & uitreus ut numerare iaci-
tas stipes & relucētēs calculos possis. Inde non loci
deuexitate sed ipsa sui copia & quasi pondere ipelli-
turs fons adhuc ē amplissimū flumē atq; ēt nauium
patiēsthic munus Codex. eodem quo emerat in-
struxit plurimis & antiquissimis statuistatū illi pul-
cherri morū operum in horreis quae negligebatur
cem tu si quid istic epistola dignū ne grauerē scribe-
re: nā cū aures hominū leuitate latant tū ad ratio-
nem uitae exemplis erudimur. Vale.

C.P. Maximo. S.

¶ T gaudium mihi & solatium in litteris: ni-
hilq; tam latū quod his latius: tā triste qd
non per has sit minus triste. Itaq; & infirmitate uxo-
ris & meorum periculo: quorūdam uero etiā morte
turbatus ad unū doloris leuamētū studia confugi:
quae praestāt ut aduersa magis intelligam: sed patiē-
tius feram. Est autē mihi moris: q; sum daturus i ma-
nus hominū ante amicos: iudicio examinare iprimis
tuo. Proinde si qn nūc itēde i librū meū quē cū hac e-
pistola accipies. Quia ueror ne ipse ut tristis pas-
sē tēderi: impare. n. dolori ut scribere potuist uacuo
aīo letoq; n̄ potui: porro ut ex studiis gaudiū sic stu-
dia hilaritate pueniūt. Vale. C.P. Gallo. S.

a D quae noscēda iter ingredi: trasmittef mare

ne in ledulo quidem nisi ab alijs mouebatur.
quinetiam foedum miserandumq; die iuden-
tes lauandos fircandos praebat. auditum est
frequenter ab ipso quereretur de contumelijs
debilitatis suae: digitos se seruorum suorum
quotidie lingere: uiuebat tamen et uiuere vo-
lebat sustinēte maxime uxore, quae culpam in-
chaati matrimonij in gloriam perseuerantia
verterat. habes omnes fabulas urbis nam sunt
omnes fabulae, nullus. expectabatur auctio.
enim fuit tam copiosus ut amplissimos hortos
eodem quo emerat die intruxerit. plurimis
et antiquissimis statuistatū illi pulcherri-
morū operum in horreis quasi nec legebatur
mutem tu si quid de epistula dignum ne
grauare. Nam cum aures hominum nouita-
te letantur tamen ad rationem uitae exem-
plis erudimur. Vale

C. Plinius Maximo suo Salutem.

¶ T gaudium mihi et solatium in litteris,
nihilq; tam letum quod his letius: nihil
tam triste quod non per has minus triste. Itaq;
et infirmitate uxoris et meorum periculo

[back](#)

duo a haec & sonantia quam iuxta & pressa delectant.
 aliquid enim ammodo turpis ista discordia est tamen quis
 plerumque tuetur: ut aliud iudices exigant: cum al-
 liquis praecipue auditor adfidebeat: quibus
 iudex si forte iudex maxime mouetur: potest tamen
 si utique quam in his difficultatibus libris in noui-
 tas. Et si necesse est: ne utique apud nostros: apud grae-
 cos enim est quiddam quamuis ex diuersis sonantiam
 omnino dissimile: nam ualliserat moris leges quas
 ut conparias prioribus legibus arguebant: aliarum
 conlatione conuincere: ita nobis esse repetenda in danti
 legi quod postularimus: cum haec ipsa lege tumulus
 colligendum fuit: quod nequaquam blandum auri-
 bus imperitorum tantum maiorem apud doctos ha-
 bere gratiam debet: quam tamen in apud in doc-
 tos habet: nos autem si placuerit et cetera: adhibi-
 tur sumus: eruditissimum quomque saltem ad huc
 an si recte dandum ex amine rectum: omnisque quos
 ego moui in utraque per recta oculos pone: id que
 eligere in quod uicerit ratio: ac tamen ratio suggerat:
 nos ex cunctis obsequium. **VALLE**

C. PLINIUS CALVISIO SVO SALUTEM

Attenuata & accipe auream fabulam fabulati-
 mo. Nam me in nouis ad hunc: nec refert quo
 potissimum incipiam uerum: apud sonis ignis uer-
 uacabat huius discipulis quibus galba ad optauit: ad hanc regu-
 lus uenit primum in pu dentiam hominis quia uenit ad
 aegram: cuius in uento in uicissimus: ipse in uicissimus
 fuerat: ubi uenit tantum: ad illam primum uero sedie
 quod die qua hora na cessat in interrogauit: ubi caudit:
 componit ualium: in tendit oculos: mouet labra: ag-
 rat edigit: compitac nichil: ut diu in uero expectatione
 suspendit: habet inquit dimittit in uento: sed euadet
 quod ducit in uento: liquet: aruspice consul conuen-
 sum frequenter: expertus: nec mori sacrificium facit: ad-
 firmitur ex a cum siderum significacione congruere: illa
 ut in periculo credula postea di allos: legat in regulos
 bit: mox in grauias: clamor in uento: hominem nequam
 perfidum a plura con quam per uerum: quibus in per alu-
 tem filia per uero: facit in uento: in uento in uento
 quam frequenter: quod in uento: quod in uento

fallit: ut caput in uento: id est: ut caput in uento
 blar: si ille locupletis: si uero: si uero: si uero
 dine conflatabatur: cupiebat mutare testamen-
 tum: regulis qui speraret aliquid ex nouis tabu-
 lis: qui uero: qui uero: qui uero: qui uero
 tati rogare quo: qui in uento: qui in uento
 rogarent: postquam signatum est testamentum
 mutae sonam uerba ad locutionem: idem que me-
 dias: qui uero: qui uero: qui uero: qui uero
 bonam: qui uero: qui uero: qui uero: qui uero
 blefus: & tamquam moneta audis: si uero: si uero
 tulum quidem: sufficiunt duae fabulae: anseho
 lastica legere: tamposit: in uento: in uento
 ornata femina signatura: res: in uento: in uento
 rat pulcherrima: si uero: si uero: si uero: si uero
 ad signandum: rogare: in uento: in uento
 ludere hominem: qui uero: qui uero: qui uero: qui uero
 ta coegit mulierem: aperire: in uento: in uento
 cas: qui uero: in uento: in uento: in uento
 tem in uento: in uento: in uento: in uento
 ille tamen: in uento: in uento: in uento
 hic hereditas: hic legat: qui uero: qui uero

**C. PLINII SECONDI
 EPIS TULARI EXPLICIT II
 INCIPIT LIBER III FELICIT**

A dactylus in uento: ut uero in uento
 A diu in uento: Quod ipse in uento
 A dactylus in uento: Cum patet in uento
 A dactylus in uento: Quamuis in uento
 A dactylus in uento: Pergrat in uento
 A dactylus in uento: Ex hereditate quae

Adcornium rufum	Modomintia cist
Adcornium trisqui	Lucia dproctera
Adcornium mianu	Postumiamperitib
Aduectric spurma	Composuisse mequial
Adulungentor	Stommi mearenidors
Adaculum suer	Uonam adognam
Aduecomum ranci	Librum quonidip
Adpaulum	Rematrocon
Adsilum proad	Scisutubellosof of
Adnepsom	Adnotat fuiden faaa
Adulium ferper	Reucomia
Adumrum foverm	officium amulatit
Adcalusium rufim	Adsumozon consili
Adm asium maculum	Mommihne
Adcornelium pricum	Aluo ualenimdrad

Nescio an illam iucundius tempestiviora qua
 quovis per alia spemina huiusmodi idem uteremur
 magnis inter se similes fieri docuimus et amula
 ruerunt nichil enim ille uita et more distinet
 me aut uteris si sideris aut in quibus hominibus
 politica delectat. semper praeferunt namque ueris ad
 huc confusa quae etiam & quasi turbata non inde
 ceteris sensibus placida omnia & ordinata conueniunt
 quibus industria ferua turpis ambrosia honor
 gulem spemina confectis timere uat quid etiam
 parua hic parua si non cotidie fiant ordine quod
 e uoluit orbem praegre. nam placida continentur
 horum secunda calceos posset ambulare miles passus
 tres normis animi quod uis per carere si ad hinc
 amica honestas si sermone expleantur si non
 ber legatur in conditum si sensibus amicis. nam
 illi non erant autem deinde confide. & liberris
 alio sermone libropior in actum alio ad
 sumit uolunt in gulem in exempli ueluti quem
 amicum in hoc prope. quam pulchrum illud
 quod uita ferretur quantum in brant quae
 facit quos in res audias quibus per se in bua
 quamuis ille in tempore in modis sua et
 dixit ne perire uideatur per alia spemina
 in passum iterum ambulare mille iterum elide

C. PLINIUS MAXIMO SVO SALUTEM

quā parentes p̄fuit vale

HORTARIS ut oratione. amicitia plurib; recte. facia q̄ hortari q̄m ut
themē addubitat. Neq; enī me p̄tere. actiones querebant impaū omē
caloreq; ac ppe nom suū p̄dere ut quas sola cōmēdare simul. rascendert
iudiciū cōfēt. celebritas aduocatorū. expectatio. euent. fama nūmū
accorū. deducūq; impetres audientū studiū. ad hoc ducenat gestus. uict
sus. discurs. dīa. omib; q̄ morib; animi cōsentaneū uigor corporis. Vnde
accidit. ut hī quiescentes agunt. quāuis illis maxima ex parte sup̄st
eadē illa que stantib; . tam hoc qd̄ sedent. quasi debilitentur. idē p̄mā
cur. Recitantū ū p̄cipua p̄nunciatiois adiuncta oculi manus. p̄p̄e
diunt. Quomun̄ mirū ē. si auditorū incencio relanguiscit. nullis
exeritē aut blandimētis capta aut oculis excitata. hīs accedit. qd̄ ora
tio de qua loquit. pugnae icona p̄iosa ē. Porro uicāta comparatū ē.
ut ea que scripsim cū labore. dīa cū labore audiri p̄tem. O sane quō
quisq; cā rē. iudiciū. quē n̄ potius dulcia hec risonancia. q̄a uicta ip̄sū
delectent. Est quidē omino curbis ista discordia. Est cām que plerūq;
euent. ut aliud iudices exigunt. cū alloquū p̄cipue audiri adfici
debet. Quib; idē sifora iudex. maxime p̄mouerātur. P̄est cām fieri.
ut quāquā m̄his difficultatib; libro isti nouitas lenocina. nouitas ap̄
n̄os. Apud grecos enī ē. quiddā quāuis ex diuerso. n̄cām omino diffi
mule. Nā ut illis erat moris leges quas. conuarias p̄orib; legib; argue
bant. aliatū conlacione conuincere. ita nob̄ ē. rep̄undarū legi quod
postularemus. cū hac ipsa lege tū alius colligendū fuit. Qd̄ nequaquā
blandū aurib; impitoy. tanto maiore ap̄ doctos habere grām debet. q̄to
minore ap̄ indoctos habet. Nos autē si placuerit recitare. adhiberi sum
erudicissimū queq;. Sd̄ plane adhuc an sic recitandū. examina cecū.
omūq; quos ego moui. inuicāq; p̄rte calculos pone. idq; elige. in quo
uigēt ratio. Acc enī ratio exigetur. nos excusabit obsequiū. vale

ASSEM PARA. dācepe aureā fabulā.

Fabulā immo. Nāme p̄orū. noua amonuit. Nec refert. a quo potis
sumū incipia. Uerā p̄sonis. graue iacebat. hui' dīcop̄sonis. que
galba adoptauit. Adhanc regulus uenit p̄mū. Impudencia hominis
qui uenerit ad grā. cū marito inimicissimū. ip̄s inuissimū fuerat.
Esto. si uenit tancū. Atille dīa p̄xim' tōro sedis. quod die qua hortatus

67
 eos interrogavit. Vbi audit. componit uoluntatem. incendit oculos. mouet labra.
 agitat digitos. computat nichil. Uelut miseram expectatione suspendit.
 Habet inquit climactericum tempus. id euades. Quod ut tibi magis liqueat.
 anaspice consula. que sunt frequenter expectant. Hec mora sacrificium facit.
 affirmat. extra eiusdem significatione congruere. Illa ut in piculo et
 dura. posset codicillos. legatum regulo scribit. Mox ingratias ferit. Clamat
 moriens. Ob hominem nequam. perfidum. ac plus etiam quam prius. quis tibi pla-
 uere filiusceperat. Facit hoc regulus nimium scelerat. qui regnum. quod uir-
 deus. quos ipse cotidie fallit. in capite infelicius pueri dactylat. Velleus blis
 ille locupletis consularis. nouissima ualitudine confluebat. Cupidus
 mutare testamentum. Regulus qui sperat aliquid ex nouis tabulis. quia nup-
 care eum cepit. medicos hortari. rogare. quo quomodo spiritum hominum proferat.
 Postquam signatum est testamentum. mutat personam. uertit ad locutionem. uideque medicum.
 Quo usque miserum cruciat. Quid inuideat bona moris. cui dare uita non potest.
 morte blis. itaque omnia audita. regulum et tantulum quidem. Sufficiunt de
 fabula. in scolastica. Legit. Terra posuit. Istunde fiat Aurelia. a nota
 femina. signata testamentum. supererat pulcherrimas tunicas. Regulus cum
 uenisset assignandum. rogo inquit has mihi leges. Aurelia ludere hominem
 putabat. Ille seruo instabat. Nemulca. coegit mulierem aperire tabulas.
 de sibi tunicas quas erat induca legare. Obseruauit scribentem. inspicit
 an scripserat. Ecce Aurelia quidem uiuit. ille tam istud tamque mortuum coegit.
 Et hic hereditatem. hic legata. quas mortui accipit. A A A A A I A T E I N O M A I
 in ciuitate in qua iam pridem minora prima. immo maiora. nequicia non
 obstat. quam pudor. uirtutem habent. Aspice regulum qui ex pueri. ut non.
 ad tantas opes perflata peruenit. ut ipse in dixerit cum consuleret. quia cum
 seceratui secentas implectitur. et. uenisse. extra duplicata. quibus por-
 tendi milites. reducentes habiturum. Et habuit. simodo ut cepit. aliena
 testamenta. quod est improbius quam falsi. ipsi quod. illa dicuntur. uale

Nescio an ullum iocundius tempus exegeri. quam quo nup-
 spurina fuit. Adeo quidem. ut neminem magis in senectate simo-
 senescere dactum. emulari uelim. Nichil est illo denique uirge ge-
 neri diuincius. Ne autem ut ceteri. derum cursu. ita uita hominum est.

duo a haec & sonantia quam iuxta & pressa delectant.
 aliquid enim ammo turpis ista discordia est tamen quae
 plerumque tuetur: ut aliud iudices exigant: cum al-
 liquis praecipue auditor adfidebeat: quibus
 iuris si forte iudex maxime promouetur: potest tamen
 si utique quam in his difficultatibus libris in noui-
 tas. Et si necesse est: ne utique apud nostros: apud grae-
 cos enim est quiddam quamuis ex diuersis sonantiam
 omnino dissimile: nam ualliserat moris leges quas
 ut conparias prioribus legibus arguebant: aliarum
 conlatione conuincere: ita nobis esse repetenda in daru
 legi quod postularimus: cum haec ipsa lege tumulus
 colligendum fuit: quod nequaquam blandum auri-
 bus imperitorum tantum maiorem apud doctos ha-
 bere gratiam debet: quam tamen in apud in doc-
 tos habet: nos autem si placuerit et cetera: adhibi-
 tur sumus: eruditissimum quemque saltem ad huc
 an si recte cum de amine et cetera: omnisque quos
 ego moui in utraque per te cetera oculos pone: id que
 eligere in quod uicerit ratio: ac tamen ratio suggerat:
 nos ex cetera habet obsequium. **VALLE**

C. PLINIUS CALVISIO SVO SALUTEM
 Aeternum. Accipe auream fabulam fabulam
 mo. Nam me in nouis ad hunc: nec refert quo
 potissimum incipiam uerum: apud sonis ignis uerum: iacebat
 huius discipulis quibusque ad deperit: ad hanc regu-
 lus uenit primum in pu dentiam hominis quia uenit ad
 aegram: cuius in uenit in uenit: ipse in uenit in uenit
 fuerat: obo si uenit in uenit: ad hunc primum in uenit
 quod die qua horam accedat in uenit: ubi ad hunc
 componit ualiam: in uenit oculos mouet labra ag-
 rat: digito computat nichil: ut ad hunc in uenit
 suspendit: habet inquit dimittit in uenit: sed uenit
 quod ducit in uenit: liquet: arripit in uenit: consul conuenit
 sunt frequentes: expertus: nec in uenit: sacrificium facit: ad
 firmitas ex a cum in uenit: significacione congruit: illa
 ut in uenit: opud a postea ad hunc: legat in uenit: obo
 bit: mox in uenit: clamor in uenit: hominem nequam
 perfidum ac plura conuenit: quam in uenit: quibus in uenit
 ter in uenit: facit in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 quam frequentes: quod in uenit: quod in uenit: in uenit

fallit: ut caput in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 blar si in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 dine conflatabatur: cupiebat mutare et tamen
 num regulis qui speraret aliquid ex nouis tabu-
 lis qui in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 tari rogare quo: quod in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 rogarent: postquam in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 mutae sonant uerum ad locutionem: idem que me-
 dias: quod in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 bona in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 ble si: & tamquam in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 tulum quidem: sufficiunt duae fabulae: anecho-
 lastica legere: tamposita: in uenit: in uenit
 ornata femina signatura: in uenit: in uenit
 rat pulcherrima in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 ad signandum: rogare in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 ludere hominem in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 ta coegit mulierem in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 cas quod in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 tem in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 ille tamen in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 hic hereditas: hic legat: quod in uenit: in uenit

**C. PLINII SECONDI
 EPIS TULARI EXPLICIT II
 INCIPIT LIBER III FELICIT**
 A dactylus in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 A dactylus in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
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 A dactylus in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit
 A dactylus in uenit: in uenit: in uenit: in uenit

accipit. αλλὰ τὶ Διὰ τὸ ποιεῖν in ea ciuitate i qua
iam pridem non minora premia imo maiora nequi
tia & improbitas q̄ pudor & uirtus habent. Aspice
Regulum qui ex paupere & tenui ad tantas opes p
flagitia processit ut ipse mihi dixerit cum consule
ret q̄ cito sextertium sexcenties impleturus esset in
uenisse se ex duplicia: qbus portendi millies et du
centies habiturū. & habebit si modo ut cepit aliena
testamēta: quod est improbissimū genus falsi: p̄p̄s
quorum sunt illa dicta uerit.

C. CAECILI PLINI SECVNDI EPIST.
LIBER TERTIVS.

C. P. Caluissio. S.

Esicio an ullum iucundius tempus exe
gerim q̄ quo nuper apud Spuriinnā fui
adeo quidem ut neminem magis i fene
ctute: (si modo senescere datum est) xmu
lari uelim. Nihil est enim illo uitæ genere distincti
us. Me autem ut cernis syderū carlus: ita uita homi
nū disposita delectat: senum præsertim. Nam iuue
nes cōfusa adhuc quædam & quasi turbata non in
decenti: Senibus placida omnia & ordinata conue
niunt: quibus industria seip̄ turpis ambitio ē. Hæc
regulā Spuriinna constantissime seruauit: quin etiam
parua hæc: si non quouidie fiant: ordine quodam &

uel ut orbe circū agit. Mane lectulo continetur. ho
ra secūda calceos poscit: ambulat mille pas. nec mi
nus animum q̄ corpus exercet: si assunt amici: hone
stissimi sermones explicant: si nō: liber legiē: inter
dum etiā præsentibus amicis: si tamen illi non gra
uantur: deinde confidet & liber rursus: aut sermo li
bro potior. mox uehiculū ascendit: assumit uxorem
singularis exempli: uel aliquem amicorum ut me p
xime. q̄ pulchrum illud q̄ dulce secretum: quātum
ibi antiquitatis: quæ facta: quos uiros audias: quib̄
præceptis imbua: quāuis ille hoc temperamentū
modestæ suæ indixerit: ne præcipe uideatur. Pera
ctis. vii. mil. pas. iterum ambulabat mille. Iterum re
sidet uel se cubiculo ac stilo reddit: scribit enim & q
dem utraq; lingua: Lyrica doctissime: mira illis dul
cedo: mira suauitas: mira hilaritas: cuius gratiā cu
mulat sanctitas scribentis. Vbi hora balinei nuncia
ta est: Est aut hyeme nona: æstate octaua: i sole si ca
ret uento ambulat nudus: deinde mouetur pila ue
hementer & diuinā hoc quoq; exercitationis gene
pugnat cum senectute. Iotus accubat & pauli per ci
bum differt: interim audit legentē remissius aliqd &
dulcius. Per hoc omne tēpus liberū ē amicis: uel ea
dē facere: uel alia si malint: apponit cœna non mi
nus nitida q̄ frugū in argento puro & antiquo. Sunt
in usu & Corynthia: quib̄ delectat & adficiē. Fre
quēter comædis cœna distiguit: aut uoluptates quorū
e iii

ambulat

G. es. fatio

hora balnei

prole luvius

ana

Comædi

C. Plinius. Calvisio suo salutem
 Nescio an ullum iucundius tempus
 exerceam quam quoniam per ardua
 riuum amicum adeo quidem ut ne amicum
 maxime senectutes in odos senescere
 reditum est amularum et in nihil
 est enim illi outae genere distinctum
 ctius in ex utem ut certus siderum
 cursus ita uitae hominum disposita
 delectatis enim praesertim nam
 iuvenes ad huc conatus aquae dant
 et quae siturba non inde cent se-
 nibus placida omnia et ornatu con-
 ueniunt quibus industriae et turpis
 ambitio est hanc reculae puri-
 nae constantissimae seruatur quineti-
 rarum haec rarum. si non cotidie fiat
 ordine quod amet uelut orbem circū-
 actum anelactulo continetur hora
 secundae hanc eos poscit ambulatio
 lix assuum tria nec minus animum
 quam cor tunc se recelsi adsunt amica
 honestissimi sermones explicitantur
 si non libere lectur inter dum etiam praesentis
 amicae etiam in illis monentur
 tur deinde consideret libere purus
 aut sermonis potior. moxue hic

accipit. αλλὰ τὶ Διὰ τὸ ποιεῖν in ea ciuitate i qua
iam pridem non minora premia imo maiora nequi
tia & improbitas q̄ pudor & uirtus habent. Aspice
Regulum qui ex paupere & tenui ad tantas opes p
flagitia processit ut ipse mihi dixerit cum consule
ret q̄ cito sextertium sexcenties impleturus esset in
uenisse se ex duplicia: qbus portendi millies et du
centies habiturū. & habebit si modo ut cepit aliena
testamēta: quod est improbissimū genus falsi: p̄p̄sis
quorum sunt illa dicta uerit.

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gerim q̄ quo nuper apud Spuriinnā fui
adeo quidem ut neminem magis i fene
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lari uelim. Nihil est enim illo uitæ genere distincti
us. Me autem ut cernis syderū carlus: ita uita homi
nū disposita delectat: senum præsertim. Nam iuue
nes cōfusa adhuc quædam & quasi turbata non in
decenti: Senibus placida omnia & ordinata conue
niunt: quibus industria seip̄ turpis ambitio ē. Hæc
regulā Spuriinna constantissime seruauit: quin etiam
parua hæc: si non quouidie fiant: ordine quodam &

uel ut orbe circū agit. Mane lectulo continetur. ho
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uantur: deinde confidet & liber rursus: aut sermo li
bro potior. mox uehiculū ascendit: assumit uxorem
singularis exempli: uel aliquem amicorum ut me p
xime. q̄ pulchrum illud q̄ dulce secretum: quātum
ibi antiquitatis: quæ facta: quos uiros audias: quibz
præceptis imbua: quāuis ille hoc temperamentū
modestæ suæ indixerit: ne præcipe uideatur. Pera
ctis. vii. mil. pas. iterum ambulabat mille. Iterum re
sidet uel se cubiculo ac stilo reddit: scribit enim & q
dem utraq; lingua: Lyrica doctissime: mira illis dul
cedo: mira suauitas: mira hilaritas: cuius gratiā cu
mulat sanctitas scribentis. Vbi hora balinei nuncia
ta est: Est aut hyeme nona: æstate octaua: i sole si ca
ret uento ambulat nudus: deinde mouetur pila ue
hementer & diuinā hoc quoq; exercitationis gene
pugnat cum senectute. Iotus accubat & pauli per ci
bum differt: interim audit legentē remissius aliqd &
dulcius. Per hoc omne tēpus liberū ē amicis: uel ea
dē facere: uel alia si malint: apponit cœna non mi
nus nitida q̄ frugū in argento puro & antiquo. Sunt
in usu & Corynthia: quibz delectat & adficiē. Fre
quēter comædis cœna distiguit: aut uoluptates quor
e iii

ambulat

G. es. fatio

hora balnei

pl. le. luvius

cœna

comædis

opacus hunc subter exit fons & exprimit pluribus uen-
nis: sed imparibaeluctatus. Quae facit gurgitē lato
gremio patefacto purus & uitreus ut numerare iaci-
tas stipes & relucētēs calculos possis. Inde non loci
deuexitate sed ipsa sui copia & quasi pondere ipelli-
turs fons adhuc ē amplissimū flumē atq; ēt nauium
patiēsthic munus Codex. eodem quo emerat in-
struxit plurimis & antiquissimis statuīs: nā illi pul-
cherri morū operum in horreis quae negligebatur
cem tu si quid istic epistola dignū ne grauerē scribe-
re: nā cū aures hominū leuitate latent tū ad ratio-
nem uitae exemplis erudimur. Vale.

C.P. Maximo. S.

¶ T gaudium mihi & solatium in litteris: ni-
hilq; tam latū quod his latius: tā triste qd
non per has sit minus triste. Itaq; & infirmitate uxo-
ris & meorum periculo: quorūdam uero etiā morte
turbatus ad unū doloris leuamētū studia confugi:
quae praestāt ut aduersa magis intelligam: sed patiē-
tius feram. Est autē mihi moris: q; sum daturus i ma-
nus hominū ante amicos: iudicio examinare iprimis
tuo. Proinde si qn nūc itēde i librū meū quē cū hac e-
pistola accipies. Quia ueror ne ipse ut tristis pas-
sē tenderi: impare. n. dolori ut scribere potuist uacuo
aīo letoq; n̄ potui: porro ut ex studiis gaudiū sic stu-
dia hilaritate pueniūt. Vale. C.P. Gallo. S.

a. D quae noscēda iter ingredi: trasmittef mare

ne in ledulo quidem nisi ab alijs mouebatur.
quinetiam foedum miserandumq; die iuden-
tes lauandos fircandos praebat. auditum est
frequenter ab ipso quereretur de contumelijs
debilitatis suae: digitos se seruorum suorum
quotidie lingere: uiuebat tamen et uiuere vo-
lebat sustinēte maxime uxore, quae culpam in
chaati matrimonij in gloriam perseuerantia
verterat. habes omnes fabulas urbis nam sunt
omnes fabulae, nullus. expectabatur auctio.
enim fuit tam copiosus ut amplissimos hortos
eodem quo emerat die intruxerit. plurimis
et antiquissimis statuīs. tantum illi pulcherri-
morū operum in horreis quasi nec legebatur
mutem tu si quid de epistula dignum ne
grauare. Nam cum aures hominum nouita-
te letantur tamen ad rationem uitae exem-
plis erudimur. Vale

C. Plinius Maximo suo Salutem.

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Cessit ut ipse mihi dixerit cum con-
suleret quomodo se tertium sesce-
ties impleturus esset inuenisse se ex
ta duplicata quibus totum diuinitas et
ducenties habiturum et habebit si
modum te oportet mihi testamur
quod est in probissimum cenustal
siis quorum sumit illud ut te
uale



ELISTULARUM. EXC. LIBER. II.

INC. LIB. III. FELICITER.



AD CALVISIUM RUFUM
nescio an ullum
AD UTBIUM MAXIMUM
quod ipse amicis tuis
AD CREPELLAE HIRULLAE
cum patre tuo
AD CAELIUM MACRINUM
quodvis etiam
AD SILEBIUM MACRUM
quodvis etiam
AD SEVERUM
quodvis etiam
AD CAMINIUM RUFUM
modonuntiatus est
AD SUTTON TRANQUE
tacis et cetera
AD CORNELIUM MINICIANUM
possunt et cetera
AD UESTRIC SPURINNI
composuisse et cetera

- AD IULIUM CENITOR.
ESTOMMINOARTEMIDORI
- AD CATILINUM SEUER.
VERILACONADCEPIAM
- AD UOCONIUM ROMANUM
VERILACONADCEPIAM
- AD RATILIUM
VERILACONADCEPIAM
- AD SILIUM PROCL.
VERILACONADCEPIAM
- AD IULIUM SERUIANUM
VERILACONADCEPIAM
- AD UIRIUM SEUERUM
VERILACONADCEPIAM
- AD CALUISIUM RUFUM.
VERILACONADCEPIAM
- AD MAESIUM MAXIMUM
VERILACONADCEPIAM
- AD CORNELIUM PRISCUM
VERILACONADCEPIAM

TTTTTTTT

C. Plinius. Calvisio suo salutem
 Nescio an ullum iucundius tempus
 exerceam quam quoniam per ardua
 riuina et uia deo quidem in uineam
 maxime in senectute in modum senescere
 reditum est et emulari uel in nihil
 est enim illi uita ex genere distincta
 et ius in exultem ut certius siderum
 cursus ita uita hominum disposita
 delectat senum praesertim nam
 iuuenes adhuc conatus aquae dant
 et quasi turba non indecent sen
 nibus placida omnia et ornata con
 ueniunt quibus industriae et uis
 ambitio est hanc reculae puri
 nae constantissimae seruatur quineti
 parua haec parua si non cotidie fiant
 ordine quod amet uel uitorbe circū
 ac poma in lectulo continetur hora
 secundae haec eos postea ambulatio
 lix assuum tria nec minus animum
 quam corpus exerceat ad sunt amica
 honestissimi sermones explicantur
 si non libere lectur inter dum etiam praes
 sentibus amicis etiam in illis monetur
 tur deinde consideret libere quis
 aut sermone liberior moxue hic

ASCENDIT AD SUAM VIXOREM IN SINGU-
 LARI SEXU PLIUELI ALIQUEM VAGRICORUM
 VIM PROXIME QUAM MULIERUM ILLUD
 QUAM DULCE SECRETIUM QUANTUM BIX-
 TI QUIAUS QUAE FACTA QUOS VIRE OS AU-
 DIAS QUIB. PRAECEPTIS IN VULGARE QUAMUIS
 ILLE HOCTEMPORAM ENTUM MODESTIAE
 SUAE INDIXERIT NE TRAECEPERE VIDENTUR
 PERACTISSE PTENOM LIB. PASSUUM E-
 RUM AMBULATUM ILLE PER VIRE RESIDIT
 VEL SECUBICULO EXSTILO REDDIT SRI
 BPTENI METQUIDE MUTRAQ. LINGUALY
 RICADOCTISSIMA VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 MIRASU VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 CRATIA M CUM VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 BENTIS VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 EST AUTEM HIC VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 UAM INSOLESCARE TUR VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 NUDUS DE INDE MOUETUR PILAUE HE-
 MENTER ET DIUNA VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 CITATIONIS CENERE VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 NECTUTE LOTUS ACCUBAT ET PAULIS
 PERCIBUM DIFFERT INTERIMA UDIT LE-
 CENTEM REMISSUS ALIQUID ET DULCIS
 PER HOCTEMPORAM ENTUM MODESTIAE
 AMICIS VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO
 SIMILITUDINE VIRE A VIRE AILLIS DULCEDO

·FISCUS· ·Vale
 C·LINIUS·CORELLIAE·SALUTEM·
 CUM PATRENTUUM CRUICISSIMUM ET SAN-
 CTISSIMUM VIRUM SUSPEXERIM IN AELIS
 ANA·MA·VERI·INDUBITE·ANTE·Q· IN·ME·MO-
 RIA·ME·IUS·ET·IN·HONORE·ANTUUM·IN·DICE
 DILIGAM·CUPIAM·NE·CESSSE·EST·AT·Q··E·I·X·
 QUANTUM·IN·ME·FUE·RITE·NIT·AK·UT·FILII·US
 TUUS·X·I·OS·IM·LIS·EX·SIST·ATE·QUID·E·M·
 MALO·MATERN·O·QUAM·Q··AM·ILLI·PAT·ER·
 NUS·ET·IAM·EL·AR·US·SPECTATUS·CONTICE
 RIT·PAT·ER·QUO·Q·ET·PAT·RU·US·IN·LUSTRI·L·AM·
 DE·CONSPICUI·QUI·B·OMNIB·AD·E·M·UM·
 SIMILIS·ADOLESCET·SIBI·IN·BUT·US·HON·ES-
 TIS·ARTIB·US·FUE·RIT·QUA·SP·LUR·IM·UM·REFE-
 R·MA·QUO·POT·ISSIM·UM·ACCIP·I·AT·AD·HUC·
 ILL·UM·PUE·RIT·AE·R·ATIO·IN·TRA·CON·TUBER-
 NI·UM·ANTUUM·V·E·NIT·PRAE·CEPTORES·DOMI-
 HAB·UT·UBI·EST·TERROR·IB·MODIC·AE·ST·ET·IX·
 NULL·AM·TER·RIA·AM·STUDIA·E·I·US·EX·TRA-
 LIMEN·CONFER·AND·AS·UNT·IAM·CIRCUM·SPI-
 CIE·AD·US·RHETOR·LATIN·US·CUI·US·SCHO-
 LA·E·SE·UE·RIT·AS·PUDOR·IN·PRIMIS·CASTITAS·
 CONSTET·ADESTE·NIM·AD·UL·ESCENTI·NOS·
 TRO·CUM·CETERIS·NAT·UR·AE·FORTUN·AE·Q·
 DOT·IB·EX·IM·IA·CORPORIS·PUL·CRIT·UDO·
 CUM·HOC·LUBRICO·L·ET·ATIS·NON·PRAE·CEP-

Torquatos edcustos etiam pectoris
 quærendus est uideor ex eodem mon-
 strare tibi posse iulium centiorem
 amatorem et dicitur amicum non
 obstitit karitas hominis quæ iudi-
 cionata est uir est emendatus et cra-
 uis paulo etiam horridior et durior
 ut in hac licentia temporum quan-
 tum eloquentia ualeat pluribus cre-
 dere potes nam dicendi facultas
 aperta et exposita statim cernitur
 uita hominum altos recessus mac-
 nasque latebras habet cuius proce-
 nitorem sponsorem accipere nihil
 ex hoc uirum filium tuum audiet nisi
 profuturum nihil discet quod nescis
 si rectius fuerit ne minus sapere ab
 illo quam te meque admonetur
 quibus in acinibus oneretur quæ nomi-
 na et quantas sustineat proinde faue-
 tibus diis trahere uirum præceptoris
 quo magis et prius mox eloquentia
 discat quæ malesine moribus dis-
 citur uale

C. PLINIUS MACRINO Salutem
 Quamuis etiam amici quos præsentem
 habes amet sermone hominum

MODESTI A SERMONISEI PATRICIO
 PULI AUTE MME AD HOC CONSILIUM
 SOLI CONSENSUSSENATUS QUI AN
 INCONSISTENTEM METALIQUIDEM
 MINORIS SED TAMEN NUMERI
 EXISTIMATENTEMPTORIS NOCT
 ET ANSICULORUM HOSPITIUM
 PRAECCUSATIONE VOLUNTARI
 SECHUS QUOD ET FORMUS ARBITRABAR
 PULIUS SINGULORUM NEC LECEPRAE
 TEREACUM RECORDI PERQUANTA
 PROPS DECAVETICIS PORE ADUOCI
 TIONE ET AN PERICULAS VOISSE
 SENSU ANSICULORUM HOSPITIUM
 NOVO INDICATUM EST ENIM
 PARATUM ANSICULORUM BENEFICI
 UERTAS IN NULLA PASTORIS CUM
 LUSU ANSICULORUM ANSICULORUM
 TIS QUID INDICATUM EST ENIM
 MEMINERUNT QUOD INDICATUM
 ANSICULORUM ANSICULORUM
 CLASSICUS ANSICULORUM ANSICULORUM
 ANSICULORUM ANSICULORUM
 ANSICULORUM ANSICULORUM
 ANSICULORUM ANSICULORUM
 ANSICULORUM ANSICULORUM
 ANSICULORUM ANSICULORUM

AN SENSICULORUM

Nulla minus maxima computat etiam
 si munere hoc tertio fungere et acili
 ore mihi excusationem fore si
 quis incidisset quem non deberem
 accusare nam cum est omnium offi
 ciorum in his aliquis tuum optime
 libertati ueniam obsequio prelaetatur
 audisti consilium meum motus super
 est aliter ut prelaetarte iudicium tuum
 in quo mihi aequi uicundaret sim
 plicitas dissidentis quam compro
 bantis auctoritas uale
 Plinius macro suo salutem
 Pergratum est mihi quod tam dilige
 ter libros tuos uolueris lectitas ut
 habere omnes uel isque etasque qui
 sint omnes de functione iudicis partibus
 atque etiam quos in ordine scripti
 notum tibi faciam est enim haec
 quoque studiosis non in uicunda cog
 niti de iaculatione equestris unus
 hunc cum praefectus et de militia
 re praefectus et de euraque composuit
 de uita romponi secundum duo quo
 singulari praefectus hoc memorie
 amicum si debetum munus exsol
 uit bellorum et romanorum uicundaret

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quā parentes p̄fuit vale

HORTARIS ut oratione. amicitia plurib; recte. facia q̄ hortari q̄m ut
themē addubitat. Neq; enī me p̄tere. actiones querebant impaū omē
caloreq; ac ppe nom suū p̄dere ut quas sola cōmēdare simul. rascendert
iudiciū cōfēt. celebritas aduocatorū. expectatio. euent. fama nūmū
accorū. deducūq; impetres audientū studiū. ad hoc ducenat gestus. uict
sus. discurs. dīa. omib; q̄mōtib; animi cōsentaneū uigor corporis. Vnde
accidit. ut hī quiescentes agunt. quāuis illis maxima ex parte sup̄st
eadē illa que stantib; . tam hoc qd̄ sedent. quasi debilitentur. idē p̄mā
cur. Recitantū ū p̄cipua p̄nunciatiois adiuncta oculi manus. p̄p̄e
diunt. Quomun̄ mirū ē. si auditorū incencio relanguiscit. nullis
exeritē aut blandimētis capta aut oculis excitata. hīs accedit. qd̄ ora
tio de qua loquit. pugnae icona p̄iosa ē. Porro uicāta comparatū ē.
ut ea que scripsim cū labore. dīa cū labore audiri p̄tem. O sane quō
quisq; cā rē. iudiciū. quē n̄ potius dulcia hec risonancia. q̄uāstera ip̄sū
delectent. Est quidē omīno curbis ista discordia. Est cām que plerūq;
euent. ut aliud iudices exigunt. cū alloquū p̄cipue audiri adfici
debet. Quib; idē sifore iudex. maxime p̄mouerātur. P̄est cām fieri.
ut quāquā m̄his difficultatib; libro isti nouitas lenocina. nouitas ap̄
n̄os. Apud grecos enī ē. quiddā quāuis ex diuerso. n̄cām omīno diffi
mule. Nā ut illis erat moris leges quas. contrarias p̄orib; legib; argue
bant. aliatū cōtatione conuincere. ita nob̄ ē. rep̄undarū legi quod
postularemus. cū hac ip̄sa lege tū alius colligendū fuit. Qd̄ nequaquā
blandū aurib; impitoy. tanto maiore ap̄ doctos habere grām debet. q̄to
minore ap̄ indoctos habet. Nos autē si placuerit recitare. adhiberi sum
erudicissimū queq;. Sd̄ plane adhuc an sic recitandū. examina cecū.
omūq; quos ego moui. inuicāq; p̄rte calculos pone. idq; elige. in quo
uigērit ratio. Acc enī ratio exigitur. nos excusabit obsequiū. vale

ASSEM PARA. dācepe aureā fabulā.

Fabulāsimmo. Nāme p̄orū. noua amonuit. Nec refert. a quo potis
sumū incipia. Uerā p̄sonis. graue iacebat. hui' dīcop̄sonis. que
galba adoptauit. Adhanc regulus uenit p̄mū. Impudencia hominis
qui uenerit ad grā. cū marito inimicissimū. ip̄s inuissimū fuerat.
Esto. si uenit tancū. Atille dīa p̄xim' tōro sedis. quod die qua hortatus

67
 eos interrogavit. Vbi audit. componit uoluntatem. incendit oculos. mouet labra.
 agitat digitos. computat nichil. Uelut miseram expectatione suspendit.
 Habet inquit climactericum tempus. id euades. Quod ut tibi magis liqueat.
 anaspice consula. que sunt frequenter expectant. Hec mora sacrificium facit.
 affirmat. extra cunctis significatione congruere. Illa ut in piculo et
 dura. posset codicillos. legatum regulo scribit. Mox ingratias ferit. Clamat
 moriens. Ob hominem nequam. perfidum. ac plus etiam quam prius. quis tibi pla-
 uere filiusceperat. Facit hoc regulus nimium scelerat. qui regnum. quod uir-
 deus. quos ipse cotidie fallit. in capite infelicius pueri dactylis. Velleus blis
 ille locupletis consularis. nouissima ualitudine confluebat. Cupidus
 mutare testamentum. Regulus qui sperat aliquid ex nouis tabulis. quia nunc cap-
 ture cum cepit. medicos hortari. rogare. quo quomodo spiritum hominum proferat.
 Postquam signatum est testamentum. mutat personam. uertit ad locutionem. uideque medicum.
 Quo usque miserum cruciatum. Quid inuideat bona moris. cui dare uita non potest.
 morte blis. itaque omnia audisse. regulum et tantulum quidem. Sufficiunt due
 fabule. in scolastica. Legit. Terra posuit. Istunde fiat Aurelia. et nota
 femina. signata testamentum. supererat pulcherrimas tunicas. Regulus cum
 uenisset assignandum. rogo inquit has mihi leges. Aurelia ludere hominem
 putabat. Ille seruo instabat. Nemulca. coegit mulierem aperire tabulas.
 de sibi tunicas quas erat induca legare. Obseruauit scribentem. inspicit
 an scripserat. Ecce Aurelia quidem uiuit. Ille tam istud tamque mortuum coegit.
 Et hic hereditatem. hic legata. quas mortui accipit. A A A A A I A T E I N O M A I
 in ciuitate in qua iam pridem minora prima. immo maiora. nequicia non
 obicit. quam pudor uirtutis habent. Aspice regulum qui ex pueri. ut non.
 ad tantas opes perflata peruenit. ut ipse in dixerit cum consuleret. quia cum
 seceratui secentas implectitur. et. uenisse. extra duplicata. quibus por-
 tendi milites. reducentes habiturum. Et habuit. simodo ut cepit. aliena
 testamenta. quod est improbius quam falsi. ipsi quod. illa dicuntur. uale

Nescio an ullum iocundius tempus exegeri. quam quo nupc
 spurina fuit. Adeo quidem. ut neminem magis in senectate simo-
 senescere dactum. emulari uelim. Nichil est illo denique uirge ge-
 neri diuincius. Ne autem ut ceteri. derum curs. ita uita hominum est

opacus hunc subter exit fons & exprimit pluribus uen-
nis: sed imparibaeluctatus. Quae facit gurgitē lato
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pistola accipies. Quia ueror ne ipse ut tristis pas-
sē tēderi: impare. n. dolori ut scriberē potui ut uacuo
aīo letoq; n̄ potui: porro ut ex studiis gaudiū sic stu-
dia hilaritate pueniūt. Vale. C.P. Gallo. S.

a. D quae noscēda iter ingredi: trasmittef mare

ne in ledulo quidem nisi ab alijs mouebatur.
quinetiam foedum miserandumq; die iuden-
tes lauandos fircandos praebat. auditum est
frequenter ab ipso quereretur de contumelijs
debilitatis suae: digitos se seruorum suorum
quotidie lingere: uiuebat tamen et uiuere vo-
lebat sustinēte maxime uxore, quae culpam in-
chaati matrimonij in gloriam perseuerantia
verterat. habes omnes fabulas urbis nam sunt
omnes fabulae, nullus. expectabatur auctio.
enim fuit tam copiosus ut amplissimos hortos
eodem quo emerat die intruxerit. plurimis
et antiquissimis statuistatū illi pulcherri-
morū operum in horreis quasi nec legebatur
mutem tu si quid de epistula dignum ne
grauare. Nam cum aures hominum nouita-
te letantur tamen ad rationem uitae exem-
plis erudimur. Vale

C. Plinius Maximo suo Salutem.

¶ T gaudium mihi et solatium in litteris,
nihilq; tam letum quod his letius: nihil
tam triste quod non per has minus triste. Itaq;
et infirmitate uxoris et meorum periculo

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accipit. αλλὰ τὶ Διὰ τὸ ποιεῖν in ea ciuitate i qua
iam pridem non minora premia imo maiora nequi
tia & improbitas q̄ pudor & uirtus habent. Aspice
Regulum qui ex paupere & tenui ad tantas opes p
flagitia processit ut ipse mihi dixerit cum consule
ret q̄ cito sextertium sexcenties impleturus esset in
uenisse se ex duplicia: qbus portendi millies et du
centies habiturū. & habebit si modo ut cepit aliena
testamēta: quod est improbissimū genus falsi: p̄p̄sis
quorum sunt illa dicta uerit.

C. CAECILI PLINI SECVNDI EPIST.
LIBER TERTIVS.

C. P. Caluissio. S.

Esicio an ullum iucundius tempus exe
gerim q̄ quo nuper apud Spuriinnā fui
adeo quidem ut neminem magis i fene
ctute: (si modo senescere datum est) xmu
lari uelim. Nihil est enim illo uitæ genere distincti
us. Me autem ut cenus syderū carlus: ita uita homi
nū disposita delectat: senum præsertim. Nam iuue
nes cōfusa adhuc quædam & quasi turbata non in
decenti: Senibus placida omnia & ordinata conue
niunt: quibus industria seip̄ turpis ambitio ē. Hæc
regulā Spuriinna constantissime seruauit: quin etiam
parua hac: si non quouidie fiant: ordine quodam &

uel ut orbe circū agit. Mane lectulo continetur. ho
ra secūda calceos poscit: ambulat mille pas. nec mi
nus animum q̄ corpus exercet: si assunt amici: hone
stissimi sermones explicant: si nō: liber legiē: inter
dum etiā præsentibus amicis: si tamen illi non gra
uantur: deinde confidet & liber rursus: aut sermo li
bro potior. mox uehiculū ascendit: assumit uxorem
singularis exempli: uel aliquem amicorum ut me p
xime. q̄ pulchrum illud q̄ dulce secretum: quātum
ibi antiquitatis: quæ facta: quos uiros audias: quibz
præceptis imbua: quāuis ille hoc temperamentū
modestæ suæ indixerit: ne præcipe uideatur. Pera
ctis. vii. mil. pas. iterum ambulabat mille. Iterum re
sidet uel se cubiculo ac stilo reddit: scribit enim & q
dem utraq; lingua: Lyrica doctissime: mira illis dul
cedo: mira suauitas: mira hilaritas: cuius gratiā cu
mulat sanctitas scribentis. Vbi hora balinei nuncia
ta est: Est aut hyeme nona: æstate octaua: i sole si ca
ret uento ambulat nudus: deinde mouetur pila ue
hementer & diuinā hoc quoq; exercitationis gene
pugnat cum senectute. Iotus accubat & pauli per ci
bum differt: interim audit legentē remissius aliqd &
dulcius. Per hoc omne tēpus liberū ē amicis: uel ea
dē facere: uel alia si malint: apponit cœna non mi
nus nitida q̄ frugū in argento puro & antiquo. Sunt
in usu & Corynthia: quibz delectat & adficiē. Fre
quēter comædis cœna distiguit: aut uoluptates quorū
e iii

ambulat

G. es. fatio

hora balnei

pl. le. luvius

ana

Comædi

mat tunicis. Regulus cum uenisset ad signandum, Rogo inquit has mihi leges. Aurelia ludere hominem putabat, ille serio istabat. nec multum coegit mulierem aperire tabulas, ac sibi tunicas, quas erat eduta, legere. obseruauit scribentem, inspexit an scripisset. et Aurelia quidem uiuit, ille tamen istud tanquam moriturus coegit. et hic hereditatis, hic legum, quasi mercedem accipit. *ΑΑΑΑ* *ΑΑΑΑ* *ΑΑΑΑ* *ΑΑΑΑ* in ea ciuitate, i qua iam priorem non minora praemia, immo maiora, nequitia et improbitas, quam pudor et uirtus, habent. Aспица Regulum, qui ex paupe et tenui, ad tantum opus per flagitia processit, ut ipse mihi dixerit, cum consuleret, quam cito sexagesimum sex annos implemus esset, inuenisse se extra duplicem, quibus portendi melior, et ducentis habiturum. et habebit, si modo, ne coepit aliena testamentum, quod est improbitissimum genus falsi, ipsis, quorum sunt illa, dictauerit.

Vale.

FINIS.

C. PLINII SECUNDI EPISTOLA
RVM LIBER TERTIVS.C. PLINIUS CALVISIO
SVO SALVTEM.

Ego, an ullum iucundius tempus exegerim, quam quo nuper apud Spurinam fui, adeo quidem ut neminem magis i fenestris, (si modo fenestre datum est, venatori uelim. nihil est enim illo uitae genere diuinius. ne autem ut artus siderum curas, ita uita hominum distorsim delectat, semum praefertim. Nam inuenies adhuc confusa quaedam, et quasi uerba non indecens, senibus placida omnia et ordinata conueniant, quibus industria fera, turpis ambitio est. hanc regulam Spuria constantissime seruat. quoniam et in parua haec, parua si non quotidie sunt, ordine quodam, et uelut orbe circumagunt. mane lectulo continetur, hora secundae caloros poscit, ambulat millia passuarum. nec minus animum, quam corpus exercet. si ad senem amicum honestissimi sermones expleantur. si non liber legatur, interitum etiam praesentibus amicis, si nomen illi non exsuarur deinde confidet, et liber uisus, aut sermo libro potior. mox uehiculam ascendit, adfuit uxori singularis exempli, uel aliquem amicum, ut me proxime. Quam pulchrum illud, quam dulcor secretum, quam ibi tranquillitas, quam secreta, quos uiros audias, quibus praeparas ibitare. Quamuis ille hoc tempus

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[illegible]

Cessit ut ipse mihi dixerit cum co-
sulere quoniam ipse esset tertium sesce-
ties impleturus esset in venis se ex
ta duplicat x quibus portendit mihi es-
ducenties habebit et habebit si
modo ut cooptat laudem meam
quod est in probissimum genus fa-
silis si quorum sunt illi dicitur et
uxle

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